



TOEFL Writing Practice Workbook

Submitted as a TOEFL Writing Course Assignment

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Notice

This document is submitted as a TOEFL Writing course (Prof. Zhanhong Shi) assignment at Zhejiang University.

Abstract

This document contains TOEFL-style writing practice materials designed according to the updated TOEFL iBT Writing section format introduced by ETS in 2026. The collection focuses on the two primary productive writing tasks: *Write an Email* and *Write for an Academic Discussion*. For each practice task, the document first presents the original draft, followed by AI-based(ChatGPT 5.5 Thinking model) scoring, and revision suggestions, and finally the refined final version after revision.

The prompts simulate realistic academic and campus communication scenarios commonly found in modern TOEFL examinations. Email Writing tasks emphasize concise and audience-aware communication in practical university contexts, while Academic Discussion tasks assess the ability to express and organize opinions within a classroom discussion setting.

The overall structure, timing recommendations, and task organization are adapted from publicly available ETS descriptions and contemporary TOEFL preparation resources. The author answered questions on a self-designed website, the interface of which is shown in Figures 1. All content will be exported to this final report document.

Total Time Spent

Over 50 hours were devoted primarily to writing practice, evaluation and revision. Additional work included web interface design, document formatting design, source-based research, and reflective summarization.

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The screenshot displays the 'TOEFL Writing Practice Simulator' interface. At the top, a dark blue header bar contains a hamburger menu icon, the title 'TOEFL Writing Practice Simulator', the current topic 'Missing Laboratory Session - 7 minutes', a 'TIME REMAINING' timer at '03:01', and buttons for 'Start', 'Pause', 'Reset', and 'Finish'. The main content area is divided into two panels. The left panel, titled 'Practice 01 — Write an Email', includes a 'Prompt visible' button and details the task: 'Missing Laboratory Session', 'RECOMMENDED TIME: 7 minutes', 'SITUATION: You recently missed a laboratory session because you had a medical appointment. The course assistant has posted an announcement saying that students who missed the lab must contact him by email.', 'TASK: Write an email to the course assistant. Explain why you missed the lab, ask whether you can complete a make-up activity, and suggest one or two possible times.', and 'YOUR EMAIL SHOULD' with bullet points: 'Mention the reason clearly', 'Make a polite request', and 'Provide practical availability'. The right panel, titled 'Your Response', shows a text input area with 'Writing...' and 'Drafts are autosaved in this browser.' at the top. It contains a sample response: 'Dear Course Assistant, I hope you are doing well. I am writing because I missed the laboratory session on Tuesday due to a medical appointment that I had to attend. I understand that students who missed the lab should contact you by email, so I would like to ask whether there is a make-up activity or another way for me to complete the missed work. I want to make sure that I do not fall behind in the course. I am available on Wednesday afternoon after 2:00 p.m. or Friday morning before 11:00 a.m. If those times are not convenient, I would be happy to arrange another time that works better for you. Thank you very much for your time and assistance. I look forward to your reply. Best regards'. At the top right of this panel are counters for '130 words' and '701 characters', and an 'Autosaved' status.

Fig. 1. Example writing-session interface of the TOEFL writing practice simulator designed by author.

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Part I — Write an Email

Overview

This part focuses on the TOEFL iBT Writing task *Write an Email*. In this task, you are given a realistic situation and asked to write a short email to a specific person, such as a professor, teaching assistant, manager, or event organizer. The purpose is not to write a long message, but to communicate clearly, politely, and efficiently within a limited time. Most email prompts include a short situation and several required details. A strong response should make the situation clear, explain the writer's purpose, and include all the information requested in the prompt. The email should sound natural and respectful, but it does not need to be overly formal.

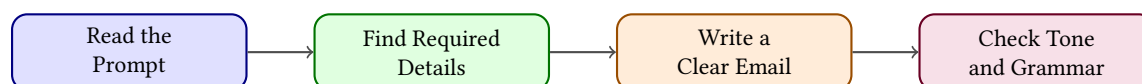


Figure: A simple workflow for the TOEFL email writing task.

What This Task Tests

The email task mainly evaluates practical written communication. In particular, it tests whether you can:

- understand the situation and identify the purpose of the email;
- include all required details from the prompt;
- make a clear request, explanation, apology, or response;
- organize a short message logically.

Basic Structure

A complete email response usually follows a simple structure. The exact wording may change depending on the prompt, but the organization is often similar:

- (1) **Greeting.** Begin with a suitable greeting, such as “Dear Professor Smith” or “Dear Course Assistant.”
- (2) **Purpose.** State why you are writing in the first one or two sentences.
- (3) **Details.** Explain the situation and include all required information from the prompt.
- (4) **Request or Response.** Say what you would like the reader to do, or how you are responding to the situation.
- (5) **Closing.** End politely with a short thank-you sentence and a proper closing.

Writing Strategy

Before writing, it is useful to spend a few seconds identifying the required information. Many low-scoring responses are not weak because they are too short, but because they miss one important point from the prompt. A good answer should answer the task directly. For example, if the prompt asks you to explain a reason, make a request, and suggest a time, all three parts should appear in the email.

The language should be polite and direct. Useful expressions include:

- “I am writing to ask whether...”
- “Would it be possible to...”
- “I apologize for the inconvenience.”
- “Thank you for your time and consideration.”

At the same time, the email should not sound mechanical. The best responses are usually simple, clear, and natural. It is better to write an accurate sentence than to force difficult vocabulary or complicated grammar.

Final Check

At the end of each practice, quickly check three things: whether the email includes all required details, whether the request or purpose is clear, and whether the tone is polite. If these three points are handled well, the response will usually feel complete even if the language is not perfect.

1 Missing Laboratory Session

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

You recently missed a laboratory session because you had a medical appointment. The course assistant has posted an announcement saying that students who missed the lab must contact him by email.

Task

Write an email to the course assistant. Explain why you missed the lab, ask whether you can complete a make-up activity, and suggest one or two possible times.

Your email should:

- Mention the reason clearly
- Make a polite request
- Provide practical availability

Original Response (Time Used: 06:48; Saved At: 2026/5/1 23:00:54; Words: 71)

Dear course assistant:

I hope it finds you well!

I'm sorry about missing the laboratory session because a had a abrupt medical appointment, which is out of my plan. Hearing your announcement, I'm writing to reschedule my session. I wonder if I was allowed to complete a make-up activity, and I will be available tomorrow night. Could you please rearrange it for me?

Apologize again for the inconvenience I brought.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

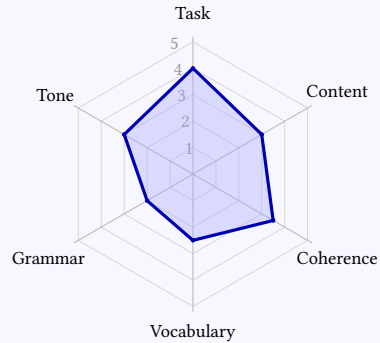
Overall Comment: This response completes the core task requirements: it explains the reason for missing the lab, asks about a make-up activity, and provides availability. However, the response contains several noticeable grammar and word-choice problems, and some expressions sound unnatural in English. The overall meaning is clear, but language control is not strong enough for a higher score.

Major Problems

- (1) Greeting punctuation: "Dear course assistant:" should be written as "Dear Course Assistant,".
- (2) Unnatural opening: "I hope it finds you well" is incorrect. A natural version is "I hope you are doing well."
- (3) Grammar error: "because a had a abrupt medical appointment" should be "because I had an unexpected medical appointment."
- (4) Unnatural phrase: "which is out of my plan" should be replaced by "which I could not reschedule" or simply omitted.
- (5) Tense problem: "I wonder if I was allowed" should be "I was wondering if I could complete a make-up activity."
- (6) Awkward request: "Could you please rearrange it for me?" sounds slightly demanding. A better version is "Please let me know if this would be possible."

- (7) Closing sentence: “Apologize again for the inconvenience I brought” should be “I apologize again for the inconvenience.”

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.0/5	The response addresses the main requirements: reason, request, and availability. However, the support is brief and only one possible time is given.
Content	3.0/5	The content is relevant, but ideas are only briefly developed and could be more specific or polished.
Coherence	3.5/5	The structure is clear and logical overall, but transitions are slightly awkward in places.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Some vocabulary choices are understandable but unnatural, such as “out of my plan” and “rearrange it for me.”
Grammar	2.0/5	There are several noticeable grammatical errors, including article use, tense, and sentence phrasing.
Tone	3.0/5	The email is polite overall, but a few expressions sound slightly unnatural or too direct for this context.
Total Score	18/30	Adequate task completion, but language accuracy and naturalness limit the score.

Revised Version (Words Count: 84)

Dear Course Assistant,

I hope you are doing well. I am writing because I missed the recent laboratory session due to an unexpected medical appointment.

I saw your announcement and would like to ask whether it would be possible for me to complete a make-up activity. I am available tomorrow evening or Friday afternoon, but I would also be happy to adjust to another time that works better for you.

I apologize for the inconvenience, and thank you for your understanding.

Best regards,
Baiming

My Notes:

make-up activity (“make up” is a verb phrase, “make-up” usually refers to remedial or supplementary academic work, and “makeup” most commonly means cosmetics or composition.)

I apologize for the inconvenience, and thank you for your understanding.

2 Office Hour Conflict

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

Your professor has invited students to visit her office hours before submitting the final essay. You would like to attend, but the regular office-hour time conflicts with another required class.

Task

Write an email to your professor. Explain the conflict, ask whether another meeting time is possible, and briefly describe what you want to discuss about your essay.

Your email should:

Use a respectful tone; state the scheduling problem; explain your academic purpose.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:52; Saved At: 2026/5/2 06:18:22; Word Count: 67)

Dear Professor:

Hope you're doing well!

I'm writing to express my request about rescheduling the meeting time of your office hour due to the confliction of required class. I would be available tomorrow and Friday night, but anytime works well with you is suitable for me. I would like to discuss me essay during the meeting, and I'm looking forward to your suggestions then.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 15/30

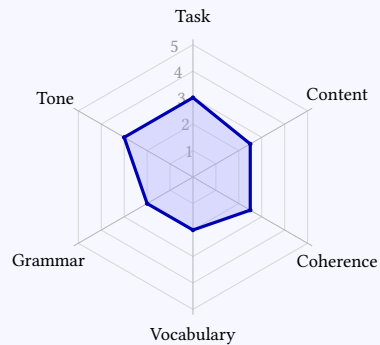
Overall Comment: This response is understandable and addresses the main requirements of the task. The writer explains that there is a schedule conflict, asks for another possible meeting time, and mentions the essay discussion. However, under a strict TOEFL-style standard, the score is limited because several expressions are unnatural or grammatically incorrect. The academic purpose is also too general, since the writer only says that they want to discuss the essay without explaining what part of the essay needs help. Overall, the message can be understood, but the language control is weak and the email does not sound fully natural or polished.

Major Problems

- (1) The opening "Hope you're doing well!" is understandable, but it is slightly too casual for an email to a professor. It should be replaced with "I hope you are doing well."
- (2) The phrase "express my request about rescheduling the meeting time of your office hour" is unnatural and wordy. It should be replaced with "ask whether it would be possible to meet at another time."
- (3) "Due to the confliction of required class" has both vocabulary and grammar problems. "Confliction" is not natural in this context, and "required class" needs an article. It should be replaced with "because the regular office-hour time conflicts with another required class."
- (4) The sentence "anytime works well with you is suitable for me" is grammatically incorrect. It should be replaced with "I would be happy to adjust to a time that is convenient for you."
- (5) "Discuss me essay" contains a basic pronoun error. "Me" should be changed to "my." A better replacement is "discuss my final essay."

- (6) The academic purpose is too vague. Instead of only saying “discuss my essay,” the writer should mention a specific purpose, such as “discuss the organization of my essay and whether my main argument is clear enough.”

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3/5	Add a clearer academic purpose, such as discussing the thesis, structure, or supporting examples of the final essay.
Content	2.5/5	Replace “discuss my essay” with a more specific goal, such as “discuss whether my main argument is clear enough.”
Coherence	2.5/5	Split the long main sentence into two shorter sentences: one for the schedule conflict and one for the meeting request.
Vocabulary	2/5	Replace “express my request” with “ask whether,” and replace “confliction” with “conflict.”
Grammar	2/5	Change “anytime works well with you is suitable for me” to “I would be happy to meet at a time that is convenient for you.”
Tone	3/5	Replace “Hope you’re doing well!” with the more formal sentence “I hope you are doing well.”
Total Score	15/30	Focus on correcting the unnatural phrases and adding one specific sentence about what part of the essay needs feedback.

Revised Version (Word Count: 89)

Dear Professor,

I hope you are doing well.

I am writing to ask whether it would be possible to meet at another time before the final essay is due. I would like to attend your office hours, but the regular time conflicts with another required class.

I am available tomorrow evening or Friday evening, but I would be happy to adjust to a time that is convenient for you. I would like to discuss the organization of my essay and whether my main argument is clear enough.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

I am available ..., but I would be happy to adjust to a time that is convenient for you. (use “a”)

If neither time works, I would be happy to meet at another time that is convenient for you. (use “another”)

Best: I would be happy to adjust to your schedule.

3 Volunteer Schedule Conflict

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

You signed up for a campus volunteer event this Saturday, but your group project meeting has just been rescheduled to the same time. The volunteer coordinator asked students to email if their availability changed.

Task

Write an email to the volunteer coordinator. Apologize for the change, explain the situation, and ask whether you can help at another time or in another role.

Your email should:

Be concise; show responsibility; propose a reasonable alternative.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:42; Overtime: 02:42; Saved At: 2026/5/2 06:54:27; Word Count: 98)

Dear Coordinator,

I hope you are doing well.

I'm writing to apologize due to the absence of the approaching campus volunteer event this Saturday. I'm really eager to serve others and enjoy the happiness of helping others, but my group project meeting has just been rescheduled to the same time. I couldn't miss it because I'm the leader. I wonder if I could change to another time or in another role which still remains vacant. Also I will be available at next event on next Sunday. I would be happy if that works for you!¹

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 19/30

Overall Comment: The email completes the basic task: it apologizes, explains the schedule conflict, and asks about helping at another time or in another role. However, several expressions are unnatural or grammatically incorrect, especially “apologize due to the absence,” “change to another time or in another role,” and “at next event on next Sunday.” The tone is polite, but the language control is not strong enough for a higher score. Under a strict TOEFL-style standard, this response would likely receive around **19/30**.

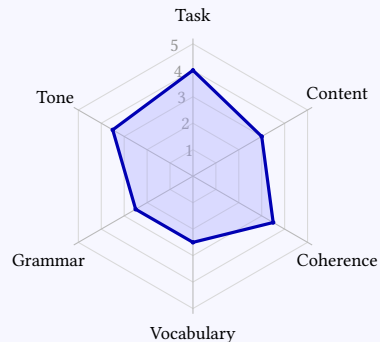
Major Problems

- (1) The phrase “apologize due to the absence” is incorrect. Use “apologize for my change in availability” or “apologize for not being able to attend.”
- (2) “The absence of the event” changes the meaning. It sounds like the event itself is absent or cancelled. The intended meaning is that the student cannot attend the event.
- (3) The sentence “serve others and enjoy the happiness of helping others” is too general and repetitive. A shorter sentence such as “I was looking forward to volunteering” is more natural.
- (4) “I couldn't miss it” should be changed to “I cannot miss it” because the project meeting is in the future.
- (5) “Change to another time or in another role” is grammatically incorrect. Use “help at another time or in another role.”

¹The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

- (6) “At next event on next Sunday” is incorrect because it needs an article and a better preposition. Use “for the next event next Sunday” or “next Sunday if extra help is needed.”

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	The response addresses the required points: it apologizes, explains the schedule conflict, and asks about another time or role. However, the proposed alternative is not very specific.
Content	3/5	The situation is clear, but some details are vague or unnecessary, especially the general sentence about enjoying helping others.
Coherence	3.5/5	The email follows a logical order, but the request would be clearer if the alternative time and alternative role were stated more directly.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Several word choices are unnatural, such as “absence of the event,” “approaching event,” and “remains vacant.”
Grammar	2.5/5	There are noticeable grammar problems, especially with prepositions, articles, and sentence structures such as “change to another time or in another role.”
Tone	3.5/5	The tone is polite and responsible, but some wording sounds too emotional or unnatural for a concise volunteer email.
Total Score	19/30	The email is understandable and completes the task, but language accuracy and naturalness limit the score.

Revised Version (Word Count: 92)

Dear Volunteer Coordinator,

I hope you are doing well.

I am writing to apologize for my change in availability for this Saturday’s campus volunteer event. I was looking forward to helping, but my group project meeting has just been rescheduled to the same time. Since I am the group leader, I need to attend that meeting.

If possible, could I help at another time or take another role that still needs volunteers? I would also be available next Sunday if extra help is needed.

Thank you for your understanding.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

I was looking forward to ..., but ...

Since ... (I am the group leader), I have to ... (attend that meeting).

4 Incorrect Presentation File

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

Your classmate sent you the wrong version of a presentation file for a group assignment. The deadline is tomorrow, and you need the correct file before you can finish your part.

Task

Write an email to your classmate. Explain the problem, ask for the correct file, and mention when you need it.

Your email should:

Be direct but polite; explain why the file matters; include a clear deadline.

Original Response (Time Used: 07:03; Overtime: +00:03; Saved At: 2026/5/11 07:15:16; Word Count: 64)

Dear Classmate,

Sorry to bother you, but you've sent me the incorrect version of presentation file. I can't finish my part of speech drafting if I didn't received the right file. Could you sent me the file as soon as possible before 7 p.m. tonight? I have to complete the task today because tomorrow is the deadline.

Looking forward to your reply!

Best,

Baiming²

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18.5/30

Overall Comment: This email completes the basic task: it explains that the file is wrong, asks for the correct file, and gives a clear deadline. However, several grammar and word-choice errors make the message sound unnatural. The meaning is still understandable, but the language control is not strong enough for a high TOEFL writing score. Under a strict TOEFL-style standard, this response would likely receive around **18.5/30**.

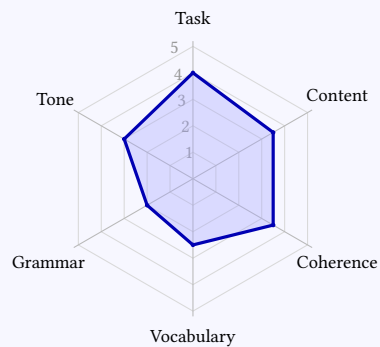
Major Problems

- (1) The greeting "Dear Classmate" is too general and unnatural. In a real email, use the person's name, such as "Dear [Name]" or "Hi [Name]".
- (2) "the incorrect version of presentation file" is missing an article. It should be "the wrong version of the presentation file".
- (3) "my part of speech drafting" is unnatural and unclear. Here, "speech" does not fit well. You should say "my part of the presentation" or "my section of the presentation script".
- (4) "if I didn't received" has two grammar problems. After "didn't," the verb should be the base form "receive." Also, because you are talking about a present/future condition, use "if I don't receive" or "unless I receive".

²The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

- (5) “Could you sent me” is incorrect because modal verbs such as “could” must be followed by the base verb. It should be “Could you send me”.
- (6) “as soon as possible before 7 p.m.” is redundant and awkward. If you have a clear deadline, use “by 7 p.m. tonight”.
- (7) “you’ve sent me” is understandable, but it may sound slightly accusatory. A softer version is “I think I received the wrong version”.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.0/5	The email includes the problem, the request, and the deadline. However, the greeting is unnatural and the explanation is somewhat rough.
Content	3.5/5	The key information is present, but the reason why the correct file matters could be expressed more clearly and naturally.
Coherence	3.5/5	The message follows a logical order: problem, consequence, request, deadline. Some sentences are weakened by grammar errors.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Several expressions are unnatural, especially “presentation file,” “part of speech drafting,” and “as soon as possible before 7 p.m.”
Grammar	2.0/5	There are clear grammar errors: “didn’t received,” “Could you sent,” and missing articles. These errors lower the score significantly.
Tone	3.0/5	The email is polite overall, but “you’ve sent me” may sound slightly accusatory. A softer phrase would be better.
Total Score	18.5/30	The task is completed, but grammar and word choice prevent the response from reaching a higher score.

Revised Version (Word Count: 70)

Dear [Name],

Sorry to bother you, but I think I received the wrong version of the presentation file. I need the updated file before I can finish drafting my part of the presentation, and the assignment is due tomorrow. Could you please send me the correct file by 7 p.m. tonight? That would give me enough time to complete and check my section.

Thanks for your help.

Best,

Baiming

My Notes:

I think I received the wrong version of ... (mild and euphemistic)
by 7 p.m. tonight (use “by” -> instead of “before”)

5 Research Assistant Interview (Rewritten)

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

You applied for a part-time research assistant position on campus. The professor in charge has asked applicants to send a short email explaining their interest and availability for an interview.

Task

Write an email to the professor. State your interest in the position, briefly mention a relevant skill or experience, and provide your availability for an interview.

Your email should:

Sound professional; connect your background to the position; list specific available times.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:22; Overtime: +02:22; Saved At: 2026/5/12 00:50:48; Word Count: 89)

Dear professor,

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm writing to express my interest in taking the part-time research assistant position on campus. Having the experience of assisting scientific research in my group for two years, I really excel at not only doing research under the supervision of the leader, but also dividing tasks and arrange other participants to work together.

I'll be available tomorrow night and Friday night for the interview, but I would also like to adjust to another time that works for you.

Best regards,

Baiming³

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Overall Comment:

The response addresses the basic task: it states interest in the research assistant position, mentions research-related experience, and gives some availability. However, under a strict TOEFL-style standard, the response is weakened by vague time expressions, several unnatural phrases, and one long sentence with grammar and parallel-structure problems. Also, the closing was written after the seven-minute limit, so the timed version feels incomplete. The message is understandable and polite, but it is not yet fully professional or language-controlled.

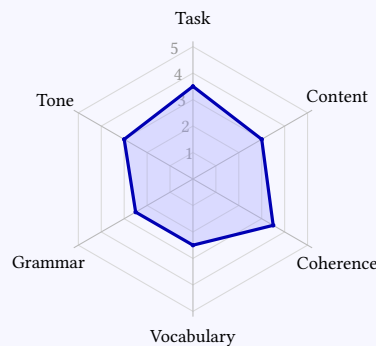
Major Problems

- (1) The salutation should be more professional. "Dear professor" should be changed to "Dear Professor," or, if the name is known, "Dear Professor Smith,". In English, a title used as a form of address should be capitalized.
- (2) The phrase "taking the part-time research assistant position" is unnatural. A student usually says "applying for," "being considered for," or "joining your research group as" a research assistant. "Taking the position" sounds as if the position has already been offered.
- (3) The sentence beginning with "Having the experience" is too long and contains several language problems. It should be simplified into one or two clearer sentences.

³The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

- (4) “I really excel at” sounds too strong and slightly boastful for a professional email. A better expression is “I have gained experience in” or “I am comfortable with.”
- (5) “the supervision of the leader” is unnatural. In an academic context, use “under a supervisor’s guidance,” “under my research advisor’s supervision,” or “as part of a research team.”
- (6) “dividing tasks and arrange other participants” has a parallel-structure error. Since “dividing” is a gerund, “arrange” should be changed to “arranging.” However, “arranging other participants to work together” is still unnatural; “coordinating teamwork” is better.
- (7) “tomorrow night and Friday night” is not specific enough. The prompt asks for specific available times, so the answer should give exact time windows, such as “Wednesday from 7:00 to 9:00 p.m.” and “Friday from 6:00 to 8:00 p.m.”
- (8) “I would also like to adjust to another time that works for you” is understandable but unnatural. A more natural version is “I would be happy to adjust to your schedule” or “I would be happy to meet at another time that is convenient for you.”

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3.5/5	The response covers interest, experience, and availability, but the available times are too vague. The closing was written after the time limit, so the timed version feels unfinished.
Content	3.0/5	The experience is relevant, but it is described too generally. The email does not mention a concrete research skill such as data analysis, literature review, coding, lab work, or report writing.
Coherence	3.5/5	The structure is basically clear: greeting, interest, experience, availability. However, the main experience sentence is too long, which makes the logic less smooth.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Several expressions are unnatural, including “taking the position,” “Having the experience,” “the leader,” and “adjust to another time.” These phrases reduce professionalism.
Grammar	2.5/5	There are noticeable grammar problems, especially the parallel-structure error in “dividing tasks and arrange.” The long sentence also creates awkward grammar.
Tone	3.0/5	The tone is polite overall, but “I really excel at” sounds a little too self-promotional. The salutation should also be more formal.
Total Score	18/30	Understandable and task-relevant, but limited by vague details, unnatural wording, and grammar control problems.

Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
Dear professor	The title should be capitalized when used as direct address.	Dear Professor,
taking the part-time research assistant position	“Taking” suggests that the position has already been offered.	being considered for the part-time research assistant position
Having the experience of assisting scientific research	Wordy and unnatural.	I have spent the past two years assisting with research
I really excel at	Too strong and slightly informal.	I have gained experience in
under the supervision of the leader	“Leader” is not natural in this academic context.	under my supervisor’s guidance
dividing tasks and arrange other participants	Parallel-structure error: “dividing” and “arrange” do not match.	organizing tasks and coordinating teamwork
tomorrow night and Friday night	Too vague for the prompt.	Wednesday from 7:00 to 9:00 p.m. and Friday from 6:00 to 8:00 p.m.
adjust to another time that works for you	Understandable but unnatural.	meet at another time that is convenient for you

Revised Version (Word Count: 111)

Dear Professor,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to express my continued interest in the part-time research assistant position on campus. I have spent the past two years assisting with research in my academic group, where I gained experience collecting data, organizing tasks, and working under a supervisor’s guidance. I believe this background would allow me to contribute responsibly to your project.

I would be available for an interview on Wednesday from 7:00 to 9:00 p.m. or on Friday from 6:00 to 8:00 p.m. If neither time is convenient, I would be happy to adjust to your schedule.

Best regards,
Baiming

My Notes:

my continued interest in sth.

where I gained experience doing sth.

If neither time is convenient, I would be happy to adjust to your schedule.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 06:54; Saved At: 2026/5/12 01:35:13; Word Count: 76)

Dear Professor,

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm writing to apply for the part-time research assistant position, for I have been assisting my academic group for two years. I gained a lot experiences there, including data analysing, task dividing and teamwork spirit. I believe that this background would allow me to be capable of this position.

I will be available tomorrow night, but I would like to adjust to your schedule.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

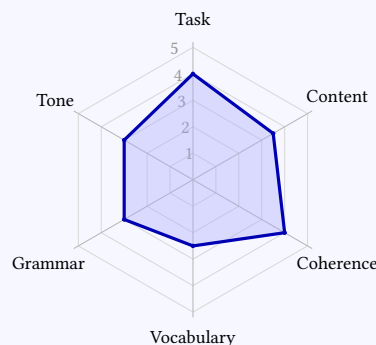
Overall Comment:

This response completes the main task: it states interest in the research assistant position, mentions relevant research experience, and provides availability for an interview. The organization is clear and the tone is generally polite. However, several expressions are unnatural or grammatically incorrect, such as “a lot experiences,” “data analysing,” “task dividing,” “teamwork spirit,” and “be capable of this position.” In addition, “tomorrow night” is too vague because the prompt asks for specific available times. Under a strict TOEFL-style standard, this response is understandable and task-relevant, but the language control is not strong enough for a higher score.

Major Problems

- (1) “for I have been assisting my academic group for two years” is grammatically possible, but it sounds too formal and slightly unnatural in a student email. “because” or “since” would be more natural.
- (2) “assisting my academic group” is incomplete in meaning. You should say “assisting with research in my academic group” because you assist with a task, not simply assist a group.
- (3) “a lot experiences” is incorrect. “Experience” is usually uncountable when referring to general background, so it should be “a lot of experience” or simply “experience.”
- (4) “data analysing” is unnatural. The standard noun phrase is “data analysis,” while the verb phrase is “analyzing data.”
- (5) “task dividing” is not idiomatic. Use “task organization,” “dividing tasks,” or “coordinating tasks.”
- (6) “teamwork spirit” is a Chinese-style expression. In English, use “teamwork,” “collaboration,” or “communication skills.”
- (7) “be capable of this position” is an incorrect collocation. A person is “qualified for a position” or “capable of handling the responsibilities of a position.”
- (8) “tomorrow night” is too vague. TOEFL prompts usually expect specific available times, such as “Wednesday from 7:00 to 9:00 p.m.”
- (9) “I would like to adjust to your schedule” is understandable, but the tone is slightly less natural. “I would be happy to adjust to your schedule” is more polite and professional.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.0/5	The response answers all three requirements: interest, relevant background, and interview availability. However, the availability is not specific enough.
Content	3.5/5	The research background is relevant, but the skills are listed in an awkward way. More concrete skills, such as data analysis, literature review, or programming, would be stronger.
Coherence	4.0/5	The structure is clear and easy to follow: greeting, purpose, background, availability, closing. The logic is straightforward.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Several phrases are unnatural, especially “data analysing,” “task dividing,” “teamwork spirit,” and “capable of this position.”
Grammar	3.0/5	The grammar is understandable, but there are errors with countability, collocation, and word form. “A lot experiences” is the most obvious grammar problem.
Tone	3.0/5	The tone is polite, but some wording sounds slightly unnatural or not fully professional. “I would be happy to adjust” would sound better than “I would like to adjust.”
Total Score	20/30	Clear and complete, but limited by unnatural expressions, vague availability, and several grammar/collocation problems.

Revised Version (Word Count: 101)

Dear Professor,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to apply for the part-time research assistant position. I have spent the past two years assisting with research in my academic group, where I gained experience in data analysis, task organization, and collaboration. I believe this background would allow me to contribute effectively to your project.

I am available for an interview tomorrow from 7:00 to 9:00 p.m. If that time is not convenient, I would be happy to adjust to your schedule.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

I have spent the past two years doing ..., where I gained experience in ...

I believe this background would allow me to contribute effectively to your project.

6 Library Book Renewal

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

You borrowed a book from the university library, but you need a few more days to finish using it for your paper. The online system does not allow you to renew it automatically.

Task

Write an email to the library staff. Explain why you need the book, ask whether a short extension is possible, and offer to return it immediately if another student has requested it.

Your email should:

Be polite; explain the academic need; show that you understand library rules.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:54; Saved At: 2026/5/12 16:38:38; Word Count: 103)

Dear Staff,

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm writing to ask if I can keep the book 'Engineering Mechanics' which is borrowed from the university library a few days more. Since I've borrowed this for a week, which meets the limitation of returning deadline, I still need it for two days more to assist finishing my ongoing paper. I apologize for the inconvenience, but I couldn't complete my paper without this. I'd be really grateful if this short extension is permitted, and I would return this book immediately whenever other students request it.

Thank you for your understanding.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 22/30

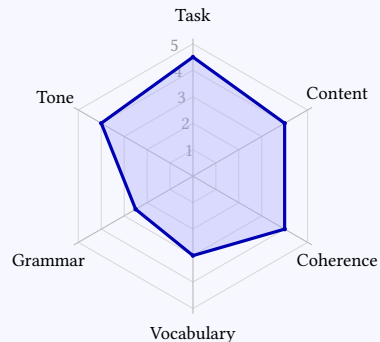
Overall Comment: The response completes the main task: it explains the need for the book, asks for a short extension, and offers to return the book if another student needs it. The tone is generally polite and appropriate for an email to library staff. However, several grammar errors and unnatural phrases make the email sound less fluent. The main problem is not content, but accuracy and naturalness of expression. With cleaner grammar and more precise wording, this response could reach a much higher score.

Major Problems

- (1) The phrase "which is borrowed from the university library" is grammatically unnatural. Since the writer borrowed the book, it should be changed to "that I borrowed from the university library."
- (2) "a few days more" is understandable but unnatural. A native-like expression is "for a few more days."
- (3) "Since I've borrowed this for a week, which meets the limitation of returning deadline" is unclear and grammatically incorrect. It should be rewritten as "Although the book is due soon" or "Although I have already had the book for a week."
- (4) "assist finishing my ongoing paper" is unnatural. The correct expression is "help me finish my paper" or "help with my paper."
- (5) "I couldn't complete my paper without this" is too absolute and slightly informal. A better version is "It would be difficult for me to complete the paper without consulting this book."

- (6) “whenever other students request it” is not precise enough. Since the task says another student may have requested it, the better wording is “if another student has requested it.”

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.5/5	The email addresses all required points: the academic need, the request for a short extension, and the offer to return the book if another student needs it. The only missing detail is that the online renewal system failed, which appears in the prompt but not clearly in the response.
Content	4.0/5	The reason is relevant and specific enough: the book is needed for a paper. However, the explanation could be stronger by mentioning that the book is a key source or that specific sections still need to be checked.
Coherence	4.0/5	The email has a clear structure: greeting, request, reason, condition, thanks, and closing. However, the long second paragraph contains too many ideas in one sentence, which weakens readability.
Vocabulary	3.0/5	Some word choices are understandable but unnatural, such as “a few days more,” “limitation of returning deadline,” and “assist finishing.” These should be replaced with more standard expressions.
Grammar	2.5/5	Several grammar errors affect fluency, especially “which is borrowed,” “Since I’ve borrowed this for a week,” and “meets the limitation of returning deadline.” The meaning is still clear, but the sentence accuracy is below a high-score level.
Tone	4.0/5	The tone is polite and respectful. However, “Dear Staff” is slightly unnatural; “Dear Library Staff” is better. Also, “I couldn’t complete my paper without this” sounds a little too absolute.
Total Score	22/30	The response is complete and polite, but grammar and unnatural phrasing prevent it from reaching the 25+ range.

Specific Corrections

1. “keep the book ‘Engineering Mechanics’ which is borrowed from the university library a few days more”

Problem: There are three problems here. First, the book title should be in quotation marks or italicized. Second, “which is borrowed” is wrong because the writer borrowed the book. Third, “a few days more” is not natural.

Better:

keep the book *Engineering Mechanics*, which I borrowed from the university library, for a few more days

2. “Since I’ve borrowed this for a week, which meets the limitation of returning deadline”

Problem: This sentence is grammatically incorrect and unclear. “Borrowed this for a week” does not naturally mean that the due date has arrived. “Meets the limitation of returning deadline” is not an English expression.

Better:

Although the book is due soon, I still need it for two more days to finish my paper.

3. “assist finishing my ongoing paper”

Problem: “Assist finishing” is unnatural. Also, “ongoing paper” is not the best expression here.

Better:

help me finish my paper

or

help with my course paper

4. “I couldn’t complete my paper without this”

Problem: The meaning is clear, but the wording is too absolute and “this” is vague. In a polite academic email, it is better to sound reasonable rather than dramatic.

Better:

It would be difficult for me to complete the paper without consulting this book.

5. “whenever other students request it”

Problem: “Whenever” means “at any time when,” but the task asks about the specific case where another student has already requested the book.

Better:

if another student has requested it

Revised Version (Word Count: 130)

Dear Library Staff,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to ask whether it would be possible to renew my borrowed copy of *Engineering Mechanics* for two additional days. I am currently using this book as a key source for a course paper, and I still need to check several sections before finishing my final draft. I tried to renew it through the online library system, but the system did not allow an automatic renewal.

I understand that library rules are designed to make books available to all students. Therefore, if another student has requested this book, I will return it immediately. If there is no pending request, I would be very grateful for a short extension.

Thank you very much for your help.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

I am writing to ask whether it would be possible to ...

It would be difficult for me to complete the paper without consulting this book.

using ... as a key source for ...

7 Student Club Information

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

You are interested in joining a student club, but you missed the information session because of a class conflict. The club president invited interested students to email questions.

Task

Write an email to the club president. Introduce yourself, explain that you missed the session, and ask about membership requirements and upcoming activities.

Your email should:

Use a friendly tone; ask specific questions; show genuine interest.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:55; Saved At: 2026/5/14 16:30:37; Word Count: 85)

Dear President,

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm Baiming, a freshmen student majoring in computer science. I really eager to join the student club which is also related to computer. Unfortunately, I was absent at the information publication meeting due to the class conflict. I'm writing to inquire if the club is still recruiting new members, and what should I do as an applicant - I've already send you my CV.

Also, is there any approaching activities may I attend?

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 19/30

Overall Comment: The email responds to the main situation and includes a friendly opening, a self-introduction, an explanation for missing the session, and questions about joining the club. However, the response loses points because several sentences contain clear grammar errors, some wording is unnatural, and the questions are not specific enough. The reader can understand the message, but the language does not yet sound fluent or fully appropriate for a high-scoring TOEFL response.

Major Problems

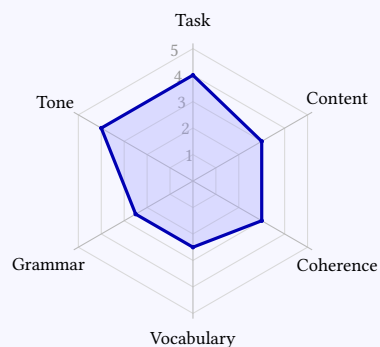
- (1) The task requirement about "membership requirements" is only partly answered. Asking whether the club is still recruiting is useful, but you should also ask directly about eligibility, application steps, deadlines, fees, interviews, or required experience.
- (2) Several grammar errors affect clarity, especially "a freshmen student," "I really eager," "I've already send," and the final question word order.
- (3) Some expressions are unnatural or inaccurate, such as "information publication meeting," "absent at," "related to computer," and "approaching activities."
- (4) The tone is basically polite, but "Dear President" sounds too general. "Dear Club President" or "Dear President of the Computer Science Club" would be more natural if you do not know the person's name.

- (5) The email shows interest, but the interest is too general. A stronger version should briefly explain why you are interested in the club, such as programming, projects, workshops, competitions, or meeting students with similar interests.

Detailed Error Analysis

Original Expression	Suggested Revision	Reason
Dear President	Dear Club President	“President” alone is too vague. Since this is a student club context, “Club President” is clearer and more natural.
a freshmen student	a freshman student / a first-year student	“Freshmen” is plural. For one person, use “freshman” or the more neutral phrase “first-year student.”
I really eager to join	I am really eager to join	“Eager” is an adjective, so it needs the verb “am.”
the student club which is also related to computer	your computer science club / your computer-related club	“Related to computer” is not idiomatic. Use “computer science club” if that is the club type.
I was absent at the information publication meeting	I could not attend the information session	“Absent at” is unnatural here. TOEFL email language should be simple and natural. “Information session” is the correct phrase.
due to the class conflict	because of a class conflict	“The class conflict” is possible only if the conflict has already been identified. Here, “a class conflict” is more natural.
what should I do as an applicant	what the application process is	In an indirect question after “inquire,” use statement word order. The revised version is also more specific.
I’ve already send you my CV	I have already sent you my CV	Present perfect requires the past participle “sent,” not the base form “send.”
is there any approaching activities may I attend	are there any upcoming activities that I may attend	“Activities” is plural, so use “are.” “Upcoming activities” is natural; “approaching activities” is not. The relative clause needs “that I may attend.”

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	You address the main situation, introduce yourself, explain the missed session, and ask about joining. However, the requirement about membership requirements is not specific enough.
Content	3/5	The content is relevant, but the email needs more concrete questions about application steps, eligibility, deadlines, and activities. The interest in the club should also be explained more clearly.
Coherence	3/5	The email has a basic structure, but the long middle sentence contains several ideas at once. Splitting it into shorter sentences would make the logic clearer.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Some vocabulary choices are understandable but unnatural, such as “information publication meeting,” “related to computer,” and “approaching activities.”
Grammar	2.5/5	Grammar errors are frequent and visible. The most serious problems are adjective usage, singular/plural form, verb tense, and indirect-question word order.
Tone	4/5	The tone is polite and friendly. However, “Dear President” is too general, and the email would sound more natural with a more precise greeting and closing thanks.
Total Score	19/30	The message is understandable and mostly complete, but grammar accuracy and specificity prevent it from reaching the high-score range.

Revised Version (Word Count: 122)

Dear Club President,

I hope you are doing well.

My name is Baiming, and I am a first-year computer science student. I am very interested in joining your computer science club because I would like to meet students who enjoy programming and learn more about projects outside class. Unfortunately, I could not attend the information session because it conflicted with one of my required classes.

Could you please let me know whether the club is still accepting new members? I would also appreciate information about the membership requirements, the application process, and any documents I should submit. In addition, are there any upcoming meetings, workshops, or activities that new students can attend?

Thank you very much for your time.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

Detail!! I would also appreciate information about the membership requirements, the application process, and any documents I should submit.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 06:51; Saved At: 2026/5/14 16:58:16; Word Count: 83)

Dear Club President,

Hope this email finds you well.

I'm Baiming, a freshman student majoring in computer science. Because I couldn't attend the information publication conference due to a class conflict, I'm writing to inquire some details about the club. Since

I have sent you my application, I wonder what else should I do - is there any complement document required? Also, I'm curious about some approaching activities, such as the carnival which breaks ice between new members next Sunday.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 23/30

Overall Comment: This response completes the main task: you introduce yourself, explain why you missed the information session, ask about the next application step, and mention upcoming activities. The tone is friendly and the content is more specific than before. However, several expressions are unnatural or incorrect, especially “information publication conference,” “inquire some details,” “complement document,” and “approaching activities.” These errors do not prevent understanding, but they make the email sound less fluent and less natural.

Major Problems

- (1) The phrase “information publication conference” is unnatural. The correct TOEFL-style expression is “information session.”
- (2) “Inquire some details” is grammatically wrong because “inquire” usually needs “about.” A better phrase is “ask about some details.”
- (3) “What else should I do” should be changed to “what else I should do” in an indirect question.
- (4) “Complement document” is incorrect. Use “additional document,” “supplementary document,” or “supporting document.”
- (5) “Approaching activities” is not idiomatic. Use “upcoming activities.”
- (6) “Carnival which breaks ice between new members” is unnatural. Use “an icebreaker event for new members.”

Detailed Evaluation

Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.5/5	You cover almost all required points: self-introduction, missed session, application questions, and activities. The membership requirement question could be more direct.
Content	4/5	The content is relevant and specific. Mentioning the icebreaker event is good, but the sentence should be expressed more naturally.
Coherence	4/5	The email is logically organized, but the long middle sentence should be divided into shorter sentences.
Vocabulary	3.5/5	Several word choices are unnatural, especially “publication conference,” “complement document,” and “approaching activities.”
Grammar	3.5/5	The grammar is understandable but still has clear errors in indirect-question order, noun form, and preposition use.
Tone	4/5	The tone is friendly and polite. It would be stronger with a brief thank-you sentence before the closing.
Total Score	23/30	A good response with complete content, but vocabulary and grammar problems prevent it from reaching the 26–30 range.

Detailed Error Analysis

Original Expression	Suggested Revision	Reason
Hope this email finds you well.	I hope this email finds you well.	In a formal or semi-formal email, the subject "I" should not be omitted.
information publication conference	information session	"Information session" is the natural phrase for a club introduction meeting.
Because I couldn't attend ... due to a class conflict	I could not attend ... because of a class conflict	"Because" and "due to" are repetitive in the same sentence. Use one clear cause expression.
Since I have sent you my application	Since I have already submitted my application	"Submitted my application" sounds more natural than "sent you my application."
I wonder what else should I do	I wonder what else I should do	This is an indirect question, so it should use statement word order.
is there any complement document required?	are there any additional documents required?	"Document" should be plural after "any" in this context. "Complement document" is not natural English.
the carnival which breaks ice between new members	the icebreaker event for new members	"Break the ice" is an idiom, but here the noun form "icebreaker event" is much more natural.

Full-score Version (Word Count: 127)

Dear Club President,

I hope this email finds you well.

My name is Baiming, and I am a freshman majoring in computer science. I am very interested in joining your club because I hope to meet students with similar interests and take part in projects related to programming and technology. Unfortunately, I was not able to attend the introductory meeting because I had a class at the same time.

Since I have already submitted my application, could you please let me know what other steps I should complete before becoming a member? I would also appreciate it if you could tell me whether any supporting documents are required. Could you also let me know about events planned for new students, especially whether applicants may attend the icebreaker event next Sunday?

Thank you very much for your time and help. I look forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

As teacher said in 5.12, "Why don't you use some phrases instead of just copying the text from questions?"
class conflict -> had a class at the same time; the information session -> the introductory meeting

Since you haven't been a member, you should ask "whether applicants may attend the icebreaker event next Sunday" instead of "the carnival which breaks ice between new members next Sunday"

Since I have already ..., could you please let me know what other steps I should complete before ...

I would like -> I hope to ...; could you please let me know ...; I would also appreciate it if ...; Could you also let me know ...

8 International Student Orientation Volunteering

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

Your university is organizing an international student orientation, and you would like to ask whether domestic students can volunteer as peer mentors.

Task

Write an email to the orientation office. Introduce yourself, explain why you are interested in volunteering, and ask about the application process.

Your email should:

Be clear about your purpose; give one relevant reason; ask for next steps.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:39; Overtime: +02:39; Saved At: 2026/5/15 17:33:55; Word Count: 105)

Dear Orientation Officer,

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm Baiming, a freshman student majoring in international communication. I'm willing to take participate in the volunteering of the international student orientation, through which I can not only make new foreign friends, but also deepen my understanding of my own major. So I'm writing to require some information of application. I'll be really appreciated if you could tell me the detailed steps to register. Also, I'm worried if domestic students were allowed to volunteer as peer mentors. If any implement document was needed, please let me know.

Thanks for your precious time!

Best regards,

Baiming⁴

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 16/30

Overall Comment: The response addresses the general purpose of the email, but under strict timed conditions it is incomplete because the key question about whether local/domestic students can serve as mentors appears only in the gray overtime section and even begins as an unfinished word. The email is polite and mostly understandable, but several expressions are unnatural or grammatically incorrect. The main problems are inaccurate verb choices, awkward noun phrases, and an unclear reason for volunteering. If the overtime text were counted, the response would be closer to 18/30, but the official timed version should be scored lower.

Major Problems

- (1) The most important question, whether domestic students are allowed to volunteer as peer mentors, was not completed within the seven-minute limit. The timed answer ends with “domes”, which makes the final part look unfinished.
- (2) Several phrases are grammatically incorrect, such as “take participate in”, “require some information of application”, and “I’ll be really appreciated”.
- (3) The reason for volunteering is not strong enough. “Make new foreign friends” sounds too casual and slightly inappropriate for a formal university email. It should be changed to a more academic or service-oriented reason.

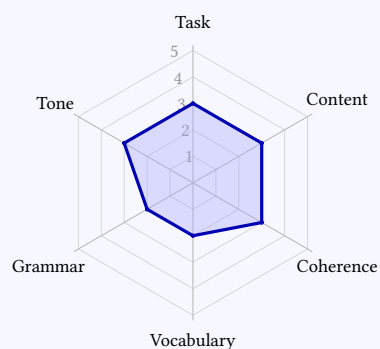
⁴The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

- (4) The email asks for application information, but it does not clearly ask for all next steps, such as eligibility, requirements, deadline, and required forms.
- (5) The tone is polite, but some word choices are unnatural or too direct, especially “require”, which sounds demanding rather than polite.

Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I'm Baiming a freshman student	Too casual for a formal email. Understandable, but “first-year student” is more formal and widely accepted.	My name is Baiming Zhang. a first-year student
I'm willing to take participate in the volunteering of the international student orientation make new foreign friends	Grammatically wrong. “Take participate” is not a valid phrase. Awkward noun phrase. Too casual; “foreign” can sound distant or impolite in this context.	I am interested in volunteering for the international student orientation program support students from abroad / help new international students adjust
deepen my understanding of my own major	Vague. It does not explain clearly how the volunteer work connects to the major.	apply what I have learned about cross-cultural communication
I'm writing to require some information of application	“Require” sounds too forceful, and “information of application” is unnatural.	I am writing to ask about the application process.
I'll be really appreciated if	Wrong subject. A person cannot be “appreciated” in this structure.	I would really appreciate it if
I'm worried if domestic students were allowed implement document	Wrong wording and tense. “Worried if” is not suitable here. Wrong word choice.	I was wondering whether local students are eligible. supporting documents / required forms
Thanks for your precious time	“Precious time” sounds unnatural in this email.	Thank you for your time.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3/5	The general purpose is clear, but the key eligibility question is not completed within the time limit.
Content	3/5	The email includes identity, interest, and an application request, but the reason is weak and too casual.
Coherence	3/5	The message is understandable, but several ideas are placed in one long paragraph, making the logic less clean.
Vocabulary	2/5	Some word choices are inaccurate, such as “require”, “foreign friends”, and “implement document”.
Grammar	2/5	There are several noticeable errors, including “take participate in”, “I’ll be appreciated”, and tense problems.
Tone	3/5	The email is polite overall, but some expressions are either too casual or too forceful for an office email.
Total Score	16/30	This is understandable but incomplete under timed conditions. Accuracy and task completion need improvement.

Revised Version (Word Count: 121)

Dear Orientation Office,

My name is Baiming Zhang, and I am a first-year student majoring in International Communication. I recently learned about the upcoming welcome program for students arriving from abroad, and I am interested in helping as a student mentor. Because my major focuses on cross-cultural communication, I believe this role would give me a meaningful chance to support new students while improving my ability to communicate with people from different backgrounds.

Could you please let me know whether local undergraduate students are eligible to serve in this role? If so, I would be grateful if you could send me the application requirements, deadline, and any forms I need to submit.

Thank you for your time.

Best regards,
Baiming Zhang

My Notes:

If so, I would be grateful if you could ...

Because ..., I believe this role would give me a meaningful chance to ... while improving my ability to
be eligible to (more formal) = be allowed to

9 Incorrect Workshop Registration Name (Rewritten)

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

You registered for an academic workshop, but you realized that the confirmation email lists your name incorrectly. You need the certificate to show your correct name.

Task

Write an email to the workshop organizer. Explain the mistake, give the correct spelling of your name, and ask whether the certificate information can be updated.

Your email should:

Be precise; include the correct information; make a polite request.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:49; Saved At: 2026/5/15 18:07:58; Word Count: 98)

Dear Workshop Organizer,

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm writing to revise my incorrect name in the confirmation email of your academic workshop. The name was mistakenly spelled as "Baimin" while my real name is "Baiming" with a extra "g" at the last letter. I understand that my Chinese name is not as popular as some English name, so it's not really a big deal. Could you please let me know when will the certificate information be renewed, in case of that I couldn't log in this workshop later.

Thanks for your time.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Overall Comment: This response completes the basic task: it explains that the registered name is incorrect, gives the correct spelling, and asks about updating the certificate information. It is also finished within the seven-minute time limit, which is a clear improvement. However, the language is still not smooth enough for a high score. Several expressions are unnatural or grammatically incorrect, and the final sentence combines two different concerns: certificate information and workshop login. A stronger answer should be more direct, more precise, and more professional.

Major Problems

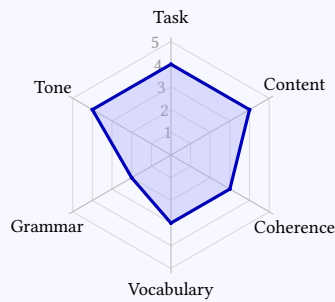
- (1) The request is not direct enough. Instead of asking "when will the certificate information be renewed," you should ask whether the organizer could update your registration and certificate information.
- (2) Some word choices are inaccurate. For example, "revise my incorrect name" and "renewed" are not natural for correcting registration information.
- (3) The sentence about your Chinese name is unnecessary. It makes the email less concise and may sound too casual.
- (4) The last sentence is unclear because certificate information and workshop login are different issues. If you are worried about both, they should be separated.
- (5) Several grammar errors reduce the score, including article mistakes, indirect-question word order, and incorrect phrases such as "in case of that."

Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I'm writing to revise my incorrect name	"Revise" means to edit a text, not usually to correct registration information.	I am writing to ask whether my name can be corrected in the workshop records.
the confirmation email of your academic workshop	Unnatural phrase order.	the confirmation email for the academic workshop
The name was mistakenly spelled as "Baimin"	Understandable, but slightly wordy.	My name was listed as "Baimin."
my real name is "Baiming"	"Real name" sounds informal here. You need the official/correct spelling.	the correct spelling is "Baiming"
with a extra "g"	Article error. "Extra" begins with a vowel sound, so it needs "an."	with an additional "g"
at the last letter	Unnatural. The "g" is the final letter, not "at" the final letter.	at the end / as the final letter
my Chinese name is not as popular as some English name	Unnecessary and awkward. "Some English name" should be plural or more specific.	This sentence can be deleted.
it's not really a big deal	Too casual for a formal request. It may weaken the importance of the certificate correction.	Since the certificate needs to show my correct name, I would appreciate your help.
when will the certificate information be renewed	Wrong word order in an indirect question; "renewed" is the wrong verb.	whether the certificate information can be updated
in case of that I couldn't log in this workshop later	Grammatically incorrect and logically unclear.	If this mistake could also affect my workshop access, please let me know.
Thanks for your time	Acceptable, but slightly simple.	Thank you for your time and assistance.

Detailed Evaluation

Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	The required information is included, but the request for updating the certificate is not direct enough.
Content	4/5	The incorrect and correct names are clear, but the explanation about Chinese names is unnecessary.
Coherence	3/5	The email is understandable, but the final sentence mixes certificate correction with workshop login.
Vocabulary	3/5	Some words are inaccurate, especially "revise," "renewed," and "real name."
Grammar	2/5	Several errors appear in articles, word order, and sentence structure.
Tone	4/5	The tone is polite, but "not really a big deal" is too casual for this situation.
Total Score	20/30	The task is complete, but grammar and wording prevent it from reaching a high score.



Revised Version (Word Count: 130)

Dear Workshop Organizer,

My name is Baiming Zhang, and I recently registered for the upcoming academic workshop. I am writing because the confirmation email lists my name as "Baimin," but the correct spelling is "Baiming Zhang," with the final letter "g" included. Since the workshop certificate will be used for my academic records, I would like to make sure that my name appears correctly on all official materials.

Could you please update my registration information and the certificate record before the certificate is issued? If you need any proof of identity, registration number, or additional form from me, I would be happy to provide it as soon as possible. I apologize for the inconvenience caused by this correction request.

Thank you for your time and assistance.

Best regards,
Baiming Zhang

My Notes:

Renew: To extend the period of validity of something; To resume or repeat something

Update: correct, amend, modify

If you need any proof of identity, registration number, or additional form from me, I would be happy to provide it as soon as possible.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 06:53; Saved At: 2026/5/15 19:15:42; Word Count: 120)

Dear Workshop Organizer,

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm Baiming, and recently I've registered for an upcoming academic workshop. Sadly, I found my name was spelled mistakenly as "Baimin", while the correct name is "Baiming" with a extra "g" at the last letter. I understand this name is not so popular as other names, so it's not a big deal.

I will really appreciate it if you could revise my name before the certificate was made. It means a lot to me. Also, I couldn't sign in the website if the name hasn't been updated. Could you please let me know as soon as possible when you amend it.

Thanks for your time and assistant.

Best regards,
Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

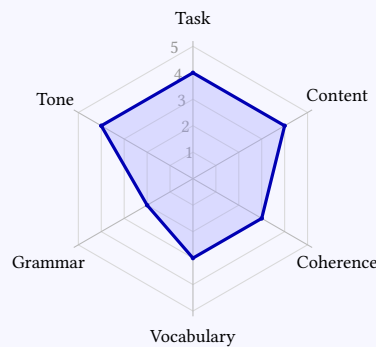
Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Overall Comment: This response completes the task and gives the incorrect name, the correct spelling, and a clear request to correct the certificate information. It is also finished within the time limit and reaches a more appropriate word count than the previous version. However, the response still contains several grammar and word-choice problems. Some expressions sound too casual or unnecessary, such as “Sadly” and “it’s not a big deal.” The final request is understandable, but it should be more concise and professional.

Major Problems

- (1) Some expressions are too casual for a formal email, especially “Sadly” and “it’s not a big deal.”
- (2) Several phrases are grammatically incorrect, such as “with a extra ‘g,’” “before the certificate was made,” and “Thanks for your time and assistant.”
- (3) The verb “revise” is not the best choice here. You are asking the organizer to correct or update your name, not revise a piece of writing.
- (4) The sentence about the name being unpopular is unnecessary. It does not help complete the task and weakens the professional tone.
- (5) The last sentence is unclear. “Could you please let me know as soon as possible when you amend it” should be rewritten as a polite request for confirmation.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	The email answers the prompt and includes the incorrect name, correct name, and correction request.
Content	4/5	The main information is clear, but the sentence about the name being uncommon is unnecessary.
Coherence	3/5	The structure is understandable, but the second paragraph combines several requests too loosely.
Vocabulary	3/5	Some words are suitable, but “revise,” “amend,” and “assistant” are inaccurate in context.
Grammar	2/5	Frequent errors in articles, tense, prepositions, and sentence structure lower the score.
Tone	4/5	The email is polite overall, but “Sadly” and “not a big deal” are not ideal for formal writing.
Total Score	20/30	The task is complete, but grammar and expression accuracy still limit the score.

Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I'm Baiming	Too casual for a formal email.	My name is Baiming Zhang.
recently I've registered	The present perfect is possible, but the word order sounds less natural here.	I recently registered
Sadly, I found	"Sadly" is too emotional for this simple administrative issue.	I noticed that
my name was spelled mistakenly as	Understandable, but unnatural word order.	my name was mistakenly spelled as
with a extra "g"	Article error. "Extra" begins with a vowel sound, so it should be "an."	with an extra "g"
at the last letter	Unnatural. A letter is not usually described as being "at the last letter."	at the end / as the final letter
this name is not so popular as other names	Unnecessary and awkward. It also sounds too personal for this task.	Delete this sentence.
it's not a big deal	Too casual and weakens your request. The certificate name is important.	Since the certificate needs to show my correct name, I would appreciate your help.
I will really appreciate it if you could	Mixed tense/modal. "Would appreciate it if you could" is the standard polite form.	I would really appreciate it if you could
revise my name	"Revise" is usually used for writing, essays, or documents.	correct my name / update my name
before the certificate was made	Wrong tense. The certificate has not been made yet, so use present passive or "issued."	before the certificate is issued
sign in the website	Wrong preposition.	sign in to the website
when you amend it	"Amend" is formal but slightly legal/document-heavy here. Also the sentence needs punctuation.	once the correction has been made
Thanks for your time and assistant	"Assistant" means a person who helps. The noun you need is "assistance."	Thank you for your time and assistance.

Revised Version (Word Count: 130)

Dear Workshop Organizer,

My name is Baiming Zhang, and I recently registered for the upcoming academic workshop. I am writing because the confirmation email lists my name as "Baimin," but the correct spelling is "Baiming Zhang," with the final letter "g" included. Since the workshop certificate will be used for my academic records, I would like to make sure that my name appears correctly on all official materials.

Could you please update my registration information and the certificate record before the certificate is issued? If you need any proof of identity, registration number, or additional form from me, I would be happy to provide it as soon as possible. Please let me know once the correction has been made.

Thank you for your time and assistance.

Best regards,
Baiming Zhang

10 Guest Lecture Location (Rewritten)

Task Type: Email Writing

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Situation

You planned to attend a guest lecture, but the event location on the university website is unclear. You want to confirm the room before the lecture begins.

Task

Write an email to the event organizer. State which lecture you plan to attend, explain what information is unclear, and ask for the correct location.

Your email should:

Keep it brief; identify the event clearly; ask for the exact room or building.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:31; Saved At: 2026/5/19 00:10:31; Word Count: 103)

Dear Event Organizer,

I hope this email finds you well!

I'm writing to inquire the precise location of the guest lecture. Since the college website says it is held near the West Lake, I want to make it clear which exactly side of the lake will the event take place. Also, I need the detailed information of the room - which floor and what's the room number.

I think I will be unable to find it if I don't know information above. I really appreciate it if you tell me before the lecture begins.

Thanks for your time and assistance.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

Overall Comment: This response basically completes the communicative purpose: it asks the organizer to confirm the lecture location before the event begins. The tone is polite, and the request for the floor and room number is relevant. However, the email does not clearly identify which guest lecture the writer plans to attend, which is a key requirement in the prompt. In addition, several grammar and word-choice problems make the email sound unnatural, such as "inquire the precise location," "which exactly side," and "will the event take place" in an embedded question. The response is understandable, but it needs more precise event identification, smoother phrasing, and more natural formal-email grammar.

Major Problems

- (1) The email does not identify the lecture clearly enough. The prompt asks the writer to state which lecture they plan to attend, so the email should include a lecture title, topic, speaker, or date.
- (2) Some expressions are grammatically incorrect or unnatural. For example, "inquire the precise location" should be changed to "ask about the precise location" or "confirm the exact location."
- (3) The embedded question word order is wrong. "which exactly side of the lake will the event take place" should be revised as "on which side of the lake the event will take place."
- (4) The request is slightly repetitive. The email asks about the side of the lake, floor, and room, but it can be expressed more concisely as "the exact building, floor, and room number."

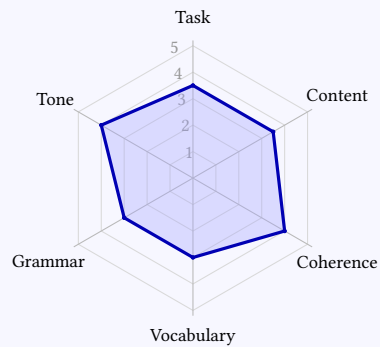
- (5) The sentence “I think I will be unable to find it if I don’t know information above” is too informal and awkward. A better version is “I would appreciate receiving this information before the lecture begins so that I can arrive on time.”

Detailed Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I’m writing to inquire the precise location	“inquire” is usually followed by “about”; the phrase sounds unnatural.	I am writing to confirm the exact location.
Since the college website says it is held near the West Lake	“the West Lake” is usually unnecessary if referring to the place name; “says it is held” is acceptable but not very polished.	The university website lists the venue only as “West Lake Campus.”
which exactly side of the lake will the event take place	Wrong word order in an embedded question; “which exactly side” is unnatural.	on which side of the lake the event will take place
the detailed information of the room	Unnatural collocation.	the exact building, floor, and room number
which floor and what’s the room number	Too conversational; the structure is not parallel.	which floor it is on and what the room number is
I think I will be unable to find it if I don’t know information above	Awkward and slightly too direct; “the information above” needs an article.	I would appreciate receiving this information before the lecture begins so that I can arrive on time.
I really appreciate it if you tell me	Tense is wrong for a polite request.	I would really appreciate it if you could let me know.

Detailed Evaluation

Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3.5/5	The email asks for the location and mentions the unclear information, but it does not clearly identify the specific lecture, which is required by the prompt.
Content	3.5/5	The request for the room, floor, and exact place is relevant. However, the information is not organized as efficiently as it could be, and the lecture itself is not identified.
Coherence	4/5	The structure is easy to follow: greeting, reason for writing, problem, request, closing. Some sentences are repetitive or awkward, but the logic is clear.
Vocabulary	3/5	The vocabulary is understandable but sometimes unnatural, such as “inquire the precise location,” “detailed information of the room,” and “information above.”
Grammar	3/5	Several grammar issues appear, especially with embedded question word order, article use, and tense in polite requests. These errors do not block understanding but reduce accuracy.
Tone	4/5	The tone is polite and appropriate for an organizer. However, some expressions, such as “I will be unable to find it,” could be softened and made more professional.
Total Score	21/30	The response is functional and polite, but it loses points for incomplete event identification and noticeable grammar problems.



Revised Version (Word Count: 106)

Dear Event Organizer,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to confirm the location of the guest lecture titled "Artificial Intelligence and Future Education," which I plan to attend this Friday afternoon. On the university website, the venue is listed only as "West Lake Campus," but it does not mention the exact building, floor, or room number.

Could you please let me know the correct location of the lecture, including the building name and room number? I would appreciate receiving this information before the lecture begins so that I can arrive on time.

Thank you very much for your help.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

venue = place , but more formal.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 06:57; Saved At: 2026/5/19 00:25:32; Word Count: 111)

Dear Event Organizer,

I hope this email finds you well!

I'm looking forward to attend a lecture held this Friday night which is titled with "Artificial Intelligence and College Education", but I have some problem with it. It only mentioned "the West Lake" as the venue on the university website. I can't find the right building since there are 12 buildings.

Could you please tell me the detailed information about where the event will be held. I will appreciate if you send me the exact building, floor and the room number before the event begins - I don't want to miss it.

Thanks for your time and help.

Best regards,

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 23/30

Overall Comment: This response completes the task quite well. The writer clearly states which lecture they plan to attend, explains why the location information is unclear, and asks for the exact building, floor, and room number before the lecture begins. The email is polite and easy to understand. However, several grammar and word-choice problems make the response less natural and less formal, such as “looking forward to attend,” “titled with,” “I have some problem with it,” and “I will appreciate if.” The content is strong, but the language accuracy needs improvement.

Major Problems

- (1) “looking forward to attend” is grammatically incorrect. After “look forward to,” the verb should be in the gerund form: “looking forward to attending.”
- (2) “which is titled with” is unnatural. A lecture is usually “titled,” “called,” or “entitled,” not “titled with.”
- (3) “I have some problem with it” is too vague and slightly unnatural. The real problem is the unclear location, so it should be expressed directly.
- (4) “It only mentioned” is unclear because “it” refers to the website. A clearer sentence is “The website only lists the venue as...”
- (5) “Could you please tell me the detailed information about where the event will be held.” should end with a question mark, and the phrase is wordy. It is better to write, “Could you please let me know the exact location?”
- (6) “I will appreciate if” is incorrect. The correct expression is “I would appreciate it if...”

Detailed Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I'm looking forward to attend	After “look forward to,” use a noun or gerund.	I am looking forward to attending
a lecture held this Friday night which is titled with	Awkward structure; “titled with” is incorrect.	a lecture titled “Artificial Intelligence and College Education” this Friday evening
but I have some problem with it	Too vague and unnatural.	but I am unsure about its exact location
It only mentioned “the West Lake” as the venue	“It” is unclear; “mentioned” is not the best verb here.	The university website only lists the venue as “West Lake”
I can't find the right building since there are 12 buildings	Understandable, but slightly informal.	Since there are 12 buildings in that area, I am not sure which one I should go to.
Could you please tell me the detailed information about where the event will be held.	This should be a question; the phrase is wordy.	Could you please let me know the exact location of the event?
I will appreciate if you send me	Incorrect polite-request structure.	I would appreciate it if you could send me
the exact building, floor and the room number	Add a comma and make the structure parallel.	the exact building, floor, and room number
I don't want to miss it	Understandable, but a little too conversational.	so that I can arrive on time

Detailed Evaluation

Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.5/5	The response clearly identifies the lecture, explains the unclear location, and asks for the exact room before the event. This fully addresses the prompt.
Content	4/5	The details are relevant and useful, especially the explanation that there are 12 buildings. However, the wording could be more concise and formal.
Coherence	4/5	The email has a clear structure: greeting, lecture identification, problem, request, and closing. Some sentences could be connected more smoothly.
Vocabulary	3.5/5	The vocabulary is understandable, but some expressions are unnatural, such as "titled with," "some problem with it," and "detailed information about where."
Grammar	3.5/5	The meaning is clear, but there are several noticeable grammar errors, especially with verb forms, polite requests, and question punctuation.
Tone	4/5	The tone is polite and appropriate. The phrase "I don't want to miss it" is acceptable, but "so that I can arrive on time" would sound more formal.
Total Score	23/30	This is a good TOEFL email response with complete content, but language accuracy prevents it from reaching the highest level.

Revised Version (Word Count: 100)

Dear Event Organizer,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am looking forward to attending the guest lecture titled "Artificial Intelligence and College Education" this Friday evening. However, I am not sure about its exact location. The university website only lists the venue as "West Lake," but there are several buildings in that area, so I do not know which one I should go to.

Could you please let me know the correct building, floor, and room number for the lecture? I would appreciate receiving this information before the event begins so that I can arrive on time.

Thank you very much for your help.

Best regards,

Baiming

My Notes:

look forward to sth./doing sth. (I've made this mistake so many times and it's so unforgivable!)

a lecture titled "..."

I have some problem with it -> I am unsure about its exact location

In this sentence: I would appreciate it if you could send me the exact building, floor, and room number. "would" and "could" are not mainly used to talk about the past. They are used to make the request more polite and less direct.

Part II — Academic Discussion

Overview

This part focuses on the TOEFL iBT Writing task *Write for an Academic Discussion*. In this task, you are placed in a short online class discussion. A professor introduces a question related to an academic topic, and two students give their opinions. Your job is to write your own response to the professor's question and add something meaningful to the discussion.

This task is different from a traditional essay. You do not need to write a long introduction, several body paragraphs, and a formal conclusion. Instead, you need to express a clear opinion, support it with specific reasons or examples, and connect your response naturally to the discussion. A strong answer should sound like a thoughtful student contribution rather than a memorized essay.



Figure: A suggested workflow for the TOEFL academic discussion task.

What This Task Tests

The academic discussion task mainly evaluates whether you can participate in an academic conversation in written English. In particular, it tests whether you can:

- understand the professor's question and respond directly to it;
- express a clear personal opinion;
- support your opinion with a reason, example, or explanation;
- refer to the ideas of other students when appropriate;
- add a new point instead of simply repeating what has already been said;
- organize your response clearly within a short time limit.

Basic Structure

A complete academic discussion response usually has a simple structure. The response should be focused and easy to follow, even though it is much shorter than a full essay.

- (1) **Position.** Begin by clearly answering the professor's question.
- (2) **Connection.** Briefly connect your view to one of the student responses, if it is useful.
- (3) **Reason.** Give a specific reason that explains why you hold this opinion.
- (4) **Example.** Add a concrete example, personal experience, or realistic situation.
- (5) **Contribution.** End by adding a final insight that moves the discussion forward.

Writing Strategy

Before writing, spend a few seconds deciding your position. Your opinion does not have to be unusual, but it should be clear. Avoid writing a response that only says both sides are reasonable without making your own view specific. In most cases, it is better to choose one main position and support it well.

The two student comments are useful because they give you possible directions. You may agree with one student, disagree with one student, or combine ideas from both. However, you should not simply copy their points. A stronger response uses the student comments as a starting point and then adds a new reason, example, or perspective.

Useful expressions include:

- "I agree with this view because..."
- "I understand this concern, but I think..."
- "One additional point is that..."

- “For example, in a university setting...”
- “This is why I believe that...”

The best responses usually develop one idea clearly rather than listing many points quickly. A short but well-supported answer is often stronger than a longer answer with vague examples. Try to explain why your reason matters. This makes your response sound more academic and less like a simple personal preference.

Common Problems

Several problems often weaken responses in this task. One common problem is writing too generally. For example, saying that something is “good for students” is not enough unless you explain why. Another problem is repeating the professor’s question or the students’ ideas without adding your own contribution. Some responses also become too informal, using casual expressions that do not fit an academic discussion.

A good response should avoid these problems by giving a direct answer, developing one clear reason, and using a specific example. The tone should be natural but still appropriate for a classroom discussion.

Final Check

At the end of each practice, quickly check three things: whether your opinion is clear, whether your support is specific, and whether your response adds something new to the discussion. If these three points are handled well, the response will usually sound complete and appropriate for the task.

11 Team Projects vs. Individual Work

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

In this week's discussion, we are considering how students should complete major course projects. Some people believe students learn more when they work in teams, while others believe independent work leads to deeper understanding. Which approach do you think is better for university students, and why?

Student A

I think team projects are usually more useful because students learn how to divide tasks and communicate. These abilities are important in most careers, not just in school.

Student B

I prefer individual projects because grades are fairer. In a group, one student may do most of the work while others receive the same score.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 15:23; Saved At: 2026/5/2 00:35:23; Words Count: 138)

While some people might say it's fairer to value projects individually, I think the teamwork spirit is more important. Since the communication became really convenient nowadays, everyone is allowed to work just focus on his own part. Although not every one works the same which seems unfair, it's more effecient that each person complete the task what they are excel at. Most significantly, no one could finish a extremely complex project by his own, which attached importance to teamwork and collaboration. For example, there are very little number of companies which only contains only one person. It's the same in academic course project. Taking account of the concerns that some students might have, which is the same score between different contributors, the professor can make detailed and varied assessments considering each one's own behavior in the whole project.⁵

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 17/30

Overall Comment: This response gives a clear opinion in favor of team projects and provides some relevant reasons, such as communication, task division, and the complexity of modern projects. However, under a strict TOEFL-style standard, the response is underdeveloped and contains frequent grammar and word-choice errors. The main idea is understandable, but some sentences are awkward or inaccurate, which weakens the clarity of the argument. Also, the official-time response is only 81 words, below the recommended length for the Academic Discussion task. The gray overtime part adds useful support, but it would not fully count in a real timed test.

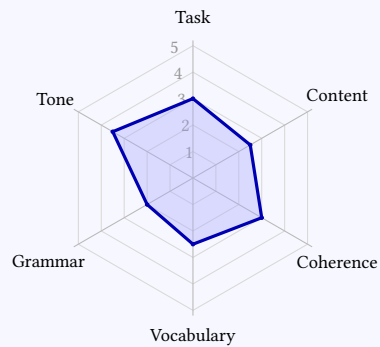
Major Problems

- (1) Several grammar errors affect clarity, such as subject-verb agreement and sentence structure.
- (2) Some expressions are unnatural, including "teamwork spirit," "work just focus on his own part," and "what they are excel at."

⁵The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

- (3) The reasoning is relevant but still general. The response needs a more concrete example from a university project.
- (4) The final idea about complex projects is strong, but it is not expressed accurately enough.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3.0/5	The response answers the question and gives a clear preference for team projects. However, it is below the recommended length within the official time limit and does not develop the position sufficiently.
Content	2.5/5	The ideas are relevant, especially task division and complex projects, but they remain general. A more specific university example would make the argument stronger.
Coherence	3.0/5	The response has a basic logical direction, moving from fairness to teamwork and collaboration. However, transitions are sometimes mechanical, and some sentence-level problems make the argument less smooth.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Some vocabulary is appropriate, such as “communicate,” “collaboration,” and “complex project.” However, several phrases are unnatural or inaccurate, such as “teamwork spirit” and “what they are excel at.”
Grammar	2.0/5	Grammar errors are frequent and noticeable. Problems include article errors, subject-verb agreement, wrong verb forms, and awkward sentence structures. These errors sometimes interfere with clarity.
Tone	3.5/5	The tone is suitable for an academic discussion. It is polite and relevant, but the language control is not strong enough to sound fully academic.
Total Score	16.5/30	Strict estimated converted score: approximately 17/30 .

Revised Version (Words Count: 155)

I agree more with the view that team projects are better for university students. Although individual projects may seem fairer, most important academic and professional tasks require cooperation. In a team project, students can learn how to divide responsibilities, explain their ideas clearly, and solve disagreements. These skills are difficult to develop if every student only works alone.

For example, in an engineering course, one student may be good at programming, another may be better at data analysis, and another may be responsible for writing the final report. By combining their strengths, the group can often complete a more complex and meaningful project than one student could finish independently. I understand the concern about fairness mentioned in the second student’s response, but this problem can be reduced if professors include peer evaluation and individual reports. Therefore, I think team projects are more valuable because they prepare students for real academic and professional collaboration.

12 Recorded Lectures

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Many universities now record lectures and allow students to watch them later. Some instructors worry that recorded lectures reduce class attendance, while students often say recordings help them review difficult material. Should universities record most lectures?

Student A

I support recording lectures because students can pause the video and review complex points before exams. This is especially helpful in science and engineering courses.

Student B

I am not sure it is a good idea. If students know every lecture is recorded, they may skip class and miss the chance to ask questions in real time.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 12:00; Overtime: +02:00; Saved At: 2026/5/11 15:31:53; Word Count: 121)

Recording lecture boosts more advantages than disadvantages. It can not only provide materials for students to review, but also allow students to watch in a faster speed, which is more efficient. Although some students might skip class because of this, it's students' self-discipline task. Those who would be absent at class, will not listen to class and ask questions in real time either if they are forced to attend. I love the recording myself because it really helped a lot when I was preparing the final exam. It's difficult to digest all the details in class, but after the semesters learning, I can review the lecture and gain new knowledge. As the saying goes: "Reviewing can bring new understanding to you."⁶

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Score: 3/5

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Overall Comment:

The response gives a clear opinion and addresses both sides of the issue. It explains that recordings help students review and that attendance problems depend partly on students' self-discipline. However, under a strict TOEFL-style standard, the response would lose points because several expressions are unnatural, some grammar errors affect fluency, and the final sentence is incomplete within the official ten-minute time limit. The ideas are relevant, but they need smoother development and more precise academic wording.

Major Problems

- (1) The opening sentence has an unnatural collocation. "Recording lecture boosts more advantages than disadvantages" should be changed to "Recording lectures has more advantages than disadvantages" or "Recording lectures offers more benefits than drawbacks."

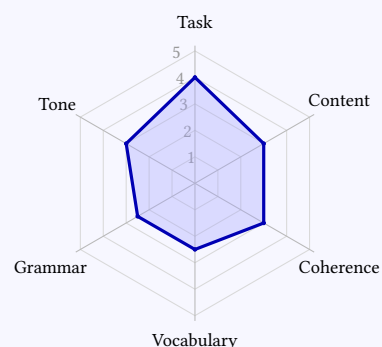
⁶The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

- (2) Several phrases use incorrect prepositions or word forms. For example, “watch in a faster speed” should be “watch at a faster speed,” and “preparing the final exam” should be “preparing for the final exam.”
- (3) The sentence about self-discipline is grammatically weak. “It’s students’ self-discipline task” should be changed to “it is a matter of students’ self-discipline.” Also, “self-discipline” is misspelled; the correct spelling is “self-discipline.”
- (4) The argument about skipping class is useful, but the sentence is too awkward. “Those who would be absent at class” should be “students who are likely to skip class.” The phrase “absent at class” is incorrect; the standard phrase is “absent from class.”
- (5) The final sentence is incomplete within the official time limit. Since the gray text was written after ten minutes, the official response ends with “gain,” which makes the conclusion unfinished. This would hurt coherence and task completion.
- (6) The tone is understandable, but some expressions are too casual for an academic discussion. “I love the recording myself” should be replaced with “In my own experience, recordings have been helpful.”

Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
Recording lecture boosts more advantages than disadvantages.	Singular/plural error and unnatural use of “boosts advantages.”	Recording lectures has more advantages than disadvantages.
provide materials for students to review	Understandable, but “materials” is vague here.	provide useful materials for review / give students a useful way to review
watch in a faster speed	Wrong preposition. We say “at a speed,” not “in a speed.”	watch at a faster speed
it’s students’ self-discipline task	Unnatural noun structure and spelling error.	it is a matter of students’ self-discipline
Those who would be absent at class	Wrong phrase. The correct phrase is “absent from class.”	Students who are likely to skip class
will not listen to class	We usually say “listen in class” or “pay attention in class.”	may not pay attention in class
I love the recording myself	Too casual for TOEFL academic writing.	In my own experience, recordings have been very helpful.
preparing the final exam	Missing preposition.	preparing for the final exam
after the semesters learning	Incorrect possessive and unnatural expression.	after a semester of learning
gain new knowledge	Possible, but in this context “deepen my understanding” is more natural.	deepen my understanding

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.0/5	The response clearly answers the question and supports recording lectures. It also addresses the attendance concern, but the official-time ending is incomplete.
Content	3.0/5	The main reasons are relevant: review, faster watching, self-discipline, and personal exam preparation. However, the examples are brief and could be more developed.
Coherence	3.0/5	The response has a logical direction, but some sentences are awkwardly connected. The final sentence is unfinished within the time limit, which weakens the conclusion.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Several word choices are understandable but unnatural, such as “boosts more advantages,” “self-discipline task,” and “love the recording.”
Grammar	2.5/5	There are frequent grammar and collocation errors, including singular/plural problems, wrong prepositions, spelling mistakes, and awkward sentence structures.
Tone	3.0/5	The tone is mostly appropriate, but some phrases sound too casual for an academic discussion response.
Total Score	18/30	This is around a TOEFL-style 3/5 response: clear position and relevant ideas, but limited by language control and an incomplete timed ending.

Revised Version (Word Count: 142)

I believe universities should record most lectures, but recordings should be used as a supplement rather than a replacement for attending class. I agree that recordings are especially useful for reviewing difficult material, because students can pause, slow down, or replay explanations that they did not fully understand during class. For example, in a physics or engineering course, one missed step in a derivation can make the rest of the lecture confusing, so a recording gives students a chance to check the logic again before exams. The concern about attendance is reasonable, but students who habitually skip class may not participate seriously even without recordings. Universities can still encourage attendance by keeping in-class discussions, quizzes, or participation activities. Therefore, recording lectures would improve learning as long as instructors make clear that the videos are a study tool, not a substitute for class.

13 First-Year Campus Housing (Rewritten)

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Some universities require first-year students to live in campus housing, while others allow students to choose whether to live on or off campus. In your opinion, should first-year students be required to live on campus?

Student A

Living on campus helps new students make friends and adjust to university life. It is also easier to attend events and use campus resources.

Student B

I think students should have freedom to choose. Some students live near the university or have financial reasons for staying with family.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:52; Saved At: 2026/5/11 14:31:30; Word Count: 110)

While some students might think that it take living in the university as a given, I think it's students' freedom to choose. It is unnessesary to force those students to live on campus whose houses are near campus, which not only takes up school's dorm resources, but also brings burden to them to pay the dorm fee. Also, you can never expect what your dormitory be like. Take one of my friend as an example, he tried to live in the campus at first, but a dorm mate stayed up really late playing computer games, which bothered him a lot. Finally, he moved out and can have peace to rest.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated Official-style Level: 3/5

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18–19/30

Overall Comment: This response clearly answers the question and gives a reasonable opinion: first-year students should not be required to live on campus. The financial reason and the roommate example are both relevant. However, the language is not controlled enough for a higher score. There are many grammar and word-choice problems, such as incorrect verb forms, misplaced relative clauses, unnatural collocations, and tense inconsistency. Under a strict TOEFL-style standard, this response is understandable and relevant, but it would probably remain around the 3/5 level rather than reaching 4/5.

Major Problems

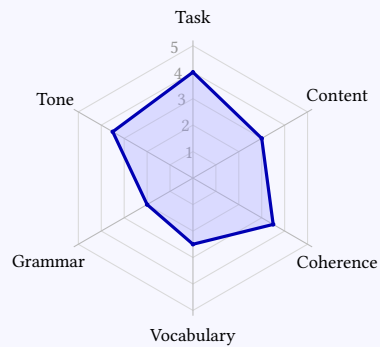
- (1) The opening sentence is grammatically unclear. "It take living in the university as a given" is not correct English. It should be changed to "Although some people believe that living on campus should be required" or "Although some students take campus housing for granted."
- (2) "It's students' freedom to choose" is understandable but unnatural. A better expression is "students should have the freedom to choose where they live." The phrase "have the freedom to do something" is the natural collocation.

- (3) The sentence “force those students to live on campus whose houses are near campus” has a misplaced relative clause. “Whose houses are near campus” should directly follow “students.” A clearer version is: “require students who live near campus to stay in dormitories.”
- (4) “Takes up school’s dorm resources” is missing an article and sounds unnatural. Use “take up the school’s dormitory resources” or, more naturally, “use limited campus housing space.”
- (5) “Brings burden to them to pay the dorm fee” is not idiomatic. The correct expression is “place an extra financial burden on them” or “make them pay unnecessary dormitory fees.”
- (6) “You can never expect what your dormitory be like” has a grammar error. After “what,” the clause needs a finite verb form: “what your dormitory will be like.” Also, “living environment” is more precise than “dormitory” here.
- (7) “One of my friend” must be “one of my friends.” After “one of,” the noun should be plural because it means one person from a group of friends.
- (8) “Live in the campus” should be “live on campus.” The standard phrase is “on campus,” not “in the campus.”
- (9) “Finally, he moved out and can have peace to rest” has tense inconsistency and unnatural wording. Since the story is in the past, use “could.” A better version is: “Eventually, he moved out and was able to rest in a quieter environment.”

Main Improvement Strategy: Keep the same opinion, but use clearer academic phrasing. The revised version should state the position directly, explain the financial reason more naturally, keep the roommate example, and end with a clear recommendation.

Detailed Evaluation

Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.0/5	The response answers the professor’s question directly and gives a clear position against mandatory campus housing. However, it does not clearly connect to the two classmates’ ideas.
Content	3.0/5	The financial reason and roommate example are relevant, but the development is still limited. The example should explain more clearly why mandatory housing is unfair for first-year students.
Coherence	3.5/5	The basic order is logical: opinion, financial reason, roommate example. However, the opening sentence is unclear, the transition “Also” is simple, and there is no strong concluding sentence.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Several expressions are unnatural, such as “take living in the university as a given,” “brings burden,” “dorm resources,” and “have peace to rest.” These should be replaced with more idiomatic academic expressions.
Grammar	2.0/5	There are frequent errors in verb form, word form, articles, prepositions, relative clauses, and tense. Examples include “it take,” “unnecessary,” “one of my friend,” and “what your dormitory be like.”
Tone	3.5/5	The tone is acceptable for an academic discussion, but “you can never expect” is too absolute and conversational. A more academic version would be “students cannot always predict whether their living environment will be suitable.”
Total Score	18.5/30	This is a relevant and understandable response, but the number of language errors keeps it at about the TOEFL 3/5 level.



Revised Version (Word Count: 134)

Although living on campus can help first-year students meet classmates, I do not think it should be required. I agree with the point that students need freedom because their personal situations are very different. For example, students whose families live close to the university may not need a dormitory at all. Forcing them to live on campus would waste limited housing space and add an unnecessary financial burden. In addition, campus housing does not always create a good living environment. One of my friends first chose to live on campus, but his roommate often stayed up late playing computer games, so he could not sleep well. After he moved out, he was able to study and rest in a quieter place. Therefore, universities should recommend campus housing, but they should not make it mandatory.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 13:24; Overtime: +03:24; Saved At: 2026/5/11 15:05:23; Word Count: 124)

While some students take living on campus as granted, I think it's students' freedom to choose. Living in campus housing, which not only occupies the limited dorm resources, but also brings financial burdens to their families, will be unnecessary for those students whose houses are near the university. Also, there is no doubt that living on campus allows students to make new friends, but it's not the only way. You could never expect what the dorm living environment will be like. Take one of my friends as an example, he lived in the dorm at first, but his dorm mates stayed up very late playing computer games, which bothered his rest extremely. Then he moved out and eventually could manage his time by himself.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated Official-style Level: 3.5/5

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 22–23/30

Overall Comment:

This version is noticeably stronger than the previous draft. The organization is clearer, the argument is more balanced, and the vocabulary sounds more academic. The response now includes both a practical argument and a personal example, which makes the discussion more convincing. However, several unnatural expressions and grammar issues still remain, especially in collocations, article usage, and sentence structure. In addition, the main example is incomplete inside the timed section because part of

the development appears only in the gray overtime text. Under a strict TOEFL standard, this response is likely around the high 3/5 range or low 4/5 range, approximately 22–23/30.

Major Problems

- (1) “take living on campus as granted” is incorrect. The correct fixed expression is “take something for granted.” You must include “for.”

Correct version:

While some students take living on campus for granted, ...

- (2) “it’s students’ freedom to choose” is still unnatural English. Native academic writing normally uses: students should have the freedom to choose

- (3) “Living in campus housing ... will be unnecessary” has a structural problem.

The subject “Living in campus housing” refers to the action itself, not the policy. What you really mean is:

Requiring students to live in campus housing would be unnecessary

- (4) “occupies the limited dorm resources” is understandable but unnatural.

“Resources” is too broad here. Native speakers would usually say:

occupies limited dormitory space

or

uses limited campus housing

- (5) “those students whose houses are near the university” sounds awkward.

Native English normally says:

students who live near the university

because “houses are near” sounds overly literal and less natural.

- (6) “Take one of my friends as an example, he lived in the dorm at first” is a comma splice.

Two independent clauses cannot simply be joined with a comma.

You should write either:

Take one of my friends as an example. He lived in the dorm at first, ...

or

For example, one of my friends lived in the dorm at first, ...

- (7) “You could never expect what the dorm living environment will be like” is grammatically understandable, but still unnatural.

Better versions:

Students cannot always predict what dorm life will be like.

or

The dormitory environment may not always be suitable for everyone.

- (8) “bothered his rest extremely” is not idiomatic.

English normally uses:

seriously affected his sleep

or

disturbed his rest

- (9) “could manage his time by himself” does not logically connect well to the previous sentence.

The issue was sleep and noise, not time management.

A better ending:

After moving out, he was finally able to rest and study in a quieter environment.

Why This Version Scores Higher Than the Previous One

- The argument structure is more balanced and mature.
- Vocabulary is more academic: “financial burdens,” “limited dorm resources,” “living environment.”
- The transition between ideas is smoother.
- The example is more developed.
- Sentence variety is better.

Why It Still Does Not Fully Reach 4/5

- Too many unnatural collocations remain.
- Grammar control is still unstable.
- Some sentences are structurally awkward.
- Part of the important example only appears in overtime text.
- Native-like fluency is still missing in several places.

Detailed Evaluation

Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.5/5	Directly answers the discussion question and develops both practical and personal reasons.
Content	4.0/5	Ideas are more convincing and detailed than the previous version, though the example could be more concise and focused.
Coherence	4.0/5	The organization is logical overall, but several sentence connections are still awkward.
Vocabulary	3.5/5	More academic vocabulary is used successfully, but some collocations remain unnatural.
Grammar	3.0/5	Grammar is improved, but comma splices, awkward clause structures, and expression errors still appear frequently.
Tone	4.0/5	The tone is appropriate for an academic discussion and sounds more mature than the previous draft.
Total Score	23/30	A solid improvement with clearer organization and stronger support, but language control still prevents a stable 4/5 score.

Revised Version (Word Count: 137)

While some students believe that first-year students should live on campus, I think students should have the freedom to choose where they live. Requiring students who already live near the university to stay in dormitories would be unnecessary because it would use limited housing space and place additional financial pressure on their families. In addition, although campus housing can help students make friends, it is not always the best living environment for everyone. For example, one of my friends lived in a dormitory during his first semester, but his roommates often stayed up late playing computer games, which seriously affected his sleep. After moving out, he was finally able to study and rest in a much quieter environment. Therefore, universities should encourage campus housing instead of making it mandatory.

My Notes:

Although dormitories can ease freshmen into university life, requiring all first-year students to live on campus ignores important practical differences among students.

Mandatory housing policies may benefit some freshmen socially, but they can also create unnecessary financial and personal difficulties for others.

14 Library Building vs. Online Resources (Rewritten)

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Our university is deciding whether to spend more money on expanding the library building or improving online library resources. Which investment would benefit students more?

Student A

I would choose online resources because students can access journals, e-books, and databases from anywhere. This is useful for research and for students who live far from campus.

Student B

I think the physical library is still important. Students need quiet study spaces, and not everyone can study effectively in a dormitory or apartment.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 9:32; Saved At: 2026/5/12 01:57:50; Word Count: 88)

I agree more with the view of spending more money on improving online library resources. Since the Internet became so convenient nowadays, most of us don't think paper book necessary. Some people might say that physical library provides a quiet study place, but I think it's the same to study in the spare classroom. Take myself as an example, last year I found it difficult to search for free resource of a specific paper relating my major course, and I paid by myself at last. It's really frustrating.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Overall Comment: The response gives a clear opinion and includes one personal example, so the basic task is completed. However, it is only 88 words, which is below the recommended effective length for this task. The ideas are relevant but not developed enough: the response says online resources are better, but it does not fully explain how they help students with research, coursework, or equal access. Several expressions are understandable but unnatural, and there are noticeable grammar problems with tense, articles, countable nouns, and prepositions. Under a strict TOEFL-style standard, this response would likely receive around **18/30**.

Major Problems

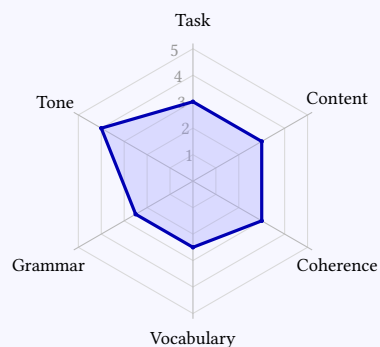
- (1) The response is too short. For this task, an effective response should normally be at least 100 words. At 88 words, the answer feels underdeveloped and does not contribute enough to the discussion.
- (2) The main example is useful but incomplete. You mention that you had to pay for a paper yourself, but you should explain why this matters: better online subscriptions would save students money, improve research efficiency, and make academic resources more equal for all students.
- (3) The sentence "most of us don't think paper book necessary" has both grammar and meaning problems. "Book" is a countable noun, so it should be plural here. Also, the claim is too broad. A better version is: "many students no longer rely mainly on printed books."

- (4) The phrase “spare classroom” is unnatural. In English, “empty classroom” or “available classroom” is more natural. Also, you should not simply say it is “the same” as the library, because classrooms may not always be quiet or available.
- (5) Several phrases sound translated from Chinese, such as “agree more with the view of spending,” “free resource of a specific paper,” and “paid by myself at last.” These should be replaced with more natural academic expressions.

Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I agree more with the view of spending more money on improving online library resources.	Wordy and unnatural. “Agree more with the view of” sounds translated.	I agree that the university should spend more money on improving online library resources.
Since the Internet became so convenient nowadays	Tense conflict. “Since” and “became” do not fit naturally with “nowadays.”	Because the Internet is so convenient today
most of us don’t think paper book necessary	“Book” should be plural. The structure “think something necessary” is possible but unnatural here.	many students no longer rely mainly on printed books
physical library provides a quiet study place	Missing article. “Study place” is understandable but less natural than “study space.”	the physical library provides a quiet study space
it’s the same to study in the spare classroom	“Spare classroom” is unnatural. The idea is also too absolute.	students can also use empty classrooms as quiet study areas
Take myself as an example	Understandable, but slightly awkward in formal writing.	For example, last year, I needed an article for one of my major courses.
search for free resource of a specific paper	“Resource” should be plural or replaced. “Free resource of a paper” is unnatural.	find access to a specific journal article
relating my major course	The preposition is missing. “Related to” is needed.	related to my major course
I paid by myself at last	Unnatural phrasing. “At last” is not appropriate here.	I eventually had to pay for it myself
It’s really frustrating.	Slightly informal and not developed enough.	This shows why better online subscriptions would directly support students’ coursework and research.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3/5	The response answers the question and states a clear preference for online resources, but it is under 100 words and does not fully add to the academic discussion.
Content	3/5	The personal example is relevant, but the explanation is too brief. You should connect the example to research access, cost, and fairness for students.
Coherence	3/5	The order is generally logical: opinion, counterargument, example. However, the transition from quiet study spaces to your paper example is abrupt.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Several phrases are unnatural, including “paper book,” “spare classroom,” “free resource of a specific paper,” and “paid by myself at last.”
Grammar	2.5/5	There are clear problems with tense, articles, plural nouns, and prepositions, such as “the Internet became so convenient nowadays” and “paper book necessary.”
Tone	4/5	The tone is appropriate for an academic discussion. However, “It’s really frustrating” is slightly informal and should be connected to a broader academic point.
Total Score	18/30	A clear but short and linguistically limited response. Better development and more natural phrasing would raise the score.

Revised Version (Word Count: 143)

I agree that the university should invest more in online library resources rather than expanding the building. The main reason is that online access has a direct impact on students’ academic performance and research efficiency. Many assignments require journal articles, e-books, and databases, and students need these materials not only on campus but also at home or during vacations. I understand the argument that the physical library provides a quiet place to study. However, the university can create quiet study areas in existing classrooms or dormitory buildings, while a broader digital library would help almost every student. For example, last year I needed an article for a course in my major, but the university database did not include it. I spent a long time searching and eventually had to pay for it myself. If the library had better online subscriptions, it would reduce financial barriers and allow students to access high-quality academic resources equally.

My Notes:

online access directly affects ... / online access has a direct impact on ...

I understand the argument that ... However, ..., while a broader digital library would help almost every student.
reduce financial barriers

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 09:23; Saved At: 2026/5/12 15:38:20; Word Count: 130)

I agree more about the decision of investing the online library resources rather than expanding the building. The main reason is that online journals, e-books, and databases are more efficient in searching and accessing. Nowadays students mainly do research online and printed books are no longer so necessary as before. For example, last year, when I was preparing the final exam, I found my school didn’t bought the article I want. So I had to pay for it myself. So improving online library brings not only the key to acquire cutting-edge investigations, but also equality for all us students. Someone might argue that they need quiet spaces to study, which makes physical libraries seemly important. But since there are many spare classrooms in our college, library is not the only option we have.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Estimated Holistic Score: 3/5

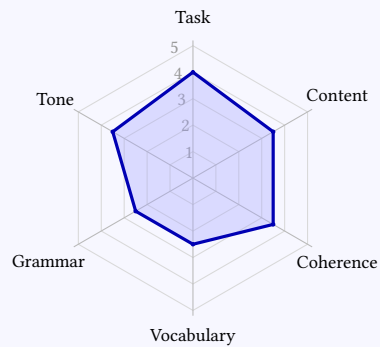
Overall Comment: This response gives a clear opinion and stays relevant to the discussion. The example about paying for an academic article is useful and directly supports the argument for online resources. However, the response has frequent grammar and word-choice problems, such as “dicion,” “did’t bought,” “the article I want,” and “cutting-edge investigations.” These errors do not completely block meaning, but they make the writing sound unnatural and less controlled. The argument is understandable, but it needs cleaner sentence structures, more precise academic vocabulary, and smoother transitions. Under a strict TOEFL-style standard, this response is around 3/5, or approximately 20/30.

Major Problems

- (1) The opening sentence is unnatural. “I agree more about the dicion of investing the online library resources” should be changed to “I agree that the university should invest more in online library resources.” The phrase “agree more about” is not idiomatic, “dicion” is misspelled, and “investing the resources” needs the preposition “in.”
- (2) Several grammar errors weaken the response. “My school did’t bought the article I want” should be corrected to “my university did not subscribe to the article I needed” or “my university did not have access to the article I needed.” After “did not,” the verb should be in base form, so “bought” is incorrect.
- (3) Some vocabulary choices are inaccurate. “Cutting-edge investigations” is not a natural phrase in this context. A better expression is “current research,” “recent academic studies,” or “up-to-date scholarly resources.”
- (4) The support is relevant but not fully polished. The example about paying for an article is good, but it should explain more clearly why this shows that online resources benefit many students, not just one student.
- (5) The counterargument is useful but too brief. The sentence about spare classrooms answers the physical-library argument, but it would be stronger if it mentioned that quiet study space can be provided without expanding the whole library building.

Detailed Evaluation

Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4.0/5	The response clearly answers the question and chooses online library resources. It also addresses the opposing view about quiet study spaces.
Content	3.5/5	The article-payment example is relevant and specific, but the explanation should connect more clearly to the broader benefit for all students.
Coherence	3.5/5	The basic structure is clear: opinion, reason, example, counterargument. However, repeated use of “So” and several awkward transitions reduce fluency.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Some useful words appear, such as “journals,” “databases,” and “equality,” but several phrases are unnatural, including “dicion,” “searching and accessing,” “cutting-edge investigations,” and “seemly important.”
Grammar	2.5/5	There are noticeable errors in verb tense, articles, prepositions, and sentence structure. Examples include “did’t bought,” “the article I want,” and “for all us students.”
Tone	3.5/5	The tone is appropriate for an academic discussion, but informal or awkward expressions make it less polished.
Total Score	19.5/30	Rounded TOEFL-style converted score: 20/30 .



Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I agree more about the dicision of investing the online library resources	“Agree more about” is unnatural; “dicision” is misspelled; “investing” needs “in.”	I agree that the university should invest more in online library resources.
more efficient in searching and accessing	Missing object; “efficient in accessing” is awkward.	make it easier for students to search for and access academic materials.
printed books are no longer so necessary as before	“so necessary as before” is not idiomatic.	printed books are no longer as necessary as they used to be.
my school didn’t bought the article I want	Spelling error; after “did not,” use base verb; tense should be past.	my university did not subscribe to the article I needed.
So I had to pay for it myself. So improving online library brings...	Repeating “So” makes the logic sound mechanical.	As a result, I had to pay for it myself. This shows that better online resources can reduce students’ financial burden.
brings not only the key to acquire cutting-edge investigations	The structure is incorrect; “investigations” is the wrong word.	gives students access to current research.
equality for all us students	Word order is wrong.	fairer access for all students.
physical libraries seemly important	“Seemly” means appropriate or proper; the intended word is “seemingly”.	physical libraries may seem important.
library is not the only option we have	Missing article before “library.”	the library is not the only option available to students.

Revised Version (Word Count: 130)

I agree that the university should invest more in online library resources rather than expanding the library building. The most important reason is that students now rely heavily on digital materials for research. If the university buys access to more journals, e-books, and databases, students can find reliable sources more quickly and use them wherever they are. For example, last year I needed an academic article for exam preparation, but my university did not subscribe to that journal, so I had to pay for it myself. Better online resources would reduce this kind of financial burden and give all students fairer access to current research. Although quiet study spaces are important, students can also use empty classrooms or study rooms. Therefore, online resources would benefit a wider group of students.

15 Final Exams vs. Smaller Assignments

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Some teachers believe that students should receive grades mainly from final exams, while others prefer multiple smaller assignments throughout the semester. Which grading method do you think is better?

Student A

I prefer multiple assignments because they reduce pressure. Students can improve gradually instead of having one exam determine most of the grade.

Student B

Final exams are better in some courses because they test whether students understand the whole subject, not just separate weekly topics.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:51; Saved At: 2026/5/19 13:40:20; Word Count: 169)

Students should receive their grades mainly from final exams instead of small assignments. Firstly, multiple assignments are usually allowed to finish at home. This makes some student have the opportunity to cheat, like exchanging answers or using large language models. So it can't reflect the students' real ability and knowledge. What's more, multiple assignments are not easier and have more pressure than student A thinks. It needs students to be hard-working all the term and anxious about every homework. Last year when I took the course of "Fluid Mechanics", I didn't understand the newly-learned chapter and was unable to finish the assignment perfectly. Since the deadline is a week, I didn't have choice but hand in the crude one. But then after the next week learning, I suddenly realized and made that difficult chapter clear. However, I wasn't allowed to revise my homework that time. I felt so anxious all the semester because other students had completed so good. Thankfully, I earned a brilliant score at the final exam.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Overall Comment:

This response has a clear position and uses a personal example effectively. The main idea is understandable: final exams may be fairer than small assignments because take-home assignments can involve cheating or outside help, and students may need more time to fully understand difficult material. However, the essay is weakened by frequent grammar errors, some unnatural expressions, and a slightly one-sided argument. To reach a higher score, the response should use more accurate sentence structures, make the reasoning more balanced, and express the example more smoothly.

Major Problems

- (1) The argument is clear but too absolute. You say small assignments are stressful and unfair, but you do not acknowledge that they can still be useful for practice. A stronger answer should say that assignments can help learning, but final exams should carry more weight.

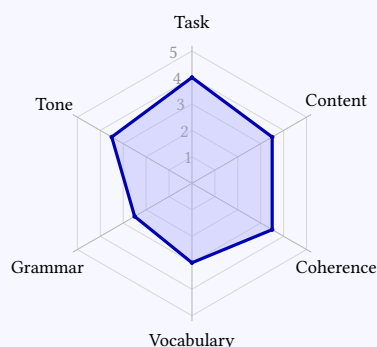
- (2) Some ideas are good but not expressed naturally. For example, “multiple assignments are not easier and have more pressure” should be changed to “multiple assignments are not always less stressful” or “frequent assignments can create constant pressure.”
- (3) There are many grammar problems with singular/plural forms, verb patterns, articles, and word choice. These errors do not completely block understanding, but they make the essay sound less fluent and less academic.
- (4) The personal example is relevant, but it is too long and slightly informal. It should be compressed and connected more directly to the main point: students sometimes need time to reach final mastery, so one early homework grade may not reflect their real ability.
- (5) The conclusion is missing. The essay ends with a personal result, but it should return to the topic and clearly state why final exams are the better grading method.

Specific Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression	Reason
small assignments	smaller assignments / frequent assignments	The topic says “smaller assignments.” If you mean assignments given many times during the semester, “frequent assignments” is more precise.
allowed to finish at home	completed at home	“Assignments are completed at home” is more natural than “allowed to finish at home.”
some student have	some students have	“Some” usually takes a plural countable noun here, so it should be “students.” The verb should also be plural: “have.”
like exchanging answers	such as exchanging answers	“Such as” is more formal and suitable for academic writing.
So it can’t reflect	Therefore, they may not reflect	Avoid starting academic sentences with “So.” Also, “assignments” is plural, so use “they.”
not easier and have more pressure	not always less stressful	“Have more pressure” is unnatural. People “feel pressure” or something “creates pressure.”
It needs students to be hard-working all the term	They require students to work hard throughout the semester	“Assignments require students to...” is the natural structure. “Throughout the semester” is more natural and academic.
the newly-learned chapter	the newly learned chapter / a new chapter	No hyphen is needed after an adverb ending in “-ly.”
Since the deadline is a week	Since the deadline was only one week away	The story is in the past, so use past tense. “The deadline is a week” is incomplete.
I didn’t have choice but hand in	I had no choice but to hand in	Correct structure: “have no choice but to do something.”
the crude one	a rough version	“Crude” sounds too negative or rude here. “A rough version” is natural.
after the next week learning	after another week of study	“Learning” cannot be used this way.

made that difficult chapter clear	finally understood that difficult chapter	“Make a chapter clear” is unnatural when the subject is the student.
that time	at that time	The phrase needs the preposition “at.”
so good	very well / extremely well	“Good” is an adjective; after “had completed,” use the adverb “well.”
a brilliant score	an excellent score	“Brilliant score” is understandable but not idiomatic. “Excellent score” is more natural.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	The response clearly answers the question and chooses final exams. It also addresses the opposing view indirectly. However, it would be stronger if it acknowledged that smaller assignments can still be useful as low-stakes practice.
Content	3.5/5	The ideas are relevant and reasonably specific. The cheating point and the fluid mechanics example both support the argument. However, the reasoning is somewhat one-sided, and the personal example needs a clearer link to the idea of final mastery.
Coherence	3.5/5	The essay has a basic logical order: position, fairness problem, pressure problem, personal example. However, transitions are sometimes simple, and the final sentence does not function as a strong conclusion.
Vocabulary	3/5	The vocabulary is understandable, but several expressions are unnatural, such as “have more pressure,” “all the term,” “the crude one,” and “made that difficult chapter clear.” More academic and idiomatic phrasing is needed.
Grammar	2.5/5	Grammar is the weakest area. There are frequent errors in plural forms, articles, tense consistency, verb patterns, and collocations. Examples include “some student have,” “didn’t have choice but hand in,” and “other students had completed so good.”
Tone	3.5/5	The tone is generally appropriate for TOEFL writing, but some phrases sound too informal or too absolute. A more balanced tone would improve the score.
Total Score	20/30	This is a clear and relevant response with a useful example, but frequent language errors and some rough reasoning prevent it from reaching the high-score range.

Revised Version (Word Count: 169)

I think final exams should carry more weight than frequent small assignments, although assignments can still be useful for practice. I understand Student A's point that smaller tasks may reduce pressure, but take-home assignments do not always measure what students can do independently. Since students usually complete them outside class, some may exchange answers or rely too heavily on online tools. As a result, the grade may reflect outside help more than real understanding.

Final exams also give students enough time to develop a complete view of the subject. In difficult courses, students may not understand a topic immediately when the homework is due. For example, when I studied fluid mechanics, I struggled with one chapter at first, but after later lectures and review, the ideas finally became clear. If my grade had depended mainly on weekly assignments, that temporary confusion would have hurt me too much. Therefore, I believe final exams, supported by low-stakes homework, are the better grading method because they are fairer and reward final mastery.

My Notes:

It can't ... -> It may not ...

No hyphen is needed after an adverb ending in "-ly."

have no choice but to do something.

"Crude" sounds too negative or rude here. "A rough version" is natural.

carry more weight than

although assignments can still be useful for practice.

I believe A, supported by low-stakes B, are the better grading method because they are ...

16 AI Tools in Coursework

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Many courses now allow students to use artificial intelligence tools for brainstorming or checking language. Should universities allow students to use these tools for coursework, or should they restrict them?

Student A

I think AI tools should be allowed if students use them transparently. They can help students organize ideas and improve grammar, especially for non-native speakers.

Student B

I worry that students may depend on AI too much. If the tool generates most of the work, the assignment no longer shows what the student has learned.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:49; Saved At: 2026/5/19 15:36:24; Word Count: 162)

I think AI tools should be allowed rather than banned. As AI has been deeply developed nowadays, we need to learn how to use them instead of ignoring them. AI has many benefits, such as it may provide new aspect to your problem because it can integrate large amount of information ranging from historic antique to newly updated documents. Also, it can play a important role as a teacher who accompanies you all day and can answer all your questions. For example, when I was taking the course of python, I had a lot of difficulties such as grammar mistakes and program bugs. Since the teacher was busy, I could only inquire AI for revising my wrong code. It really did a good job, which not only correct my homework, but also taught me about new function uses. While AI is so helpful, not using it feels like the farmer don't use any tools to cultivate - it's a waste of time.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Overall Comment: This response clearly answers the question and supports the opinion with a personal example. The position is understandable: AI tools should be allowed because they help students learn more efficiently. However, the response does not fully address the most important conflict in the prompt: AI can help students, but it may also cause overdependence or academic dishonesty. In addition, several grammar and word-choice problems reduce clarity and make the writing sound less academic. The essay is relevant and readable, but it needs stronger balance, more precise vocabulary, and better sentence control to reach a high TOEFL score.

Major Problems

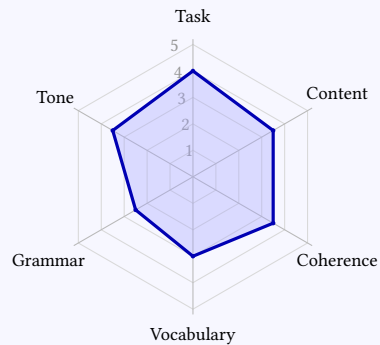
- (1) The essay supports AI use, but it barely discusses the necessary limits. The prompt asks whether universities should allow or restrict AI tools, so a high-scoring answer should explain why responsible use is acceptable while full replacement of student work is not.
- (2) The example about the Python course is useful, but it should be connected more directly to learning. The current version says AI corrected the homework, which may sound like AI completed the work for the student. It is better to say that AI explained the mistakes and helped the student understand the solution.

- (3) There are many grammar problems, such as article errors, subject–verb agreement errors, incorrect verb forms, and awkward collocations. These errors do not completely block meaning, but they make the response less polished.
- (4) Some expressions are too informal or inaccurate for academic writing. For example, “a teacher who accompanies you all day” and “the farmer don’t use any tools to cultivate” sound unnatural in this context.
- (5) The conclusion is too absolute. A stronger conclusion should say that universities should allow AI under clear rules, not simply that refusing AI is a waste of time.

Specific Problems and Corrections

Original Expression	Better Version	Reason
AI tools	AI tools	This is a spelling problem. “AI” means artificial intelligence, while “Al” looks like a name or a wrong abbreviation.
As AI has been deeply developed nowadays	Since AI has developed rapidly in recent years	“Deeply developed” is unnatural. “Nowadays” is also often unnecessary in academic writing.
provide new aspect to your problem	provide new perspectives on a problem	“Aspect” should usually be plural here, and the correct collocation is “perspectives on,” not “aspect to.”
large amount of information	a large amount of information / large amounts of information	An article is needed before “large amount.”
ranging from historic antique to newly updated documents	from historical materials to recent documents	“Historic antique” is not appropriate here. “Historical materials” is broader and more natural.
play a important role	play an important role	“Important” begins with a vowel sound, so the correct article is “an.”
a teacher who accompanies you all day	a learning assistant that is available at any time	The original wording is understandable but too informal and slightly unnatural.
the course of python	a Python course	Course names and programming languages should be expressed naturally. “Python” should be capitalized.
I could only inquire AI	I could only ask AI for help	“Inquire AI” is not idiomatic. We usually say “ask AI for help” or “use AI to check something.”
It really did a good job	It was very helpful	The original phrase is too conversational. The revised version is more academic and concise.
which not only correct my homework, but also taught me	which not only corrected my homework but also taught me	The verb should be in the past tense. Also, there should be no comma before “but also” in this structure.
new function uses	how to use new functions	“Function uses” is unnatural. The revised version directly states the meaning.
the farmer don’t use any tools	farmers refusing to use tools	“Farmer” and “don’t” do not agree. More importantly, the analogy is too informal for a TOEFL academic discussion.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	The response gives a clear opinion and stays on topic. However, it does not fully address the restriction side of the question, especially the problem of overdependence and transparency.
Content	3.5/5	The Python-course example is specific and relevant. Still, the argument is one-sided and should explain how universities can allow AI without letting students submit AI-generated work as their own.
Coherence	3.5/5	The response has a logical general-to-specific structure. However, the transitions are sometimes simple, and the final analogy does not connect smoothly to the academic discussion.
Vocabulary	3/5	Some useful expressions appear, such as “benefits” and “correct my homework,” but several phrases are unnatural, including “new aspect to your problem,” “historic antique,” “inquire AI,” and “function uses.”
Grammar	2.5/5	Grammar is the weakest part. There are repeated article errors, verb-form errors, agreement errors, and awkward sentence structures. These errors reduce fluency and precision.
Tone	3.5/5	The tone is mostly appropriate, but some phrases are too casual or exaggerated for an academic discussion, especially the final farmer analogy.
Total Score	20/30	A relevant and understandable response with a clear position, but it needs stronger balance, more academic wording, and fewer grammar errors.

How to Improve This Essay

- (1) Add a concession: admit that AI can be harmful if students let it produce the whole assignment.
- (2) Add a rule-based solution: universities should require students to disclose AI use and explain their own reasoning.
- (3) Make the example show learning rather than replacement. Say that AI explained bugs and helped you understand the code, not just that it corrected your homework.
- (4) Replace informal expressions with academic ones. For example, use “learning assistant,” “clear guidelines,” “academic integrity,” and “responsible use.”
- (5) End with a balanced conclusion: AI should not be banned completely, but it should be allowed under clear restrictions.

Revised Version (Word Count: 174)

I believe universities should allow students to use AI tools in coursework, but only under clear rules. As the first speaker suggests, these tools can help students organize ideas and check language, which is especially valuable for non-native speakers. In my Python course, for example, I often used AI to locate

grammar errors in my code and explain why a function did not work. This did not replace my learning; instead, it helped me understand the problem faster than waiting several days for feedback.

However, I agree with the second speaker that unrestricted use would be dangerous. If a student asks AI to write an entire essay or solve an assignment directly, the final work no longer reflects that student's ability. Therefore, universities should require students to disclose how they used AI and should design assignments that ask for personal reasoning, drafts, or oral explanations. In this way, AI becomes a learning assistant rather than a shortcut. Banning it completely would be unrealistic, but allowing it responsibly can improve both efficiency and learning.

My Notes:

Like calculators in mathematics courses, AI tools should not replace students' thinking, but they can support the learning process when used properly.

the correct collocation is "perspectives on," not "aspect to."

"Inquire AI" is not idiomatic. We usually say "ask AI for help" or "use AI to check something."

17 Courses Outside the Major

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Some universities encourage students to take courses outside their major, while others want students to focus mostly on specialized courses. Which policy is more valuable for students?

Student A

Taking courses outside the major is valuable because it broadens students' thinking. For example, engineering students may benefit from communication or economics courses.

Student B

Specialization is more important because students need strong professional knowledge. Too many unrelated courses may distract students from their main goals.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 15:25; Overtime: +05:25; Saved At: 2026/5/21 14:36:03; Word Count: 176)

Universities are different from high schools. While students need to learn specific lessons in high schools, they should have the chance to take courses that they are interested in. For instance, I would like to attend some music class though I'm majoring in math. Singing songs has been my hobby since I'm young. Taking such courses doesn't occupy too much time, but it truly benefits a lot, such as help releasing my stress and leading me getting more focused instead of distracted. Last year, when I was preparing the final exam and feeling overwhelmed and breathless. Then my music teacher taught me a new song about life, which impressed me. From the lyrics "live for your own", I suddenly realized that there was no need to compare with others, just to endeavor and try my best. Then I calmed down and finally earned a good score in the final exam in major. Extracurricular and unrelated courses actually doesn't conflict with the specialized courses. Instead, they might be enlightening in some way if you treat them seriously.⁷

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 17/30

Overall Comment:

This response is relevant to the topic and gives a clear personal position: students should be allowed to take courses outside their major. The personal example about a music course is understandable and somewhat effective. However, under strict TOEFL timing, the gray overtime part would not count. As a result, the official timed response ends before the main idea is fully completed. The essay also spends too much space on one personal story and does not sufficiently explain the broader academic value of non-major courses. There are several noticeable grammar and word-choice problems, such as incorrect tense, awkward verb patterns, sentence fragments, and subject-verb agreement errors.

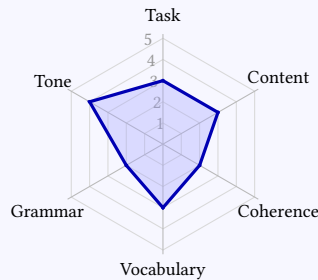
If the overtime part were counted, the response would probably be around **20/30**, because the ending becomes clearer. However, for a real TOEFL-style evaluation, the official score should be based mainly on the content completed within the time limit.

⁷The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

Major Problems

- (1) The official timed response is incomplete. The sentence “there was no need to compare” is only completed in the gray overtime section. In a real TOEFL setting, this would make the ending feel unfinished.
- (2) The argument is too personal and not academic enough. The music-course example is relevant, but the essay mainly discusses stress relief. The prompt asks which university policy is more valuable, so the answer should also discuss academic or career-related benefits.
- (3) The response does not sufficiently address the opposite view. The second student argues that specialization is important. A stronger answer should admit this concern and then explain why a balanced policy is better than pure specialization.
- (4) Several grammar errors reduce clarity. For example, “has been my hobby since I’m young,” “such as help releasing my stress,” “leading me getting more focused,” and “courses actually doesn’t conflict” are all grammatically incorrect or unnatural.
- (5) Some expressions are too informal or vague for a high-scoring TOEFL response. For example, “specific lessons,” “music class,” “occupy too much time,” and “feeling overwhelmed and breathless” should be replaced with more natural academic expressions.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3/5	The response answers the question and clearly supports taking courses outside the major. However, the official timed version is incomplete because the ending appears mainly in the overtime section.
Content	3/5	The music-course example is specific and relevant, but the explanation is narrow. It focuses mainly on stress relief instead of showing broader educational value, such as communication skills, interdisciplinary thinking, or career preparation.
Coherence	2/5	The general direction is understandable, but the structure is weak. The response has a long personal example, an incomplete ending, and limited discussion of the opposing view.
Vocabulary	3/5	The vocabulary is sufficient for basic meaning, with useful words such as “overwhelmed,” “distracted,” and “enlightening.” However, several phrases are unnatural, such as “specific lessons,” “occupy too much time,” and “leading me getting more focused.”
Grammar	2/5	There are multiple noticeable errors in tense, word form, sentence structure, and subject–verb agreement. These errors do not completely block understanding, but they clearly lower the score.
Tone	4/5	The tone is appropriate and sincere. However, it could sound more academic by reducing emotional wording and connecting the personal example more directly to university education.
Total Score	17/30	This is a relevant but only partially successful response. To reach 25+, the essay needs a complete timed ending, fewer grammar errors, stronger academic reasoning, and a clearer response to the specialization argument.

Sentence-level Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
Universities are different from high schools.	This opening is too general and does not directly answer the policy question.	Unlike high school students, university students should have some freedom to explore subjects beyond their major.
specific lessons in high schools	“Lessons” is not the best word here, and “high schools” is unnatural in this general statement.	specific subjects in high school
some music class	“Some” sounds vague. Use “a” or a plural form.	a music class / music courses
though I’m majoring in math	Grammatically understandable, but a little informal.	although my major is mathematics
Singing songs has been my hobby since I’m young.	Wrong tense. “Since” requires a past starting point.	Singing has been my hobby since I was young.
such as help releasing my stress	After “such as,” use a noun phrase or gerund.	such as helping me relieve stress
leading me getting more focused	Wrong verb pattern.	helping me become more focused
when I was preparing the final exam	Students prepare for an exam, not prepare the exam.	when I was preparing for my final exam
feeling overwhelmed and breathless	“Breathless” is too physical and dramatic here.	feeling overwhelmed and exhausted
courses actually doesn’t conflict	Subject–verb agreement error. “Courses” is plural, so use “do not.”	these courses do not conflict with specialized courses
they might be enlightening in some way	The meaning is acceptable, but it is too vague for a high score.	they can give students new perspectives and make their major studies more meaningful

Revised Version (Word Count: 162)

I believe universities should encourage students to take a limited number of courses outside their major, rather than requiring them to study only specialized subjects. I agree with the first view that such courses broaden students’ thinking. For example, an engineering student who studies communication may learn how to explain a technical design to clients or teammates, while an economics course can help the same student understand the market value of a new product. These abilities do not replace professional knowledge; they make it more useful in real situations.

I understand the concern that unrelated courses may distract students from their main goals, but this problem can be avoided if universities set a reasonable limit, such as one or two elective courses each semester. In my case, a music course helped me relax during exam season and return to my major courses with better concentration. Therefore, the most valuable policy is balanced: students should build deep expertise while also gaining broader perspectives.

18 Student-Chosen Essay Topics

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

In some classes, students are allowed to choose their own essay topics. In others, the instructor assigns the same topic to everyone. Which approach do you think leads to better learning?

Student A

I prefer choosing my own topic because I feel more motivated when I can connect the assignment to my interests.

Student B

Assigned topics are fairer because everyone works with the same level of difficulty, and the instructor can compare essays more easily.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 12:38; Overtime: +02:38; Saved At: 2026/5/22 21:35:03; Word Count: 145)

Allowing students to choose their own interested essay topics can inspire students to dive into the assignments more devotedly. That said, the choice should be limited in a given range. The given directions could prevent the possibility of diversion. Some students might not attend the class as expected, and they don't even know what's the main point of this lecture. Also, given topics prevent students to use an essay for several related lessons. For instance, one of the students in my "Elastic Mechanics" class handed in an essay about "Fluid Simulation in Elastic Pipes". But then the professor found out that the passage was not so strictly related to his class. After investigation, the essay finally turned out to be copied from another lecture "Fluid Mechanics" the student took. Overall, given topics are necessary, while students still have choice to pick in a limited range.⁸

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 16/30

Note on Timing: The strict score is based only on the text written within the ten-minute limit. The gray part was written after time expired, so it should not be counted under real TOEFL conditions. If the gray part is included, the response would be around **18/30**; however, under strict timing, the response is incomplete and the final argument is not fully delivered.

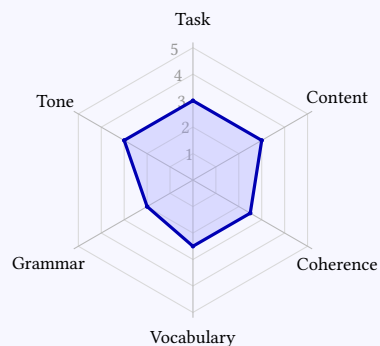
Overall Comment: This response has a reasonable central idea: students should have some freedom, but their choices should be limited by the instructor. This is a good and balanced position. However, the response is weakened by unclear wording, several grammar mistakes, and an underdeveloped example. The biggest problem is that the valid timed response ends with an unfinished sentence, so the conclusion and final reasoning are not fully available within the official time limit. The idea is promising, but the execution is not yet fluent or complete enough for a high TOEFL score.

Major Problems

⁸The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

- (1) The response does not clearly answer the question at the beginning. It first supports student choice, then shifts to assigned or limited topics. The final position is understandable, but it should be stated more directly.
- (2) The main example is too complicated and slightly indirect. The story about a student copying from another course shows a problem with unrestricted topics, but it does not clearly explain how learning improves.
- (3) Several expressions are unnatural, such as “own interested essay topics,” “dive into the assignments more devotedly,” and “possibility of diversion.”
- (4) There are grammar problems with verb patterns and noun choices, especially “prevent students to use,” which should be “prevent students from using.”
- (5) The timed version is incomplete because the sentence ends with “copied from.” In a real TOEFL test, an unfinished ending would significantly hurt the score.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3/5	The response addresses the topic and gives a reasonable position, but the stance is not stated clearly enough at the beginning. The timed response also ends before the final point is complete.
Content	3/5	The answer contains a relevant idea: complete freedom may lead students away from course goals. However, the example focuses more on copying and course mismatch than on learning outcomes.
Coherence	2.5/5	The general logic is understandable, but the progression is not smooth. The response moves from motivation to off-topic writing to plagiarism without fully explaining the connection.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	Some vocabulary choices are understandable but unnatural. Phrases such as “interested essay topics,” “dive into assignments more devotedly,” and “diversion” should be replaced with more natural academic expressions.
Grammar	2/5	There are several noticeable grammatical errors, including incorrect verb patterns, word order problems, and awkward noun choices. These errors sometimes reduce clarity.
Tone	3/5	The tone is mostly academic and appropriate, but some informal or imprecise expressions make the writing less polished.
Total Score	16/30	The response has a valid central idea but needs clearer structure, more natural language, stronger development, and a complete timed ending.

Specific Problems and Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Suggested Revision
students to choose their own interested essay topics	"Interested" describes people, not topics.	students to choose essay topics that interest them
dive into the assignments more devotedly	Unnatural collocation.	engage with the assignments more deeply
limited in a given range	Awkward expression.	limited to a clearly defined range
prevent the possibility of diversion	"Diversion" is not the natural word for "go off topic" here.	prevent students from going off topic
what's the main point of this lecture	The prompt is about classes and essay assignments, not one lecture. Also, the word order is informal.	what the main purpose of the course or assignment is
prevent students to use an essay	Incorrect verb pattern. "Prevent" should be followed by "from doing."	prevent students from using the same essay
one of the students	Grammatically possible, but too wordy in this context.	a student
the passage was not so strictly related to his class	Unnatural and imprecise.	the essay was not closely related to the course
the essay finally turned out to be copied from...	The timed version is incomplete. This seriously hurts coherence.	the essay turned out to have been adapted from another course
given topics are necessary	"Given topics" is understandable but not the best academic phrasing.	instructor-guided topics are necessary
students still have choice to pick	Missing article and awkward repetition.	students should still have some choices

How to Improve This Response

- (1) State the position clearly in the first sentence. For example: "I think students learn best when they can choose topics within a framework set by the instructor."
- (2) Do not spend too much space on a complicated example. In TOEFL Academic Discussion writing, one clear and directly relevant example is better than a long story.
- (3) Connect every example back to learning. Do not only say that unrestricted topics cause unfairness or plagiarism; explain that instructor guidance keeps students focused on the course objective.
- (4) Use safer and more natural expressions. For example, use "go off topic" instead of "diversion," and "engage more deeply" instead of "dive into assignments more devotedly."
- (5) Leave at least one sentence for a conclusion within the time limit. An unfinished final sentence can lower the score even if the earlier ideas are acceptable.

Revised Version (Word Count: 153)

I think students learn best when they can choose their own essay topics within a clearly defined framework set by the instructor. Complete freedom may sound motivating, but it can easily lead students away from the purpose of the course. On the other hand, assigning exactly the same topic to everyone may make grading easier, but it can also reduce students' curiosity.

A limited-choice model combines the strengths of both approaches. For example, in an engineering mechanics class, the instructor might require everyone to analyze a concept related to elasticity, but students could choose cases such as bridge cables, aircraft wings, or soft robots. In this way, each student still practices the same academic skill and meets the same learning objective, while also connecting the essay to a personal interest.

Therefore, I agree partly with both students. Choice increases motivation, but instructor guidance is necessary to keep the assignment fair, focused, and educational.

Why the Revised Version Can Receive 30/30

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 30/30

- (1) The position is clear from the first sentence: students should choose topics, but only within an instructor-defined framework.
- (2) The essay directly responds to both sides of the discussion: motivation from student choice and fairness from assigned topics.
- (3) The example is specific, academic, and relevant. It uses an engineering mechanics class to show how limited choice can improve learning.
- (4) The logic is complete: unrestricted choice may cause loss of focus; fully assigned topics may reduce motivation; limited choice solves both problems.
- (5) The language is natural and concise, with strong expressions such as “clearly defined framework,” “learning objective,” and “connecting the essay to a personal interest.”
- (6) The conclusion is short but effective, reinforcing the balanced position.

19 Required Internships

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Some people argue that universities should require students to complete internships before graduation. Others believe internships should be optional. What is your view?

Student A

Required internships help students understand real workplaces and make better career plans before they graduate.

Student B

Internships should be optional because some students may need the summer for research, family responsibilities, or required courses.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:47; Saved At: 2026/5/26 18:48:46; Word Count: 138)

Internship should be optional because it is unnecessary for everyone to attend one. For instance, not every student will apply for a company after graduation. Some students will keep on studying, while some will be freelancer. Even for those who are going to the enterprise, they might find a job that is not related with their own major. One of my senior student, who is major in physics, finally be an YouTuber running his own channel. So for these people, internships shouldn't be obliged. Also, forced internships would bring involution to college. Students would be overwhelmed if they are always comparing with each other. If someone got an internship that is not so good, they might be discriminated and mocked. So when talking about internship, personal situations and social factors should be counted, instead of just a requirement.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Overall Comment:

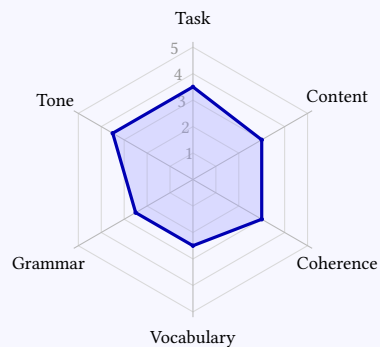
Your response has a clear position: internships should be optional. You also provide two understandable reasons: not all students need corporate internships, and mandatory internships may create extra pressure. However, the essay is still far from a high-scoring TOEFL response. The main weaknesses are insufficient development, weak explanation of examples, unnatural word choice, and frequent grammar errors. To reach a higher score, you need to make your reasoning more specific, use more natural academic expressions, and reduce basic grammatical mistakes.

Major Problems

- (1) The position is clear, but the reasoning is not fully developed. You mention that some students may not need internships, but you do not explain enough why research, coursework, family responsibilities, or other plans may be more valuable than an internship.
- (2) The example is not persuasive enough. The example of a physics student becoming a YouTuber could work, but you need to explain more clearly how this example proves that mandatory internships are unsuitable for everyone.

- (3) Several expressions are unnatural or non-idiomatic, such as “attend an internship,” “apply for a company,” “be freelancer,” “enterprise,” “involution,” and “internships shouldn’t be obliged.”
- (4) There are many noticeable grammar errors involving singular/plural forms, verb forms, articles, and prepositions. These errors do not completely block understanding, but they significantly lower the language score.
- (5) The tone is sometimes too absolute or emotional. For example, “discriminated and mocked” sounds exaggerated. A more academic expression would be “feel unnecessary pressure” or “compare themselves with others.”

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	3.5/5	The response clearly answers the prompt and presents a definite opinion. However, it does not fully respond to the opposing view that internships help students understand real workplaces and plan careers.
Content	3.0/5	The essay includes reasons and an example, but the example is underdeveloped. The YouTuber example needs a clearer connection to the argument that mandatory internships are not suitable for every student.
Coherence	3.0/5	The basic structure is understandable, but the logical progression is somewhat rushed. More transition phrases such as “However,” “Moreover,” “For this reason,” and “Therefore” would improve coherence.
Vocabulary	2.5/5	The essay communicates the basic meaning, but several word choices are unnatural, including “attend one,” “apply for a company,” “enterprise,” “involution,” and “obliged.”
Grammar	2.5/5	There are many noticeable errors, such as “some will be freelancer,” “who is major in physics,” “finally be an YouTuber,” and “related with.” These mistakes lower the language score.
Tone	3.5/5	The tone is generally appropriate for an academic discussion, but some expressions, such as “discriminated and mocked,” sound too emotional or exaggerated.
Total Score	18/30	The essay is understandable and has a clear opinion, but the argument is not sufficiently developed, and the language contains too many grammar and vocabulary problems for a high score.

Specific Error Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression	Reason
Internship should be optional	Internships should be optional	The essay is discussing internships as a general policy, so the plural form is more natural.
attend one	complete one / do one	“Attend” is usually used for classes, meetings, or events. For internships, “complete an internship” or “do an internship” is more natural.
apply for a company	work for a company / apply to a company	“Apply for” is usually followed by a position, such as “apply for a job.” When referring to a company, use “apply to a company.”
some will be freelancer	some will become freelancers	“Freelancer” is a countable noun. It needs an article or a plural form. Here, “become freelancers” is the most natural choice.
going to the enterprise	planning to work in industry	“Enterprise” is unnatural in this context. “Work in industry” is a better way to describe working for companies after graduation.
related with their own major	related to their major	The correct collocation is “related to,” not “related with.”
One of my senior student	One of my senior schoolmates / One senior student I know	After “one of,” the noun should be plural. Also, “senior schoolmate” sounds more natural than “senior student” here.
who is major in physics	who is majoring in physics / who is a physics major	When “major” is used as a verb, the correct form is “majoring in.” You can also use the noun phrase “a physics major.”
finally be an YouTuber	eventually became a YouTuber	“Finally be” is grammatically incorrect. Also, “YouTuber” takes “a,” not “an,” because it begins with a consonant sound.
internships shouldn’t be obliged	internships should not be mandatory	“Obliged” usually describes people, not internships. “Mandatory” is the correct word for a required policy.
bring involution to college	create unhealthy competition on campus	“Involution” is a direct translation from Chinese and is not natural in this context. “Unhealthy competition” expresses the idea more clearly.
not so good	low-quality / less prestigious	“Not so good” is too informal and vague. A TOEFL essay should use more precise vocabulary.
should be counted	should be taken into account	The fixed expression is “take something into account.”

How to Improve This Essay

- (1) Make the main position more precise. Instead of simply saying that internships should be optional, say that they should be optional but strongly supported by universities.
- (2) Add balance to the argument. First admit that internships are useful for many students, and then explain why they should not be mandatory for everyone.

- (3) Use a more academic and general example. For instance, a physics major who plans to apply to graduate school may benefit more from research experience than from a short corporate internship.
- (4) Avoid direct translations from Chinese. For example, replace “involution” with “unhealthy competition” or “unnecessary pressure.”
- (5) End with a practical policy suggestion. For example, universities could offer several choices, such as internships, research projects, community service, or career workshops.

Revised Version (Word Count: 153)

I agree more with the second student that internships should remain optional, although universities should strongly support them. The first student makes a reasonable point: real workplace experience can help students test a career path before graduation. However, making internships mandatory would ignore the very different goals students have. For example, a physics major who plans to apply for graduate school may benefit more from spending the summer in a research lab than from taking a short corporate internship unrelated to his field. Other students may need that time for required courses, family responsibilities, or exam preparation.

A better policy is to provide flexible forms of career preparation. Students could choose among internships, research projects, community work, or professional workshops, depending on their plans. This approach keeps the practical value of internships without turning them into a bureaucratic requirement. Therefore, internships should be optional but strongly encouraged and well supported by the university.

20 Useful Guest Speakers (Rewritten)

Task Type: Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Professor

Universities often invite guest speakers from industry, government, or research institutions. What type of guest speaker would be most useful for students, and why?

Student A

I think industry speakers are the most useful because they can explain what skills employers actually expect from graduates.

Student B

Researchers are more helpful because they show students how knowledge is created and may inspire them to pursue graduate study.

Task

Write a response that gives your opinion and supports it with specific reasons or examples. You may refer to the ideas of the professor or the students.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:52; Saved At: 2026/5/30 15:42:11; Word Count: 131)

Among various guest speakers invited to the universities, I think researchers are the most useful for us students. Universities are somewhere for students to gain new knowledge and learn to do research, while the researchers' lecture properly meet this requirement. They could not only bring the most updated and cutting-edge investigations, but also share their own research experiences. Last year, a professor who had won a Nobel Prize from other country came to our university to share his success. From his speech I realized that no one was born to be successful. Instead, his thousands of failure in different area. His word really inspired me a lot in a researcher's perspective. Also, inviting different researchers to university can elevate international fame and promote connections. So researchers are really helpful to universities.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Overall Comment: The response answers the question directly and chooses a clear position: researchers are the most useful guest speakers. The essay also gives a relevant reason: researchers can show students cutting-edge work and share research experience. However, the development is still limited, and several grammar mistakes make some sentences unclear or incomplete. The example about the Nobel Prize professor is useful, but it needs to explain more clearly what the speaker said and how it helped students. Overall, this is a relevant but linguistically unstable response, so it is around the middle range rather than the high range.

Major Problems

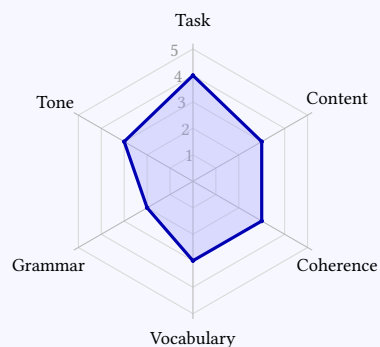
- (1) The main idea is clear, but the explanation is not deep enough. You say researchers are useful because they bring cutting-edge knowledge, but you should explain how this benefits students, such as helping them understand research methods, failure, persistence, and graduate study.
- (2) Some sentences have serious grammatical errors. For example, "Instead, his thousands of failure in different area" is not a complete sentence. It lacks a verb and has noun-number problems.

- (3) Several expressions are unnatural. For example, “Universities are somewhere” should be changed to “Universities are places where,” and “the most updated investigations” should be changed to “the latest research” or “cutting-edge discoveries.”
- (4) The example is too vague. A Nobel Prize winner is a strong example, but you need to describe the lesson more specifically instead of only saying that he “shared his success.”
- (5) The final point about improving the university’s international fame is relevant to universities, but the prompt asks what is useful for students. You should connect this point back to students, such as future academic exchange, collaboration, or research opportunities.

Specific Corrections

- (1) Original: “Universities are somewhere for students to gain new knowledge and learn to do research.”
Better: “Universities are places where students gain new knowledge and learn how to conduct research.”
Reason: “somewhere” is too vague and informal here. “places where” is more natural.
- (2) Original: “the researchers’ lecture properly meet this requirement.”
Better: “researchers’ lectures directly meet this need.”
Reason: The subject is plural, so the verb should be “meet,” but “lecture” must also be plural. “Properly meet” is unnatural; “directly meet” is better.
- (3) Original: “the most updated and cutting-edge investigations”
Better: “the latest and most cutting-edge research”
Reason: “Most updated” is not a natural academic expression. “Research” is more appropriate than “investigations” in this context.
- (4) Original: “a professor who had won a Nobel Prize from other country”
Better: “a Nobel Prize-winning professor from another country”
Reason: “from other country” is grammatically wrong. Use “from another country.”
- (5) Original: “Instead, his thousands of failure in different area.”
Better: “Instead, he experienced thousands of failures in different areas before achieving success.”
Reason: The original is a sentence fragment. It needs a subject, a verb, and correct plural nouns.
- (6) Original: “His word really inspired me a lot in a researcher’s perspective.”
Better: “His words inspired me to think from a researcher’s perspective.”
Reason: “words” should be plural, and “in a perspective” is unnatural. Use “from a perspective.”
- (7) Original: “So researchers are really helpful to universities.”
Better: “Therefore, researchers are highly beneficial guest speakers in a university setting.”
Reason: “So” and “really helpful” sound too casual for TOEFL academic writing.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	The response clearly chooses researchers as the most useful guest speakers and stays on topic. However, it does not fully compare researchers with industry or government speakers.
Content	3/5	The ideas are relevant, especially the points about cutting-edge knowledge and research experience. However, the support is general, and the Nobel Prize example is not developed enough.
Coherence	3/5	The essay has a basic structure, moving from opinion to reasons to example. However, the transition from personal inspiration to university fame is not smooth, and one sentence fragment breaks the logic.
Vocabulary	3/5	There are some useful academic words, such as “cutting-edge,” “research experiences,” and “promote connections.” However, several collocations are unnatural, such as “most updated investigations” and “in a researcher’s perspective.”
Grammar	2/5	Frequent grammar problems affect clarity. Major issues include sentence fragments, subject-verb agreement, singular/plural errors, and incorrect prepositions.
Tone	3/5	The tone is generally appropriate, but phrases like “really helpful” and “for us students” are slightly informal. A more academic style would improve the response.
Total Score	18/30	Clear position and relevant ideas, but grammar errors and insufficient development prevent the essay from reaching a high TOEFL score.

Revised Version (Words Count: 167)

I agree that researchers are the most useful guest speakers for university students, although industry speakers can also provide practical career advice. The main reason is that researchers show students how knowledge is actually created. In regular classes, students often receive finished theories and conclusions, but a good research speaker can explain the uncertainty, failed attempts, and persistence behind a discovery. This helps students understand that research is not just about talent, but also about asking precise questions and improving an idea step by step.

For example, if a physicist or engineer visits a university and describes how one project failed many times before producing a publishable result, students may become less afraid of difficulty in their own studies. Such a talk is especially valuable for undergraduates who are deciding whether to pursue graduate school. In addition, inviting researchers from different countries or institutions can broaden students’ academic vision and create opportunities for future collaboration. Therefore, researchers are the most beneficial guest speakers for a university setting.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 11:37; Overtime: +01:37; Saved At: 2026/5/31 23:54:17; Word Count: 115)

I agree that researchers are more useful for us students, although industry speakers can share their working skills. For university students, learning new knowledge and leading research are the prior aims. Researchers’ reports directly meet these needs. Students could not only understand how researchers’ programs were completed, but also learn how many failures researchers have experienced before the final successful result. For example, a Nobel-Prize-winning professor came to our university last year. He shared the moments that he didn’t get results as expected after months of hard work and nearly abandoned his progress. However, he persisted trying some other methods and finally formed a satisfying output. From his experience, I thought of myself and not⁹

⁹The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 16/30

Overall Comment: The response answers the question and presents a clear position: researchers are more useful guest speakers for university students. The example of a Nobel-Prize-winning professor is relevant, and it shows that the writer understands the value of research experience. However, the response is clearly unfinished. The last sentence stops in the middle, which seriously weakens the coherence and completeness of the essay. In addition, the explanation is not deep enough, and several expressions are unnatural or grammatically inaccurate. Overall, the response has a clear idea, but its language control and development are not strong enough for a higher score.

Major Problems

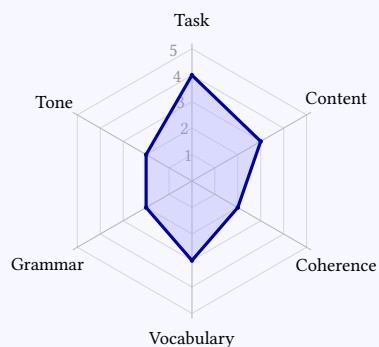
- (1) The response has a clear opinion, but the supporting explanation is too limited. It says researchers are useful, but it does not fully explain how their talks help students academically.
- (2) The final sentence is incomplete: "From his experience, I thought of myself and not..." This makes the essay feel unfinished and causes a serious coherence problem.
- (3) Some expressions are unnatural, such as "the prior aims," "researchers' reports," and "formed a satisfying output."
- (4) The example is relevant but not fully developed. The writer should explain more clearly what lesson students can learn from the professor's experience.
- (5) The conclusion is missing. A complete final sentence is necessary to summarize the argument.

Specific Corrections

- (1) Original: "I agree that researchers are more useful for us students"
Better: "I agree that researchers are more useful for university students."
Reason: "Us students" is informal and awkward in academic writing.
- (2) Original: "learning new knowledge and leading research are the prior aims"
Better: "learning new ideas and conducting research are among the main goals."
Reason: "Learning new knowledge" and "leading research" are unnatural. "Prior aims" is also not idiomatic.
- (3) Original: "Researchers' reports directly meet these needs."
Better: "Researchers' talks directly meet these needs."
Reason: "Reports" usually refers to written documents. Since the topic is guest speakers, "talks" is more appropriate.
- (4) Original: "researchers' programs were completed"
Better: "research projects are completed"
Reason: "Programs" is not the best word here. Academic work is usually called "research projects."
- (5) Original: "how many failures researchers have experienced"
Better: "how many setbacks researchers often experience"
Reason: "Setbacks" sounds more natural and academic than "failures" in this context.
- (6) Original: "He shared the moments that he didn't get results as expected"
Better: "He talked about times when he did not get the results he expected"
Reason: "The moments that" is unnatural. "Times when" is more idiomatic.
- (7) Original: "nearly abandoned his progress"
Better: "nearly gave up on the project"
Reason: We do not usually say "abandon progress." The natural expression is "give up on the project."
- (8) Original: "he persisted trying some other methods"
Better: "he kept trying different methods"
Reason: "Persisted trying" is awkward. "Kept trying" is simpler and more natural.
- (9) Original: "finally formed a satisfying output"
Better: "finally achieved a satisfactory result"
Reason: "Formed a satisfying output" is unnatural and sounds translated from Chinese.

- (10) Original: "From his experience, I thought of myself and not"
 Better: "His experience reminded me not to give up easily when I face difficulties in my own studies."
 Reason: The original sentence is incomplete and needs a clear ending.

Detailed Evaluation



Criterion	Score	Comment
Task	4/5	The response clearly chooses researchers as the most useful guest speakers and stays on topic.
Content	3/5	The main idea and example are relevant, but the explanation is not fully developed. The essay needs to explain more clearly how researchers' experience benefits students.
Coherence	2/5	The basic structure is understandable, but the unfinished final sentence seriously damages the flow and completeness of the response.
Vocabulary	3/5	The vocabulary is understandable, but several word choices are unnatural, such as "prior aims," "programs," and "satisfying output."
Grammar	2/5	There are several grammar and collocation problems. The incomplete final sentence is the most serious issue.
Tone	2/5	The tone is mostly acceptable, but some expressions are informal or awkward, such as "us students." The unfinished ending also weakens the academic tone.
Total Score	16/30	The response has a clear position and a relevant example, but limited development, unnatural expressions, grammar problems, and an incomplete ending keep it in the lower-middle range.

Revised Version (Words Count: 145)

I agree that researchers are the most useful guest speakers for university students, although industry speakers can also share practical workplace skills. The main reason is that researchers can show students how knowledge is created. In regular classes, students usually learn finished theories, but researchers can explain the questions, failures, and repeated attempts behind a discovery.

For example, a Nobel Prize-winning professor visited our university last year. He said that he once worked for months without getting the expected results and almost gave up on the project. However, he kept trying different methods and finally achieved a meaningful result. His experience reminded me that research requires patience and persistence. It also encouraged me not to give up easily when I face difficulties in my own studies. Therefore, researchers can inspire students in a deep and meaningful way.

Part III — Model Response Comparison

Overview

This part is designed for comparison between your own TOEFL writing responses and high-quality model responses. It includes complete examples of both Email Writing and Academic Discussion tasks, allowing you to examine differences in structure, language use, tone, clarity, and idea development.

The prompts and model responses are sourced from [TOEFLResources.com](https://www.toeflresources.com), which provides authentic examples of TOEFL writing responses. Figure 2 shows a screenshot from the website homepage.

Guidance

- Read the prompt carefully and write your own response first.
- Compare your response with the model response in terms of organization, grammar, vocabulary, and task fulfillment.
- Identify useful expressions, sentence structures, and transitions from the model response.

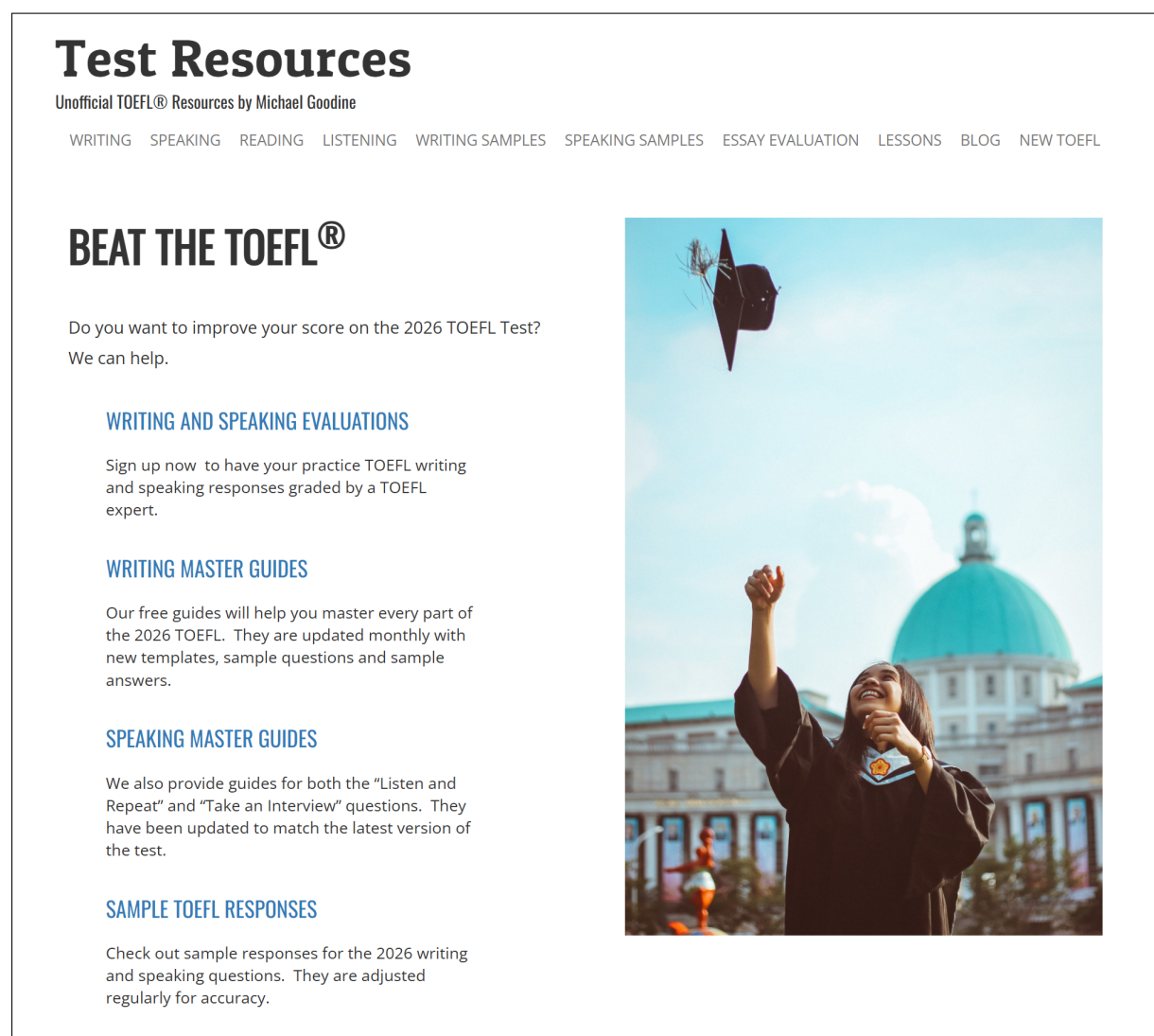


Fig. 2. Screenshot of the homepage of [TOEFLResources](https://www.toeflresources.com).

21 Missed Quiz (Rewritten)

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You are enrolled in Professor Lastman's European History course, which meets on Tuesdays and Thursdays. You were absent last Thursday because of a scheduled medical appointment, and as a result you missed a short in-class quiz that counts toward your participation grade.

Write an email to your professor. In your email, do the following:

- Explain why you were absent and that you understand you missed the quiz.
- Ask whether you can make up the quiz or complete an alternate assignment.
- Ask if there is anything else you should review to stay caught up.

Original Response (Time Used: 08:35; Overtime: +01:35; Saved At: 2026/6/1 06:58:37; Word Count: 125)

Dear Lastman,

Hope this email finds you well.

I'm writing to explain my absence on European History course last Thursday due to the conflict of a scheduled medical appointment. Unfortunately, a short in-class quiz was taken in that class so I missed it either. While the quiz score will be counted in the participation grade of this class, I am kindly asking whether if I could make up for this. I would be really grateful if you could rearrange my exam and tell me the time. Also, if any alternative assignment could be done, that will also works to me.

I'll appreciate it if you could notify anything important or which I should remain aware in time. Thank you for your considering.

Best regards,

Baiming¹⁰

Model Response (Word Count: 137)

Hello Professor Lastman,

I am writing because unfortunately I missed last Thursday's history class due to a critical appointment at the university health clinic that I was unable to reschedule. I know that there was a quiz during the class which will impact my final participation grade. Would it be possible to complete a makeup quiz or some other assignment so that my grade is not affected by my absence? As you are aware, I plan to apply for graduate school next year, and I will need a high GPA to stay competitive. I have asked a classmate to share her notes from Thursday's session so that I do not fall behind due to my absence, but if there is anything else I should review to stay caught up, please let me know.

Thanks for your time and attention,

Clayton Yesavage

¹⁰The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18–20/30

Your response completes the main communicative purpose, but it loses points for grammar, word choice, tone, and time control. The message is understandable, yet several sentences sound unnatural or contain clear grammatical errors. Also, the final required point about reviewing missed material was written after the seven-minute limit, so the timed version would be considered incomplete.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Expression
Dear Lastman,	A professor should be addressed by title.	Dear Professor Lastman,
Hope this email finds you well.	Too informal without subject.	I hope this email finds you well.
my absence on European History course	Wrong preposition and article.	my absence from your European History course
due to the conflict of a scheduled medical appointment	Unnatural wording.	because of a scheduled medical appointment / due to a scheduling conflict with a medical appointment
a short in-class quiz was taken in that class	Unnatural passive structure.	there was a short in-class quiz during that class
so I missed it either	<i>Either</i> is used in negative agreement, not here.	so I missed it as well
the participation grade of this class	Awkward phrase.	my participation grade in this class
I am kindly asking whether if I could	Do not use both <i>whether</i> and <i>if</i> ; <i>kindly asking</i> is unnatural.	I would like to ask whether I could
make up for this	<i>Make up for</i> means compensate for a mistake; use <i>make up</i> for a quiz.	make up the quiz
rearrange my exam	A quiz is not an exam; <i>rearrange</i> is not natural here.	schedule a makeup quiz
that will also works to me	Subject–verb agreement error and wrong preposition.	that would also work for me
I'll appreciate it if you could notify anything important	Wrong tense and verb pattern.	I would appreciate it if you could let me know about anything important
which I should remain aware in time	Unnatural and grammatically incomplete.	anything I should review to stay caught up
Thank you for your considering.	Wrong noun form.	Thank you for your consideration.

Comparison with the Model Response

Compared with the model response, your email is less polished mainly in three areas. First, the model response is more specific and natural: it says the appointment was at the university health clinic and

could not be rescheduled, which makes the absence sound reasonable. Your phrase “due to the conflict of a scheduled medical appointment” is understandable, but less idiomatic.

Second, the model response has smoother logic. It moves from the absence, to the missed quiz, to the makeup request, and finally to catching up with class material. Your response includes these ideas, but the transitions are weaker, and the sentence about staying caught up was written after the time limit. In a timed TOEFL setting, this would reduce the score because one required task point is not fully completed within seven minutes.

Third, the model response uses a more appropriate academic tone. It is polite but direct: “Would it be possible to complete a makeup quiz or some other assignment?” Your sentence “I would be really grateful if you could rearrange my exam” sounds less precise because this was a short quiz, not an exam, and the professor is not necessarily expected to “rearrange” it.

Main Suggestions

For this type of email, focus on accuracy before complexity. Use simple but correct structures such as “I missed class because...”, “I understand that I missed...”, and “Would it be possible to...?” Also, keep the request modest: ask whether a makeup quiz or alternate assignment is possible, rather than sounding as if the professor should automatically arrange another exam. Finally, finish all required points before adding extra details, because an incomplete timed answer loses more points than a short but complete one.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 07:45; Overtime: +00:45; Saved At: 2026/6/1 07:38:55; Word Count: 126)

Dear Professor Lastman,

I hope this email finds you well.

I’m writing to spread my apologies due to the absence of the European History class last Thursday because of the conflict of a scheduled medical appointment. I understand that I missed a short in-class quiz which contributes to the final score by counting in the participation grade. Since I need to apply for a PhD next year, a better GPA is needed to stay competitive. So I wonder if I could complete a makeup quiz in another time, or any alternative assignment could substitute this quiz. I have lend my classmates’ notes to review the context of Thursday’s class. But if there’s anything I need to remain caught up, please let me know.

Best Regards,
Baiming¹¹

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 19/30

This score is based on a strict timed evaluation. If the gray overtime text is counted, the response would be around **21/30**. The main ideas are mostly present, but the response still has several noticeable grammar and word-choice errors. More importantly, the final required point about what to review was completed after the time limit, so the timed version is not fully complete.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

¹¹The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Original Expression	Problem	Better Expression
I'm writing to spread my apologies	Wrong verb choice.	I am writing to apologize
due to the absence of the European History class	Wrong structure; you were absent from class.	for my absence from your European History class
because of the conflict of a scheduled medical appointment	Unnatural wording.	because of a scheduling conflict with a medical appointment
a short in-class quiz which contributes to the final score	Awkward and overly complicated.	a short in-class quiz that counts toward my final grade
counting in the participation grade	Wrong preposition and phrase.	as part of my participation grade
a better GPA is needed to stay competitive	Passive and unnatural.	I need to maintain a strong GPA to stay competitive
So I wonder if I could	Too informal; sentence begins weakly.	Therefore, I was wondering whether I could
complete a makeup quiz in another time	Wrong preposition.	take a makeup quiz at another time
or any alternative assignment could substitute this quiz	Awkward structure.	or complete an alternate assignment instead
I have lend my classmates' notes	Wrong verb form and meaning. <i>Lend</i> means to give, not borrow.	I have borrowed a classmate's notes
review the context of Thursday's class	<i>Context</i> is not appropriate here.	review the material from Thursday's class
anything I need to remain caught up	Wrong phrase.	anything else I should review to stay caught up
Best Regards	Capitalization issue.	Best regards

Comparison with the Model Response

Compared with the model response, your answer is weaker mainly in language accuracy and naturalness. The model response uses simple but correct expressions, such as "I missed last Thursday's history class" and "Would it be possible to complete a makeup quiz or some other assignment?" Your response tries to express the same ideas, but phrases like "spread my apologies," "conflict of a scheduled medical appointment," and "substitute this quiz" sound unnatural.

Your organization is generally clear: you explain the absence, mention the missed quiz, ask for a makeup option, and try to ask about catching up. However, the last required point is partly outside the time limit. In a strict TOEFL-style evaluation, this matters because the task asks for three specific functions, and all of them should be completed within seven minutes.

Main Suggestions

For this type of email, prioritize correct and direct expressions. Use safe sentence patterns such as "I am writing to apologize for...", "I understand that I missed...", and "Would it be possible to...?" Avoid over-complex wording, because it often creates grammar errors. Also, finish the three required task points first, then add extra explanation only if time remains.

22 More Information from Speaker

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You attended a guest lecture on campus by Dr. Amina Rashid on Monday about how to stay productive and manage stress as a college student. You wanted to ask a follow-up question after the talk, but there were too many students waiting to speak with her.

Write an email to Dr. Rashid. In your email, do the following:

- Explain that you attended her lecture and briefly mention what you found especially helpful.
- Ask if she could share more information about the techniques she talked about.
- Ask if she has any suggestions for resources you could use to improve your study habits this semester.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:29; Overtime: +02:29; Saved At: 2026/6/1 23:27:58; Word Count: 147)

Dear Doctor Rashid,

I hope this email finds you well.

This Monday I have attended your inspiring lecture, which is about how to complete things efficiently and deal with stress. Your method of scheduling every day and keep things going as planned seemed really helpful to me. However, I was willing to ask some questions but unfortunately failed because of the limited time that day. I wonder how can you stay energetic and disciplined to the plan. Since I often abandoned during the plan, I want to know if you are using any applications to keep in track. Also, I need to apply for PhD next year, so GPA will be really important to me. Could you please give me some advice about how can I improve my study habits, so I can earn a higher GPA?

I really appreciate your time and consideration.

Best regards,

Baiming¹²

Model Response (Word Count: 144)

Hello Dr. Rashad,

I attended your lecture on Monday about managing stress, and enjoyed it quite a lot. Several of my classmates also enjoyed it, so I must thank you for taking the time to visit our campus and give such an inspiring presentation. All of us found your comments about dealing with exam-related anxiety particularly useful. If possible, could you share additional information about the strategies you mentioned during the talk? Perhaps you could pass along copies of the articles you referred to, or examples of how students have put certain strategies into practice. Moreover, I would really appreciate it if you could recommend some resources I could utilize to improve my study habits. Are there any books you would recommend? Or perhaps there are some websites I could check out for additional ideas.

Thank you very much for your time,

Michael Schertzer

¹²The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 17/30

This score is based mainly on the content completed within the **seven-minute time limit**. Your response mentions that you attended the lecture, identifies the topic, and explains one useful point. However, the response within the time limit is incomplete, and the request for resources to improve study habits appears mostly in the gray overtime section. If the overtime content were counted, the score would be around **20/30**.

1. Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
Dear Doctor Rashid	The salutation is unnatural in an email. Use the abbreviated title.	Dear Dr. Rashid,
This Monday I have attended your inspiring lecture	Wrong tense. A specific past time should not use the present perfect tense.	I attended your inspiring lecture this Monday
which is about how to complete things efficiently and deal with stress	The tense and wording are unnatural. The prompt says productivity and stress management.	which was about how to stay productive and manage stress
Your method of scheduling every day and keep things going as planned	Parallel structure error: <i>scheduling</i> and <i>keep</i> do not match.	Your method of planning each day and keeping tasks on schedule
I was willing to ask some questions	<i>Was willing to</i> means “was willing,” not “wanted to.”	I wanted to ask some follow-up questions
but unfortunately failed because of the limited time	<i>Failed</i> sounds too strong and unnatural here. The reason should be clearer.	but I was unable to do so because many students were waiting to speak with you
I wonder how can you stay energetic	Incorrect word order in an indirect question.	I wonder how you stay energetic
disciplined to the plan	Unnatural collocation.	disciplined enough to follow a plan
I often abandoned during the plan	Incorrect verb use; the sentence lacks a proper object.	I often abandon my plans halfway
keep in track	Incorrect fixed expression.	keep on track
apply for PhD next year	Missing article; the phrase is incomplete.	apply for a PhD program next year
Could you please give me some advice about how can I improve my study habits	Incorrect word order in an indirect question.	Could you please give me some advice about how I can improve my study habits

2. Comparison with the Model Response

Compared with the model response, your answer is weaker mainly in **task completion, specificity, and naturalness**. The model response clearly covers all three required points: it says the speaker’s comments

on exam-related anxiety were useful, asks for additional information about the strategies, and requests concrete resources such as articles, examples, books, and websites. Your response asks about discipline and apps, but the request is less clearly connected to “the techniques she talked about.” Also, your final request about improving study habits appears after the seven-minute limit, so it would not fully count in a strict TOEFL situation.

Your tone is generally polite, but the sentence about applying for a PhD and needing a high GPA sounds a little too personal and goal-oriented for a short follow-up email to a guest speaker. A better approach would be to keep the focus on academic habits this semester, such as recommended books, websites, apps, or daily planning methods. The model response is also more concise and easier to answer because each request is specific.

One small issue in the model response is that it writes *Dr. Rashad*, while the prompt says *Dr. Rashid*. This spelling mistake should not be copied.

3. Main Improvement Advice

For this type of TOEFL email, you should make each required point explicit and finish the task within the time limit. Instead of writing a long personal explanation about GPA or PhD applications, use direct requests such as asking for articles, apps, books, websites, or examples of study schedules. You should also avoid complicated sentence structures if they create grammar errors. A simpler but accurate sentence is usually better than a longer sentence with indirect-question mistakes.

Overall, your content is relevant, but grammar errors and incomplete time-limited task fulfillment lower the score. To reach the 24–26 range, you need clearer indirect questions, more natural collocations, and a more complete answer within seven minutes.

23 Property Damage

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You rent an apartment from Greenview Properties. Since yesterday evening, there has been a steady leak from the ceiling in your living room near the window. You have already put a bucket under the leak, but the water is starting to damage the wall and you are worried it could affect the electrical outlet nearby.

Write an email to the property manager, Ms. Park. In your email, do the following:

- Explain the problem clearly, including when it started and where the leak is.
- Ask for a maintenance visit as soon as possible and ask to be told a specific time when they will arrive.
- Ask what you should do to prevent further damage until maintenance arrives.

Original Response (Time Used: 10:53; Overtime: 3:53; Saved At: 2026/6/2 00:57:51; Word Count: 163)

Dear Ms. Park,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am a renter of your apartment from Greenview Properties. Unfortunately, last night I found a steady leak from the ceiling in my living room near the window. I have put a bucket to collect the leak, but the water is damaging the wall. I'm afraid if it would permeate through the electrical wires in the corner. I think I might need a maintenance visit as soon as possible, in case of the situation getting worse. Would the repair worker be available tonight? If not, please inform me when the worker will be free. Also, what should I do to prevent further damage of the damp area. I have already cut off the electric for safety. But the pieces of the wall are falling due to the water, and I don't know how to deal with this. I'll appreciate if you could give me some advice.

Thank you for your time.

Best,

Baiming

Model Response (Word Count: 165)

Good afternoon Ms. Park,

My name is Michael Crosby, and I rent apartment 420 in Greenview Properties. I am writing to let you know that water has been leaking from the ceiling of my apartment since yesterday evening. To be more specific, water is leaking from a small crack near the window in my living room. I am already able to spot a little bit of damage to the wall and am worried that it could get worse in the near future. Would it be possible for someone from the maintenance office to visit later today to take care of this issue? If so, could you let me know what time they will arrive? In the meantime, I would appreciate it if you could tell me what I should do to prevent the damage to the wall from getting worse. I am actually a little bit worried that it might eventually ruin the apartment's hardwood floors.

Thank you very much for your time and attention,

Michael Crosby

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 22/30

This score is based on the full submitted response. Your email clearly explains the leak, mentions when and where it started, asks for a maintenance visit, requests an arrival time, and asks what to do before maintenance arrives. However, the response took **10:53**, which is almost four minutes over the recommended time. If only the content completed within seven minutes were counted, the score might be slightly lower, around **19–20/30**.

1. Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Version
I am a renter of your apartment from Greenview Properties	The expression is understandable but unnatural.	I rent an apartment from Greenview Properties.
last night I found a steady leak	The prompt says “yesterday evening,” and “found” is less natural here.	yesterday evening, I noticed a steady leak
I have put a bucket to collect the leak	We collect water, not the leak itself.	I have placed a bucket under the leak to collect the water.
I’m afraid if it would permeate through the electrical wires	“Afraid if” is grammatically incorrect, and the meaning is unclear.	I am worried that the water could reach the nearby electrical outlet or wiring.
I think I might need a maintenance visit	The request is too weak for an urgent property-damage problem.	Could you please send a maintenance worker as soon as possible?
in case of the situation getting worse	This phrase is unnatural in this context.	before the situation gets worse
please inform me when the worker will be free	The wording is slightly unnatural, and the task asks for a specific arrival time.	please let me know the specific time when the worker can arrive
prevent further damage of the damp area	Wrong collocation. We say “damage to,” not “damage of.”	prevent further damage to the damp area
I have already cut off the electric	The phrase is unnatural.	I have already turned off the power near that outlet.
the pieces of the wall are falling	The sentence is not specific enough.	pieces of paint or plaster are falling from the wall
I’ll appreciate if you could give me some advice	Incorrect sentence pattern.	I would appreciate it if you could give me some advice.

2. Comparison with the Model Response

Compared with the model response, your answer is strong in **task completion**. You cover almost all required information: the leak started last night, it is in the living room near the window, the wall is being damaged, and there may be an electrical risk. You also ask for maintenance and ask what to do before the worker arrives. These details make your response relevant and complete.

However, your response is weaker in **language accuracy and naturalness**. The model response uses simple and accurate sentences, such as “water has been leaking from the ceiling” and “could you let me know what time they will arrive?” Your response contains several awkward or incorrect expressions, such as “collect the leak,” “afraid if,” and “cut off the electric.” These errors do not completely block communication, but they make the email sound less polished.

Another difference is that the model response is more direct and professional. In your response, “I think I might need a maintenance visit” sounds too hesitant for a serious situation involving water damage and electricity. A property-management email should be polite but firm. A better request would be: “Could you please send a maintenance worker as soon as possible and let me know the exact arrival time?”

3. Main Improvement Advice

For this type of TOEFL email, you should keep the message clear, direct, and easy to answer. Your content is already relevant, but you need to use more natural expressions and avoid uncertain wording. In an urgent repair request, direct phrases such as “Could you please send maintenance as soon as possible?” are better than weak phrases like “I think I might need.” You should also control time more carefully, because writing nearly eleven minutes for a seven-minute task would hurt your performance in real test conditions.

Overall, this is a complete and polite response, but grammar errors, unnatural collocations, and overtime prevent it from reaching a higher score. To reach the **25–27** range, you need cleaner sentence patterns, more natural vocabulary, and a more direct request within the time limit.

24 Noisy Neighbors

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You rent an apartment from Lakeside Residences. For the past three weeks, your upstairs neighbors have been hosting loud gatherings late at night, often continuing past midnight. The noise from music, loud conversations, and footsteps makes it very difficult for you to sleep, especially on weekdays when you have to wake up early for work.

Write an email to the property manager, Ms. Delgado. In your email, do the following:

- Clearly explain the situation, including how long it has been happening, what kind of noise it is, and how it affects your daily life.
- Describe what you have already done to try to solve the problem on your own.
- Ask what actions the property management can take to address the issue, and what you should do if the problem continues.

Original Response (Time Used: 10:14; Overtime: +03:14; Saved At: 2026/6/3 22:29:20; Word Count: 175)

Dear Ms. Delgado,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am a renter of your apartment from Lakeside Residences, and I am writing to express my hard time I am going through. Due to the noisy upstairs neighbor, who have been holding thunderous gatherings and parties late at night - even continuing past midnight sometimes, I couldn't sleep well these days. The loud music, mixed with people - including men and women, children and elderly - talking and walking noise, made me really mad. Since I need to wake up early for work on weekdays, I desperately need a quiet place to keep my sleeping time efficient. I have tried an earphone to defend the annoying noise, but it did not work at all. So could you please reach out to property managements to solve this problem, such as send the neighbor a notice letter or even a warning letter. Also, what should I do if the problem remains unsolved. I could not stand it anymore.

Thank you for your time.

Best wishes,

Baiming¹³

Model Response (Word Count: 140)

Dear Ms. Delgado,

My name is Scott Tenormin, and I rent apartment 506 in Lakeside Residences. I am writing because my upstairs neighbors have been extremely noisy over the past three weeks. Almost every night they host loud parties that prevent me from sleeping. This has a profound effect on my quality of life because my shifts at work begin in the early morning. I have already tried talking to them about the problem, but they have ignored my requests to keep quiet at night. Would it be possible for you to handle this issue by contacting my neighbors? I am sure that if you send an official warning they will change their habits. Meanwhile, it would be great if you could let me know what procedures I should follow the next time this occurs.

Thanks you very much,

Scott Tenorman

¹³The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 15/30 under strict 7-minute timing

If the gray overtime part is also counted, the response would be closer to **18/30**.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression	Reason
I am a renter of your apartment from Lakeside Residences	I rent an apartment at Lakeside Residences	More natural and accurate wording.
express my hard time I am going through	explain a difficult situation I am facing	The original phrase is grammatically unnatural.
Due to the noisy upstairs neighbor, who have	Because my upstairs neighbors have	“Neighbor” should be plural, and “who have” must agree with it.
thunderous gatherings and parties	very loud gatherings and parties	“Thunderous” sounds exaggerated and informal here.
I couldn’t sleep well these days	I have not been able to sleep well recently	Present perfect fits a problem continuing up to now.
people – including men and women, children and elderly	many people talking loudly	The details are unnecessary and sound strange in a formal complaint.
talking and walking noise	loud conversations and footsteps	More precise and natural.
made me really mad	has been very frustrating	More polite and appropriate for an email to management.
keep my sleeping time efficient	get enough sleep	“Sleeping time efficient” is unnatural.
I have tried an earphone	I have tried using earplugs / headphones	“An earphone” is incorrect in this context.
to defend the annoying noise	to block out the noise	“Defend noise” is incorrect collocation.
property managements	property management	“Management” is usually uncountable here.
such as send the neighbor a notice letter	such as sending the neighbors a notice or warning letter	Use gerund after “such as”; “neighbors” should be plural.
what should I do if the problem remains unsolved	what I should do if the problem continues	Indirect question word order is needed.
I could not stand it anymore	I would appreciate your help in resolving this issue	The original is too emotional for a formal email.

Comparison with the Model Response

Your response includes most of the required information, especially the duration, the type of noise, and its effect on your sleep. However, compared with the model response, it is less formal, less controlled, and less complete under the time limit. The model response gives a clearer identity at the beginning, states the problem directly, explains the effect on work, describes a stronger self-solution by saying the writer already talked to the neighbors, and asks for a clear procedure if the problem happens again.

Your main weakness is not content, but expression. Phrases such as “express my hard time,” “thunderous gatherings,” “defend the annoying noise,” and “I could not stand it anymore” make the email sound less professional. In TOEFL email writing, a complaint should be clear but calm. You should also avoid adding unnecessary details such as “men and women, children and elderly,” because they do not help answer the prompt.

One important issue is timing. The most important request to management appears in the gray overtime section. If this were a real 7-minute task, the response would lose points for task completion. Next time, write the three required points first in simple language: the problem, what you tried, and what you want the manager to do. Then add details only if time remains.

The model response is stronger overall, but it is not perfect. It contains a small grammar error: “Thanks you very much” should be “Thank you very much.” It also has an inconsistent name at the end. Still, its organization, tone, and sentence control are closer to a high-scoring response.

Main Improvement Direction: Use simpler formal sentences, finish all required tasks before adding extra detail, and replace emotional expressions with polite complaint language.

My Notes:

explain a difficult situation I am facing
earplugs

25 Wrong Package

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You recently ordered a pair of wireless headphones from an online electronics store called TechWorld. The package arrived yesterday, but when you opened it, you found a different, cheaper model than the one you selected on the website. You have not used the headphones yet and still have all the original packaging.

Write an email to TechWorld's customer service department. In your email, do the following:

- Clearly explain the problem, including what you ordered, what you received, and when the package arrived.
- Ask how they will resolve the issue, and whether there will be any additional cost to you.
- Request a specific timeline for when you can expect a reply and a solution.

Original Response (Time Used: 11:38; Overtime: +04:38; Saved At: 2026/6/4 17:34:40; Word Count: 148)

To whom it may concern,

I hope this email finds you well.

Last week I ordered a pair of wireless headphones from an online electronic store named TechWorld. But when I received the package yesterday morning, I found the model was different from the one I expected. I ordered the version 3.0 model, but the merchandise sent to me was the version 2.0. Since I still kept the original package and didn't use the headphones, I wonder if there will be a return and exchange way to solve this mistake. Also, if there's an extra cost during the procedure such as delivering fee, will the TechWorld pay for me? The headphones will be needed this Friday morning, because I couldn't attend the listening exam without them. So I might need your reply and solution before Wednesday. Also, the sooner, the better.

Thank you for your time.

Best regards,

Baiming¹⁴

Model Response (Word Count: 154)

To Whom it May Concern,

I am writing because of a problem I recently experienced after ordering a pair of wireless headphones from your website. The problem is that while I ordered and paid for a pair of your top of the line WX-2000 headphones, the package I received yesterday contained a pair of cheaper Z2-500 headphones. Could you let me know how you will take care of this problem? Moreover, please let me know if I will be required to pay any fees or costs to get the proper headphones. If it matters, please note that I have not used the headphones, and I have kept the original invoice and packaging. It would be really great if you could let me know how long it will take you to reply to this message, and how long it will likely take for you to resolve this problem for me.

Thanks for your time,

Chuck Alderman

¹⁴The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 15/30

This score is based only on the timed black-text response. The response explains the basic problem clearly: you ordered wireless headphones from TechWorld, received the wrong model yesterday, and still kept the original packaging. However, the timed answer stops in the middle of a sentence, so two required parts are not fully completed: asking about additional cost and requesting a clear timeline for the reply and solution. This makes the response incomplete, even though the basic situation is understandable.

Grammar and Wording Corrections

Original wording	Problem	Better correction
But when I received the package yesterday morning	Starting with “But” is too informal for this email	However, when I received the package yesterday morning
I found the model was different from the one I expected	“expected” is vague; the issue is that it was different from the order	I found that the model was different from the one I ordered
the version 3.0 model	Article and capitalization are unnatural	the Version 3.0 model
the merchandise sent to me was the version 2.0	“merchandise” is too broad and unnatural for headphones	the item sent to me was the Version 2.0 model
Since I still kept the original package	Wrong tense; “packaging” is more natural	Since I still have the original packaging
didn’t use the headphones	In a formal email, use present perfect	have not used the headphones
I wonder if there will be a return and exchange way	Unnatural expression	I would like to know how I can return the wrong item and receive the correct model
Also, I think the TechWorld should	Incomplete sentence; also no article before company name	Also, I think TechWorld should...

Comparison with the Model Response

The model response is stronger because it completes all three task requirements in a direct and organized way. It states exactly what was ordered, what was received, and when the package arrived. It also asks who will pay any extra fees and asks for both a reply timeline and a solution timeline. In contrast, your timed response explains the main problem, but it does not finish the sentence about what TechWorld should do, and it does not clearly ask about the cost or the expected timeline within the timed part.

The model response also uses more precise customer-service language, such as “how you will take care of this problem,” “required to pay any fees,” and “how long it will likely take.” Your wording is understandable, but some expressions are not idiomatic, especially “return and exchange way,” “electronic store,” and “merchandise sent to me.” These phrases make the email sound less natural.

Main Improvement Advice

For this type of TOEFL email, finish the required points first before adding extra background. A safer structure is: first explain the order problem, then ask for replacement or refund, then ask whether you need to pay any shipping or handling fee, and finally request a reply and solution by a specific date. Also, use simpler and more direct expressions instead of long or vague phrases. The content after the time limit is much more complete, but the timed version loses many points because it is unfinished.

26 Essay Submission

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You are a student in Professor Kim's sociology class. Last week, you submitted your midterm essay via the class website. Yesterday, you checked your grade and were surprised to see it was much lower than you expected. When you opened the file that was graded, you realized it was an older draft of your essay, not the final version. You still have the correct final version saved on your computer.

Write an email to Professor Kim. In your email, do the following:

- Clearly explain the problem and how you noticed that the wrong version was graded.
- Ask if you can send the final version and have your grade changed.
- Ask when you can expect a reply.

Original Response (Time Used: 07:58; Overtime: +00:58; Saved At: 2026/6/5 20:10:23; Word Count: 124)

Dear Professor Kim,

I hope this email finds you well.

Yesterday when I checked my midterm essay grade of your sociology class, I was surprised to find that my score only earned D, which was expected to be higher than C. When I opened the file, only to find the old draft. Then I realized that I forgot to update my newest essay version. Since the grade is really important to me, I wonder if I could send the final version and get my grade changed. I sincerely apologize for my mistake. And I really appreciate it if you could give me a chance to make up. Just inform me the time that I could expect a reply.

Thank you for your time.

Baiming¹⁵

Model Response (Word Count: 129)

Hello Professor Kim,

I am writing because of a problem I experienced when submitting the midterm essay last week. I was surprised by my low score on the essay, and after I checked your comments I noticed that I accidentally uploaded an old draft and did not submit my final version. Would it be possible for me to send the final version this week and get a new grade for the assignment? I know this is an unusual request, but it is very important that I do well in this class, and a poor score on the midterm essay will have a major impact on my final result. Please let me know when you will let me know if this is acceptable to you.

Thank you very much,

Lisa Paulus

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

¹⁵The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Original	Better Version	Reason
my midterm essay grade of your sociology class	my midterm essay grade in your sociology class	Use “in” for a class/course context.
my score only earned D	I received a D	A score does not “earn” a grade; the student receives it.
which was expected to be higher than C	although I had expected a grade higher than a C	The original passive structure is unnatural and unclear.
When I opened the file, only to find the old draft	When I opened the graded file, I found that it was an old draft	“Only to find” cannot stand alone after this clause.
I forget to update my newest essay version	I had forgotten to upload the final version of my essay	The past perfect is needed, and “final version” is more natural than “newest essay version.”
I wonder if I could send the final version and get my grade changed	I was wondering if I could send the final version and have my grade reconsidered	More polite and more appropriate for a professor.
give me a chance to make up	give me a chance to correct this mistake	“Make up” is incomplete here; it usually needs an object, such as “make up the assignment.”
Just inform me the time that I could expect a reply	Could you please let me know when I can expect your reply?	The original sounds too direct and grammatically incorrect.

Comparison with the Model Response

Your response completes the basic task: you explain that the wrong draft was graded, ask to send the final version, and ask about the reply time. However, the explanation is less clear than the model response. The model directly says that the student accidentally uploaded an old draft, while your version says “I forget to update my newest essay version,” which is less precise and sounds unnatural.

Compared with the model response, your tone is also slightly weaker. The model is polite but controlled, while your sentence “Since the grade is really important to me” sounds a little too personal and not very academic. A stronger version would focus on fairness and the submission mistake, not only on the importance of the grade.

The biggest problem is language accuracy. Several sentences have grammar or collocation errors, especially “my score only earned D,” “only to find the old draft,” and “Just inform me.” These errors do not destroy the meaning, but they make the email sound less polished and reduce the score.

Also, part of your required reply-time request and the closing were written after the seven-minute limit. If the overtime text is not counted, the response becomes incomplete at the end, which would lower the score further. With the gray text included, this is around **18/30**; without the overtime part, it would likely be closer to **16/30**.

Main Suggestions

Focus on three improvements: first, make the problem clearer by saying “I accidentally uploaded an older draft instead of the final version.” Second, use more polite academic wording, such as “Would it be possible” and “have my grade reconsidered.” Third, avoid direct commands like “Just inform me,” and replace them with polite questions.

27 Group Project

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You are working on a group project in your political science class. Unfortunately, you will not be able to attend the next group meeting because you have an appointment with your dentist at the same time. You are unable to reschedule the appointment because the dentist does not have any time available this month.

Write an email to John Shepherd, who is also in your group. In your email, do the following:

- Clearly explain the problem, including the fact that you cannot change the date of the appointment.
- Ask John to explain the situation to the other members of the group when the meeting takes place.
- Request that John, or another group member, send you a summary of what is discussed at the meeting.

Original Response (Time Used: 08:50; Overtime: +01:50; Saved At: 2026/6/4 20:24:04; Word Count: 132)

Dear John Shepherd,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to explain that unfortunately I will not be able to take part in the next group meeting of political science class tomorrow due to the conflict of an appointment with my dentist. The appointment couldn't be rescheduled because the dentist needs to attend an international conference the day after tomorrow. Since the conference will last three weeks, so he doesn't have any other time available this month. Could you please explain my situation to other members of the group, and tell them I am really sorry about that. Also, could you please reach out to my friend Jack, and send me a summary of the discussion. I want to stay caught up. Thank you in advance!

Best regards,
Baiming¹⁶

Model Response (Word Count: 156)

Hello John,

I am writing to let you know that I will not be able to attend the next meeting of our group. Unfortunately, I was forced to make a last-minute appointment with my dentist to deal with some tooth pain I have been experiencing over the past couple of months. The only time the dentist is available to see me is the same time as our group meeting. Would it be possible for you to explain this to everyone else in the group? If they are concerned about my absence, just let them know they can call me at any time. Additionally, it would be great if you could arrange for someone to send me a quick summary of the discussion that occurs during the meeting. It would be best to do that via e-mail, I think.

Thanks for taking the time to help me with this, John. As always, I appreciate your help.

Best wishes,

Tim

¹⁶The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 16/30

This score is based mainly on the text completed within the seven-minute limit. If the gray overtime text were counted, the score would be slightly higher, around **19/30**, because the final request and closing become clearer.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original expression	Correction / Explanation
<i>take part in the next group meeting of political science class</i>	<i>attend the next group meeting for our political science class.</i> “Attend a meeting” is more natural, and “our political science class” is clearer.
<i>due to the conflict of an appointment with my dentist</i>	<i>because I have a dentist appointment at the same time.</i> The original phrase is unnatural; “because” is simpler and more accurate.
<i>The appointment couldn’t be rescheduled</i>	<i>I cannot reschedule the appointment.</i> This is more direct and matches the task requirement better.
<i>Since the conference will last three weeks, so he doesn’t have any other time available this month.</i>	<i>Since the conference will last three weeks, he does not have any other time available this month.</i> Do not use both “since” and “so” in the same clause.
<i>explain my situation to other members of the group</i>	<i>explain my situation to the other members of the group.</i> The article “the” is needed because the group members are specific.
<i>I am really sorry about that</i>	<i>I am really sorry for missing the meeting.</i> “That” is too vague; the exact problem should be named.
<i>send me a summary of the discussion</i>	<i>send me a summary of what is discussed at the meeting.</i> This is closer to the prompt and sounds more complete.

Comparison with the Model Response

Your response covers the main situation, but it is less successful than the model response in three areas. First, the model response explains the conflict in a clear and natural way, while your response uses some awkward phrases such as “due to the conflict of an appointment.” Second, the model response stays focused on the group meeting, but your response adds extra information about the dentist’s international conference. This detail is not necessary and makes the email feel less efficient. Third, your most important request—asking for a summary of the meeting—appears mainly in the gray overtime section, so under a strict time limit your response would seem incomplete.

The model response also has a warmer and more natural tone. It directly asks John to explain the situation and arrange for someone to send a summary. By contrast, your email is polite but slightly mechanical, and the phrase about contacting “my friend Jack” weakens task relevance. To improve, use simpler sentence structures, avoid unnecessary invented details, and make sure all three required points are completed before adding extra politeness or explanations.

Overall Comment

This is a partially successful response. The purpose is understandable, and the tone is generally polite. However, grammar problems, unnatural wording, extra irrelevant detail, and the incomplete timed version reduce the score. The main improvement should be to finish the three required task points first, using short and direct sentences.

My Notes:

Do not use both “since” and “so” in the same clause

28 Travel Changes

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

Two weeks ago, you booked a room at the Gateway Hotel in Florida for a vacation you will take in the spring. Since then, your best friend Sarah has decided to join you on the trip. She has already purchased an airplane ticket, but has not yet reserved her own hotel room. She would like to stay at the same hotel as you.

Write an email to Gary Bembridge, the guest services manager at the hotel. In your email, do the following:

- Explain that your friend will join your vacation, and that she would like to stay in the hotel as well.
- Request that the room be on the same floor as yours, if possible.
- Thank Gary for taking care of this as soon as possible since you will be arriving in Florida in just a few days.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:46; Saved At: 2026/6/4 20:54:28; Word Count: 112)

Dear Gary Bembridge,

I hope this email finds you well.

I booked a room at Gateway Hotel in Florida two weeks ago, and one of my friends called Sarah would like to stay at the same hotel with me. So could you please help me to reserve her room? Also, it couldn't be great if our rooms are distributed on the same floor. We will arrive Florida in just few days, as the airplane ticket is scheduled on this Friday. So I need to get the reservation done before this Thursday. I apologize for this interrupt change. And thank you in advance if you could take care of this.

Best regards,

Baiming

Model Response (Word Count: 140)

Hello Mr. Bembridge

I am writing to let you know that my friend Sarah will be joining me on my upcoming trip to Florida. She would like to stay with me at the Gateway Hotel, but has not yet booked a room. Would it be possible for you to take care of her reservation? If possible, we would like to stay on the same floor. As you know, I will be arriving in Florida in just a few days, so I hope you can handle Sarah's reservation as soon as possible. If you are unable to find a room for Sarah, she will have to look around for a nearby hotel, but I hope we can avoid that.

Thanks for taking the time to help me with this, Gary. Sarah and I are both looking forward to our stay.

Best wishes,

Emma Cruise

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 19/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original	Corrected	Reason
one of my friends called Sarah	my friend Sarah	“Called Sarah” is awkward here. Since Sarah is already named in the prompt, “my friend Sarah” is clearer and more natural.
stay at the same hotel with me	stay at the same hotel as me	The correct comparison structure is “the same ... as.”
help me to reserve her room	help me reserve a room for her	“Help me reserve” is more natural. Also, Sarah does not have a room yet, so “a room for her” is better than “her room.”
it couldn’t be great if	it would be great if	The original sentence has the opposite meaning. “It would be great if” expresses a polite request.
our rooms are distributed on the same floor	our rooms could be on the same floor	“Distributed” is unnatural for hotel rooms. “Could be on the same floor” is simple and correct.
We will arrive Florida	We will arrive in Florida	“Arrive” requires the preposition “in” before a place such as a state or country.
in just few days	in just a few days	The article “a” is required before “few days.”
the airplane ticket is scheduled on this Friday	Sarah’s flight is scheduled for this Friday	A ticket is not usually “scheduled.” A flight is scheduled. Use “for” before the date.
I apologize for this interrupt change	I apologize for this sudden change	“Interrupt change” is incorrect. “Sudden change” is natural and polite.
thank you in advance if you could take care of this	thank you in advance for taking care of this	After “thank you for,” use a noun or gerund phrase.

Comparison with the Model Response

Your response completes the basic task: you explain that Sarah wants to stay at the hotel, ask for rooms on the same floor, and mention that the trip is coming soon. However, compared with the model response, your email is less polished and less precise. The main problem is not content, but language control. Several expressions are unnatural or grammatically incorrect, such as “it couldn’t be great if,” “arrive Florida,” and “interrupt change.” These errors make the message harder to read and reduce the score.

The model response is stronger because it uses clear, direct, and polite sentences. It also explains Sarah’s situation more smoothly: she will join the trip, she has not booked a room, and she may need another hotel if no room is available. Your response includes extra information about the airplane ticket and the Thursday deadline, but this part is not very clear and slightly distracts from the main request. In TOEFL email writing, it is better to keep the request simple and fully connected to the prompt.

Suggestions for Improvement

You should focus on three things. First, use simpler sentence structures to avoid grammar mistakes. For example, write “It would be great if our rooms could be on the same floor” instead of a more complicated sentence. Second, make the request more specific: ask whether Gary can help Sarah reserve a room, not simply “reserve her room.” Third, keep the tone polite but natural. Phrases such as “I apologize for this sudden change” and “Thank you for taking care of this as soon as possible” are more appropriate than the expressions in the original response.

Overall, this is a complete but linguistically weak response. With fewer grammar errors and more natural phrasing, it could reach the 23–25 range.

29 Wrong Jacket

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You ordered a jacket from an online store, but when it arrived, you found that they sent the wrong size. You need the jacket for a family event next week, so you want to contact customer service as soon as possible.

Write an email to the customer service department. In your email, do the following:

- Explain the problem with your order.
- Ask whether the correct size can be sent quickly.
- Request information about how to return the wrong item.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:25; Saved At: 2026/6/4 21:23:02; Word Count: 126)

To Whom It May Concern,

I hope this email finds you well.

I ordered a jacket from an online store called "Nike", but when I received the package yesterday, unfortunately I found it was the wrong size. While my size is XL, the L size jacket is a bit small to me. Because I need to wear this jacket to attend a family event next week, it will be better if the correct size jacket could be sent here before this Sunday. So could you please contact the Nike's customer service to solve this problem. Also, how can I return this wrong item? I would appreciate it if you could offer me some information such as returning address.

Thank you for your time.

Best wishes,
Baiming

Model Response (Word Count: 154)

My name is Gary Coleman, and I am writing because of a problem with a recent order from your online store. Last week I purchased a medium-sized jacket, but this morning I received a small jacket from you. Would it be possible to receive the proper jacket right away? I purchased the jacket to wear to my brother's wedding next week, so I cannot wait very long for a replacement. Moreover, I would appreciate it if you could let me know how to return the one you sent me. I can send it by mail, or hand it over to your delivery driver when he drops off the replacement jacket. Just let me know what you prefer.

Thanks for taking the time to solve this problem for me. I have always had wonderful experiences shopping with your business, and this problem certainly will not cause me to start shopping with one of your competitors.

Best wishes,
Gary

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original	Corrected	Reason
from an online store called “Nike”	from your online store	Since the email is written to customer service, “your online store” is more direct and natural.
unfortunately I found it was the wrong size	I unfortunately found that it was the wrong size	Add “that” after “found.” The adverb placement is also smoother.
While my size is XL, the L size jacket is a bit small to me	I ordered an XL, but I received a size L, which is too small for me	The original structure is awkward. The corrected version clearly states the ordered size and the received size.
Because I need to wear this jacket to attend a family event	Because I need to wear this jacket to a family event	“Wear this jacket to a family event” is more natural and concise.
it will be better if	it would be better if	This is a polite hypothetical request, so “would” is more appropriate.
the correct size jacket could be sent here	the correct-size jacket could be sent to me	“Sent to me” is clearer. “Correct-size jacket” works as a compound adjective.
contact the Nike’s customer service	help me solve this problem	You are already writing to customer service, so asking them to contact customer service is illogical. Also, do not use “the” before “Nike’s.”
this wrong item	the wrong item	“The wrong item” is the standard expression.
returning address	return address	“Return address” is the natural noun phrase. You could also ask for a “return label.”

Comparison with the Model Response

Your response addresses all three required points: you explain that the wrong size arrived, ask whether the correct size can be sent before the event, and request return information. The organization is also clear enough for the reader to follow. However, compared with the model response, your language is less natural and less precise. The biggest problem is that you write, “could you please contact the Nike’s customer service,” although the email itself is already addressed to customer service. This weakens the logic of the request.

The model response is stronger because it states the order problem very clearly: the writer purchased one size but received another. It also gives a specific reason for urgency, asks for a quick replacement, and offers possible ways to return the wrong jacket. Your response has the same basic content, but some expressions are awkward, such as “the L size jacket is a bit small to me” and “this interrupt change.” These errors do not destroy meaning, but they make the email sound less polished.

Suggestions for Improvement

You should make the size problem more exact: write “I ordered an XL, but I received a size L.” This is clearer than saying “my size is XL.” You should also make the request more direct: ask customer service to send the correct jacket quickly, not to contact another customer service department. Finally, use more natural customer-service phrases, such as “replacement,” “return label,” “return address,” and “instructions for returning the wrong item.”

Overall, this is a complete response with understandable meaning, but several unnatural expressions and one logical mistake prevent it from reaching a higher score. With clearer wording and more natural customer-service language, it could reach the 24–26 range.

30 Hotel Facilities

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You are planning a short holiday next month and found an advertisement for a hotel that looks suitable. However, the advertisement does not clearly say whether breakfast is included or if there is parking available. You want to get this information before booking.

Write an email to the hotel owner. In your email, do the following:

- Explain why you are interested in the apartment.
- Ask whether breakfast and parking are included.
- Request information about the easiest way to make a booking.

Original Response (Time Used: 07:03; Overtime: +00:03; Saved At: 2026/6/4 21:40:02; Word Count: 112)

Dear Hotel Owner,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to consult some questions of your hotel service. I planned a short holiday touring to your city next month, and I found your hotel suitable. It is really near the park I want to visit, and the price is also reasonable. I just wonder whether breakfast and parking are included in your hotel service. If yes, then I would be happy to book your hotel. Also, could you please tell me the easiest way to make a booking. The official way in Airbnb requires me to provide a lot of identifications.

Thank you for your information.

Best wishes,

Baiming¹⁷

Model Response (Word Count: 153)

Dear Hotel Manager,

I am writing because I saw an advertisement for your hotel on Facebook last week. I am planning a holiday in Tampa next week, and I think your hotel has a perfect location near the coast. I am also impressed by the fitness center shown in the ad, as I like to stay active when I am taking a trip. I have a couple of questions, however. Could you please let me know if breakfast is included? If so, could you also let me know when it is served? Also, I would like to know whether parking is provided at the hotel, or if I should park my rental car somewhere else.

Finally, it would be great if you could let me know the easiest way to make a booking. I just want to avoid any booking fees that will add to my overall cost.

Thanks for your assistance with this.

Best wishes,

Carmen Wheeler

¹⁷The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original	Corrected	Reason
Dear Hotel Owner	Dear Hotel Manager / Dear Sir or Madam	"Hotel Owner" is understandable but not natural as a form of address.
consult some questions of your hotel service	ask a few questions about your hotel services	"Consult questions" is incorrect. Use "ask questions about."
I planned a short holiday touring to your city	I am planning a short holiday in your city	Use the present continuous for a future plan. "Touring to your city" is unnatural.
I found your hotel suitable	I found your hotel suitable for my trip	Add a clear object of suitability. This makes the sentence more complete.
I just wonder whether	I was wondering whether	"I was wondering whether" is more polite and natural in an email.
included in your hotel service	included in the room rate / included with the stay	"Hotel service" is too general. The question is about what the booking includes.
book your hotel	book a room at your hotel	A guest books a room, not the whole hotel.
make a booking.	make a booking?	This is a question, so it should end with a question mark.
The official way in Airbnb	Booking through Airbnb	"The official way in Airbnb" is unnatural. Use "booking through Airbnb."
a lot of identifications	a lot of identification information / documents	"Identification" is usually uncountable here, unless you mean specific documents.
Thank you for your information	Thank you for your help / assistance	You thank someone for help, not usually "for your information" in this context.

Comparison with the Model Response

Your response answers the three main requirements: you explain why the hotel interests you, ask about breakfast and parking, and request booking information. The content is generally complete, and the reason you give, the location near a park and the reasonable price, is relevant. However, compared with the model response, your email is less natural in wording and less detailed in the questions.

The model response is stronger because it sounds more like a real customer email. It gives a specific source of the advertisement, explains the hotel's location and facilities, and asks more practical follow-up questions, such as when breakfast is served and where to park a rental car. Your response is understandable, but some phrases sound translated from Chinese, such as "consult some questions," "holiday touring," and "book your hotel." These expressions reduce fluency.

Suggestions for Improvement

You should use simpler and more standard hotel-booking language. For example, write "I am planning a short holiday in your city next month" and "I would like to know whether breakfast and parking are included in the room rate." Also, make the final request more polite and direct: "Could you please let me know the easiest way to book a room?" The Airbnb detail is acceptable, but it should be expressed more clearly, such as "Booking through Airbnb requires too much identification information."

Overall, this is a complete response with clear meaning, but the grammar and phrasing are not smooth enough for a high score. With more natural hotel-related expressions and cleaner sentence structures, it could reach the 24–26 range.

My Notes:

Thanks for your assistance with this.

Could you please let me know ...? If so, could you also let me know when/where ...? Also, I would like to know whether ..., or if I should do sth. else.

31 Library Hours

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You are a university student and usually work on assignments in the campus library in the evenings. The library is a useful place to study because it is quiet, and contains useful books and journals. Recently, the library has been closing earlier than usual, which has made it difficult for you to complete your assignments.

Write an email to Ms. Severin, the library manager. In your email, do the following:

- Explain why the library is important for your studies.
- Ask why the opening hours have changed.
- Request information about whether the library will stay open later again.

Original Response (Time Used: 06:40; Saved At: 2026/6/9 18:39:20; Word Count: 124)

Dear Ms. Severin,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to consult some problems relating to the library opening hours. I am a college student and I have always loved to study in library because of the quiet environment. Also it contains abundant academic materials which are really useful. I could not think of learning knowledge without such resources. However, I find that the library has been closing earlier than usual, and I would like to know the possible reasons. Also, could you please tell me whether the library will stay open later again? If yes, when would the library go back on track as it had always been?

Thanks for your time and your management of library.

Best regards,

Baiming

Model Response (Word Count: 150)

Dear Ms. Severin,

I am writing to ask about the library's new operating hours. I am a third-year student at the university, and I often work on my assignments in the library because it is always very quiet and provides easy access to useful books and journal articles. Unfortunately, due to the new hours I have been forced to work on my projects in my dorm room, which is often quite noisy. Just last week I was working on a major assignment for my political science class while the residents of the room across the hall hosted a huge party.

Could you possibly tell me why the hours have changed? Moreover, could you let me know if this is a permanent change? If the library will return to its former hours in the future, please let me know.

Thanks for taking the time to answer my questions.

Best wishes,

Clark Kesselring

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 23/30

Your response completes all three required tasks: it explains why the library matters, asks why the hours changed, and asks whether the library will stay open later again. The tone is polite and appropriate for an email to a library manager. However, several phrases are unnatural or grammatically inaccurate, and the content is less specific than the model response. Under a strict TOEFL-style standard, this would likely be around **23/30**, not a full-score answer.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Expression
consult some problems relating to the library opening hours	"Consult problems" is unnatural in English.	ask about some issues related to the library's opening hours
study in library	Missing article.	study in the library
Also it contains abundant academic materials	Needs smoother structure; "abundant" is a little formal here.	It also contains many useful academic materials
I could not think of learning knowledge without such resources	"Learning knowledge" is unnatural.	I cannot imagine studying effectively without these resources
when would the library go back on track as it had always been	Awkward and unidiomatic.	when will the library return to its usual schedule?
Thanks for your time and your management of library	Missing article; the phrase sounds unnatural.	Thank you for your time and for managing the library

Comparison with the Model Response

Compared with the model response, your email is clear but less persuasive. The model answer gives a concrete example: the student had to work in a noisy dorm room while others were having a party. This detail shows exactly how the earlier closing time affects studying. Your response only says that the library is quiet and useful, which is correct but rather general.

The model response also uses more natural email language, such as "I am writing to ask about the library's new operating hours" and "Could you let me know if this is a permanent change?" By contrast, phrases like "consult some problems" and "go back on track" make your email sound translated from Chinese. These errors do not prevent understanding, but they reduce the language score.

How to Improve

To move this response closer to a full-score answer, add one specific sentence about how the changed hours affected a real assignment. For example, mention that you could not finish a research paper because you lost access to books or journal articles in the evening. Also, replace unnatural expressions with simpler and more direct ones. In TOEFL emails, clear and natural wording is usually better than overly formal vocabulary.

My Notes:

"Consult problems" is unnatural in English. -> ask about some issues related to

"Learning knowledge" is unnatural. -> I cannot imagine studying effectively
return to its usual schedule

"Could you let me know if this is a permanent change?"

32 Joining a Group (Rewritten)

Task Type: TOEFL Write an Email

Recommended Time: 7 minutes

You are a student at a university, and you would like to take part in a volunteer group that helps new international students adjust to campus life. You saw a notice about the group on a campus board, but it did not include enough details about the activities or how students can become members.

Write an email to Richard Moss, the coordinator of the group. In your email, do the following:

- Explain why you are interested in joining the volunteer group.
- Ask about the activities the group organizes.
- Request information about how to become a member.

Original Response (Time Used: 10:31; Overtime: +03:31; Saved At: 2026/6/10 22:41:10; Word Count: 152)

Dear Mr. Moss,

I hope this email finds you well.

I am a third-year college student and I want to participate in your volunteer group. Yesterday when I passed by a campus board, a notice about helping new global students adjust to campus life caught my eyes. I am willing to join this group, because I want to make friends from diverse culture. Also, the meaningful work would bring me the feeling of fulfillment. However, since the notice is really concise, it lacks some information about activities. I wonder if you could share the detailed information like when and where the activities will be hold at, so I could get more prepared. If the time suits me, I would apply for the opportunity. What's more, could you tell me how to get recruited by your group, so I would not miss updated arrangement.

Thanks for your time and consideration.

Best regards,

Baiming ¹⁸

Model Response (Word Count: 144)

Hello Mr. Moss,

Yesterday afternoon I saw a notice about your group posted on the bulletin board in the student union group and I would like to volunteer my time to help the group. This is an area that I am really passionate about, as I am an international student myself. I came to study in Canada back in 2022, and I know how hard campus life can be at first.

Can you tell me what kind of activities the group organizes? I have experience arranging social events like camping and hiking in the region, so I bet I could help a lot if you run programs like those.

Would it be possible for you to send me some information about how to join the group? Should I contact you in person, or can I join online?

Thank you very much for your time,

Simon Biber

¹⁸The gray text indicates content written after the allotted seven-minute period.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

This response completes the basic task: it explains your interest, asks about the group's activities, and requests membership information. However, the score is limited by frequent grammar errors, awkward word choices, and unclear phrasing. Also, the response took **10:31**, which is far beyond the recommended seven minutes. Under strict timed conditions, the score would likely be slightly lower, around **15/30**.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Corrected Expression	Reason
I want to participate in your volunteer group.	I would like to join your volunteer group.	"Would like to" is more polite and natural in an email.
a notice about helping new global students	a notice about helping new international students	"International students" is the standard expression.
caught my eyes	caught my eye	The fixed phrase is singular: "catch one's eye."
from diverse culture	from diverse cultures / from different cultural backgrounds	"Culture" should be plural here.
bring me the feeling of fulfillment	give me a sense of fulfillment	More idiomatic academic expression.
since the notice is really concise	since the notice was quite brief	"Brief" is more natural than "concise" here; past tense matches the notice you saw.
the detailed information like when and where	more details, such as when and where	"Such as" is better for formal examples.
activities will be hold at	activities will be held	Passive form: "be held." Do not use "at" after "where" in this structure.
so I could get more prepared	so that I can prepare in advance	Clearer and more natural.
If the time suits me	If the schedule works for me	More idiomatic.
apply for the opportunity	apply to join the group	More direct and task-specific.
how to get recruited by your group	how I can become a member of the group	The prompt asks about becoming a member, not being recruited.
so I would not miss updated arrangement	so that I do not miss any important updates	"Arrangement" is countable and awkward here.

Comparison with the Model Response

Compared with the model response, your answer is less specific and less personal. The model gives a clear reason for joining: the writer is an international student and understands the difficulty of adjusting to campus life. Your reason, "making friends from diverse cultures" and gaining fulfillment, is acceptable, but it sounds more general and less connected to the purpose of helping new international students.

The model response also asks more precise questions. It asks what kinds of activities the group organizes and whether joining can be done in person or online. Your question about "when and where the activities will be held" is useful, but it does not clearly ask about the **types** of activities. For a stronger answer, you should ask about both the content and schedule of the activities.

In terms of language, the model is smoother and more natural. Your response has several grammar problems, especially with fixed phrases, plural nouns, and passive voice. These errors do not completely block communication, but they make the email sound less polished and reduce the score.

How to Improve

To reach a higher score, make your reason for joining more closely related to the group itself. For example, mention that you want to help new international students feel less lonely, understand campus resources, or adjust to university life more quickly. Also, ask more direct questions about the group's activities, application process, time commitment, and membership requirements. Finally, use simpler but more accurate sentences instead of long sentences with several grammar risks.

Main Issue: Your content is relevant, but the response needs clearer task development and more accurate sentence-level control.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 06:58; Saved At: 2026/6/10 22:56:48; Word Count: 122)

Dear Mr. Moss,

I hope this email finds you well.

Yesterday afternoon I saw a notice about your group on a bulletin board, and volunteering activity caught my eyes. I am really passionate about helping new global students because I am a international student myself and I know how hard to get fitted in campus life for students like us. So could you share more detailed information like what are included in activities? I have assisted holding the ice-breaking game event and dancing parties, and I think such events really work out.

Also, I want to ask how to become a member of your group. Could I apply it online, or I need to contact you directly.

Thanks for your time.

Baiming

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 22/30

This response is much stronger than the previous version. It is completed within the seven-minute limit, and it addresses all three required points: the writer explains why he is interested in joining, asks about the group's activities, and requests information about how to become a member.

The content is relevant and specific. In particular, mentioning that the writer is also an international student makes the reason for joining more convincing. The examples of ice-breaking games and parties also help show that the writer has some useful experience.

However, several grammar and wording problems prevent it from reaching a higher score. For example, "volunteering activity caught my eyes" should be "the volunteer opportunity caught my eye," "global students" should be "international students," and "I am a international student" should be "I am an international student." The phrase "how hard to get fitted in campus life" is also unnatural; it should be "how hard it is to fit into campus life."

There are also some sentence-structure problems in the questions. "What are included in activities" should be changed to "what kinds of activities the group organizes." Similarly, "Could I apply it online, or I need to contact you directly" should be "Could I apply online, or do I need to contact you directly?"

Overall, this is a complete and effective response with clear task fulfillment. The main weakness is language accuracy. With cleaner grammar and more natural phrasing, this could reach around **26/30**.

33 Targeted Advertising (Rewritten)

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on marketing. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Today, we're discussing the ethics of targeted advertising. Some people argue that online advertising which uses personal information to target specific people is an invasion of privacy. Others argue that it's simply an acceptable way to reach consumers with products and services they're interested in. What's your take? Do you think targeted advertising is ethical, or is it an invasion of privacy?

Jessica: I think targeted advertising is an invasion of privacy. Advertisers shouldn't be able to track and use our personal information to sell us products. It's not fair to consumers, and it's a violation of our rights. Instead, advertisers should focus on creating high-quality ads that appeal to a broad audience. By doing that they can both increase their sales and show respect for their customers.

Mike: I disagree with Jessica. To me, targeted advertising is ethical. It's a more efficient way to reach consumers with products and services that are relevant to their interests. With the money they save by using more effective marketing techniques, companies can afford to offer lower prices to their customers. Plus, we can always opt-out of targeted advertising by adjusting our privacy settings. As long as we get a choice, I think targeted advertising can be beneficial.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:49; Saved At: 2026/6/5 21:17:14; Word Count: 142)

I agree with Jessica's opinion that targeted advertising is an invasion of privacy. For me, sometimes after I searched some materials in Google website or Youtube, then I open some shopping finding that every suggestion is related to what I had just seen. It was really scaring that it felt like someone set a camera in your phone, monitoring what you are doing all the time. Also, the targeted advertising could cause some ethical problems. Since the information of customers could be related with the profits, it would eventually have a price. Some enterprises might focus on this area, collecting personal profiles and selling them. Then none of us would escape this horrible algorithm. Imagine once you registered a application or website, they would know everything about you from such enterprises. They know exactly what you might want, and post to you.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 144)

This is a controversial topic, but I think that targeted advertising isn't an ethical problem and I'm not concerned about it. I really like Mike's idea that we can just opt-out of targeted advertising if we are worried about it. I'd add that it is extremely easy to do this nowadays, as Internet browsers are very user-friendly. Even people that are inexperienced with technology can find the right settings and adjust them. Jessica raised the relevant point that companies should create advertisements that appeal to a broad audience, but she didn't mention how difficult it is to make advertisements like that. Society is more diverse than ever before, so it is almost impossible to create messages that everyone finds attractive. Small companies without large advertising and research budgets might go out of business if they are prevented from using cheap and effective targeted advertising.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 129)

While I appreciate the points made by both Jessica and Mike, I strongly believe that targeted advertising is a major problem. This is because it can gather an immense amount of data about our personal preferences and manipulate us into purchasing products that we don't actually need. For example, two weeks ago I spent some time reading articles about camping on the Internet, and I became really engrossed in the topic. Yesterday, I started seeing advertisements on my phone for extremely expensive camping equipment which I was really tempted to buy, even though I am on a tight budget nowadays. Some people might argue that targeted advertising helps us find what we need, but they overlook the fact that it might cause us to spend more money than necessary.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Your response clearly takes a position and gives a relevant personal example. It also adds a useful ethical concern about companies collecting and selling user profiles. However, the language contains several grammar and word-choice problems, and some ideas are expressed in an unclear or exaggerated way. Under a strict TOEFL Academic Discussion standard, this is a mid-to-upper response, but not a full-score one.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Corrected Expression
I agree with Jessica's opinion that targeted advertising is an invasion of privacy.	I agree with Jessica that targeted advertising is an invasion of privacy.
after I searched some materials in Google website or Youtube	after I searched for some information on Google or YouTube
then I open some shopping finding that every suggestion is related to what I had just seen	when I opened a shopping app, I found that every suggestion was related to what I had just seen
It was really scaring	It was really scary
it felt like someone set a camera in your phone	it felt as if someone had put a camera in my phone
monitoring what you are doing all the time	monitoring what I was doing all the time
the targeted advertising could cause some ethical problems	targeted advertising could cause some ethical problems
the information of customers could be related with the profits	customers' information could be connected to profit
it would eventually have a price	it would eventually become a commodity
registered a application or website	registered for an application or website
They know exactly what you might want, and post to you.	They know exactly what you might want and send targeted ads to you.

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your answer has a clear opinion, but it is less polished in both language and development. Model Response 1 directly responds to both Jessica and Mike, then adds a new point about small companies and advertising costs. Model Response 2 also gives a personal example,

but it connects the example more clearly to a broader argument: targeted ads can manipulate people into spending money unnecessarily. Your example about Google, YouTube, and shopping apps is relevant, but the explanation becomes emotional and slightly vague, especially in phrases such as “someone set a camera in your phone” and “none of us would escape this horrible algorithm.”

The main weakness is not the choice of position, but the control of academic discussion style. A full-score response should sound more measured, precise, and logically connected. For example, instead of saying that companies “know everything about you,” it would be stronger to say that companies may build detailed consumer profiles from browsing history, search records, and shopping behavior. This keeps the same meaning but sounds more academic and convincing.

Suggestions for Improvement

To improve this response, you should keep your personal example but express it more accurately. You also need to connect each example back to the ethical issue of privacy. The second half of your response has a good idea about personal data becoming profitable, but it needs clearer wording. If you explain that data brokers may collect and sell consumer profiles without users’ full understanding, your argument will become much stronger. Also, try to use consistent pronouns. Since the example is about your own experience, use “I” and “my” instead of suddenly changing to “you.”

Overall, this is a relevant and understandable response with a clear stance, but frequent grammar errors and imprecise expressions prevent it from reaching the 24–30 range.

My Notes:

For example, instead of saying that companies “know everything about you,” it would be stronger to say that companies may build detailed consumer profiles from browsing history, search records, and shopping behavior. This keeps the same meaning but sounds more academic and convincing.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 09:57; Saved At: 2026/6/5 21:42:04; Word Count: 146)

I agree with Jessica that target advertising is an invasion of privacy. When personal information is connected with profits, there will definitely emerge some companies collecting private information, including website history, shopping cart and so on. These personal profile might finally be a commodity. For example, when I registered for a new application last week, the advertise of travelling popped out. It couldn’t be coincidence, because the destination was Iceland, exactly matching the touring video on another application I had just seen. Also, the targeted advertising might amplify your every small needs. At first, I only thought that Iceland was a beautiful and brilliant place, never thinking to actually travel there on person. But after seeing that advertise, I suddenly felt an urge to do so. Though the price actually might be a little expensive to me, I felt that I could not reject the offer.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 23/30

This revised response is clearly better than the original one. Your position is direct, your example is more specific, and the connection between targeted advertising and consumer manipulation is stronger. The response also develops one main idea consistently: personal data can become profitable, and targeted ads may push people toward unnecessary purchases. However, several grammar and word-choice problems still reduce the score. The argument is understandable, but the language is not yet smooth enough for the 26–30 range.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Corrected Expression
target advertising	targeted advertising
there will definitely emerge some companies collecting private information	some companies will definitely emerge to collect private information
website history, shopping cart and so on	browsing history, shopping carts, and so on
These personal profile might finally be a commodity.	These personal profiles might eventually become commodities.
when I registered for a new application	when I registered for a new app
the advertise of travelling popped out	an advertisement for travel popped up
It couldn't be coincidence	It could not have been a coincidence
the touring video on another application	the travel video on another app
the targeted advertising might amplify your every small needs	targeted advertising might amplify even small desires
never thinking to actually travel there on person	without ever seriously thinking about traveling there in person
the price actually might be a little expensive to me	the price might actually be a little too high for me
I felt that I could not reject the offer	I felt that I could hardly resist the offer

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your revised answer is closer to Model Response 2 because both use a personal example to show how targeted advertising can influence buying decisions. This is a good direction. Your Iceland example is specific and easy to understand, so it works better than the more general example in your first version.

However, the model responses are still stronger in language control and logical clarity. Model Response 2 says that targeted advertising can “manipulate us into purchasing products that we don’t actually need.” This sentence directly connects the example to the ethical issue. In your response, the same idea is present, but it is expressed less naturally through phrases such as “amplify your every small needs” and “I could not reject the offer.” These phrases are understandable, but they sound awkward and slightly informal.

Another difference is balance. A high-scoring academic discussion response usually sounds measured, even when it takes a strong position. Your sentence “there will definitely emerge some companies” is too absolute. It would be more convincing to say that targeted advertising may encourage companies to collect and trade consumer data. This sounds more academic and less exaggerated.

Suggestions for Improvement

The main improvement should be word choice. Use precise nouns such as “browsing history,” “consumer profiles,” “personal data,” “advertisement,” and “desire.” Also, avoid Chinese-style structures such as “there will definitely emerge” and “amplify your every small needs.” Your ideas are already strong enough, so the next step is to make the wording more natural and controlled.

Overall, this is a solid TOEFL Academic Discussion response. It has a clear opinion, a relevant example, and enough development. With fewer grammar errors and more natural phrasing, it could reach the 25–27 range.

My Notes:

manipulate us into purchasing products that we don’t actually need.
there will definitely emerge some companies -> targeted advertising may encourage companies to collect and trade consumer data.

34 Social Media

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on social studies. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Today, we're going to discuss the impact of social media on society. On one hand, social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram have connected people from all over the world. However, there are concerns about the negative effects of social media, such as the spread of misinformation, the rise of cyberbullying, and addiction to social media use. What do you think? Does social media cause more harm than good?

Sarah: I think that social media has caused more harm than good. While it's true that social media platforms have connected people in unprecedented ways, they have also caused real harm to individuals and societies. Additionally, when people spend too much time on social media platforms, they could suffer from mental health problems such as anxiety and depression. This is probably because they allow people to anonymously bully and harass other users.

Mark: I think that social media has mostly improved society. For instance, it has given a voice to people that previously were ignored. Moreover, it has provided platforms for political activism that has led to positive change. And, of course, social media has made it easy for everyone to stay connected to family and friends who are far away. In the past we had to make expensive phone calls to contact our loved ones, now we can talk to them and send them pictures for free on social networks.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:55; Saved At: 2026/6/5 23:49:43; Word Count: 131)

I strongly agree with Mark that social media's benefits outweigh disadvantages. As Mark mentioned, social media definitely brought a lot of convenience to us. I would like to add that instead of just replacing phone calls and messages, social media connected people in a multi-style way. For myself, I often scroll the moments which my friends posted and got information from that. I could share their happiness online, including touring experiences, learning something in both academic and life. Although sometimes I felt anxious as Sarah said, especially when I found someone was really successful in some area. But eventually I realized that I just need to live my own life. Following my own dream, doing my own job, using connections to foster my passion, that's the true meaning of social media.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 113)

While I totally understand what both of you mean, I mostly agree with Mark's idea that social media is beneficial. I really like how social media sites help people to hear the opinions from a diverse range of people. Traditional media outlets are controlled by the rich and powerful nowadays, so they don't often include the voices of common people. On the other hand, everyone can use social media as a platform to share their ideas. For instance, last week I read a Facebook post about an effort to unionize a coffee shop in Washington. That's not the sort of thing we can hear about on CNN or in the New York Times.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 133)

In my opinion, social media is incredibly beneficial. I strongly agree with Mark's idea that social media gives a voice to people that society used to ignore. I'd add that it is almost impossible for most people to get their messages on television or in print media because those are controlled by companies and wealthy individuals. Sarah raised the relevant point that social media causes mental health problems in some young people, but she didn't mention that social media can also help us to cope with and recover from such problems. For example, there are a lot of support groups on communities like Facebook where people can talk about their struggles and get advice from people going through similar experiences. Many people have mentioned that such groups are critically important to their lives.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Estimated Raw Score: 3.0/5

Your response clearly answers the question and gives a personal opinion, so it satisfies the basic task requirement. However, the development is not strong enough for a high score. The main example is personal and understandable, but it does not fully explain why social media benefits society more than it harms society. There are also several grammar and word-choice problems that make the response sound less natural and less academically controlled.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Suggested Correction
social media's benefits outweigh disadvantages	the benefits of social media outweigh its disadvantages
social media definitely brought a lot of convenience to us	social media has definitely brought us a lot of convenience
connected people in a multi-style way	connects people in many different ways
I often scroll the moments which my friends posted	I often scroll through the posts that my friends share
and got information from that	and get information from them
including touring experiences, learning something in both academic and life	such as their travel experiences and what they are learning in academic and daily life
Although sometimes I felt anxious as Sarah said, especially when I found someone was really successful in some area.	Although I sometimes feel anxious, as Sarah said, especially when I see that someone is very successful in a certain area, I eventually...
But eventually...	
Following my own dream, doing my own job, using connections to foster my passion, that's the true meaning of social media.	Therefore, I believe the true value of social media is that it can connect us with others and inspire us, as long as we do not lose focus on our own lives and goals.

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your answer is less effective mainly because your supporting idea is more general and personal. Model Response 1 focuses on one clear social benefit: social media gives ordinary people a public voice. It also gives a concrete example about unionizing a coffee shop. Model Response 2 is even stronger because it directly responds to Sarah's concern about mental health and then turns that point around by explaining how online support groups can help people.

Your response mentions connection, friendship, happiness, and anxiety, but these points are not developed deeply enough. The sentence about feeling anxious actually supports Sarah's negative view, but your

response does not fully explain why this problem is less serious than the benefits. Also, expressions such as “multi-style way” and “true meaning of social media” sound vague, so the argument becomes less convincing.

How to Improve

To reach a higher score, you should choose one stronger supporting reason and develop it more specifically. For example, instead of only saying that you can see your friends’ posts, you could explain how social media helps students maintain relationships, exchange useful academic information, or find communities with similar interests. You should also use a clearer concession structure: admit that anxiety and misinformation are real problems, but explain why careful use of social media can reduce these harms. Finally, avoid sentence fragments and vague expressions, and use more natural academic phrases such as “maintain relationships,” “share information,” “support communities,” and “use social media responsibly.”

35 Grading Students

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: In class today, we're going to talk about grading students. Before you come to class, I want you to think about whether grades are beneficial. On one hand, they provide a way to measure students' progress. On the other hand, some argue that grades are too focused on performance and don't provide an accurate picture of a student's overall academic abilities. If you had to choose, would you say that students should be given grades or not? Why?

Lila: I think that students should not be given grades. Grades create a needlessly competitive environment and can make students feel like they are only valued for their academic performance. When students feel that grades are the most important thing, they get discouraged. Instead of giving specific grades, teachers should provide personal feedback that helps students understand what they need to improve and how they can do so. I think that approach leads to more academic success.

Jake: I believe that grades are the only way for students to understand how well they are doing and the only way to motivate them to work harder. Without grades, there would be no way to measure their progress or to identify areas where they need to improve. Moreover, grades prepare students for the real world where they will be judged based on their performance. The only way for adults to advance in their careers is to consistently perform well, and grading children prepares them for that.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:51; Saved At: 2026/6/6 16:48:54; Word Count: 116)

I agree with Jake that grades are essential because students could measure their performance using their grades. Grades are digital number that value students' work. For example, when a student is applying a PhD, he needs to provide his grade paper. It is more convenient for professors to have a overall view seeing the certification. Professors could know this student's approximate academic ability in a quite short time. However, grades should not just be focused on academic exam. They should also contain some integral aspects, including giving a speech or doing research further instead of just learning what textbooks have. So I think grades could be really useful if students' performance could be valued in multi-dimension.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 122)

While I appreciate Lila's point of view, I believe that children should be given grades on a regular basis. Even young kids want to improve academically, and grades help them to do so. Remember that students are aware that they must develop strong academic skills if they want to achieve their goals in life. Grades indicate the current level of their skills and tell them whether or not they should change how they approach their studies. For instance, a student who has received a fantastic grade in math and a poor grade in science will know to spend more of his free time studying science. In contrast, a student who hasn't gotten any grades will have no idea what to focus on.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 153)

While this is certainly a controversial topic, I don't think students should be graded. I strongly agree with Lila's idea that grades can create an overly competitive environment and may not accurately reflect a student's progress. I'd add that grades can lead to a focus on test-taking strategies rather than actual learning, and as a result students may not fully engage with the material. This means they could lack key knowledge that they'll need when they move on to the next stage of their academic life. Jake raised the relevant point that grades are the only way to identify the specific areas where students are weak, but he didn't mention that teachers can study samples of their students' work to find their weaknesses without actually grading the work. For example, they could look at a student's essay, see that he is weak when it comes to grammar, and tell him that in person.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Suggested Correction
students could measure their performance	students can measure their performance
grades are digital number that value students' work	grades are numerical indicators that evaluate students' work / that reflect students' performance
when a student is applying a PhD he needs to provide his grade paper have a overall view seeing the certification in a quite short time	when a student is applying for a PhD program he needs to provide his transcript get an overall view by reading the transcript in a very short time / in quite a short time
grades should not just be focused on academic exam	grades should not focus only on academic exams
some integral aspects doing research further just learning what textbooks have valued in multi-dimension	some broader aspects / other important aspects conducting independent research just learning what is in textbooks evaluated from multiple dimensions

Comparison with the Model Responses

Your response has a clear position and meets the minimum word requirement. You also make a useful contribution by saying that grades should measure more than exam scores. However, compared with the model responses, your argument is less fully developed. The model responses explain one main idea step by step and use examples that are closely connected to ordinary students' learning. Your PhD application example is understandable, but it feels a little too narrow and advanced for a general discussion about grading students.

The model responses also use smoother transitions and more natural academic language. For example, phrases such as "current level of their skills," "specific areas where students are weak," and "fully engage with the material" sound more precise than expressions like "digital number," "grade paper," and "valued in multi-dimension." These language problems do not completely block meaning, but they reduce clarity and make the response sound less fluent.

Main Suggestions

- Use a more common example, such as a student improving in math, writing, or science after seeing a low grade.

- Develop one idea more deeply instead of moving quickly from grades to PhD applications to speeches and research.
- Replace unnatural phrases with standard academic expressions, especially “transcript,” “numerical indicators,” and “evaluated from multiple perspectives.”
- Your final idea is good, but it should be stated more clearly: grades are useful only when they assess different abilities, not just test performance.

Overall, this is a relevant and complete response, but the language accuracy and idea development are not strong enough for a high score. With clearer examples and more natural phrasing, it could move closer to the 22–24 range.

36 Taxing Unhealthy Products (Rewritten)

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on political science. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Today we're going to discuss whether the government should tax unhealthy products, such as sugary drinks and junk food. On one hand, taxing these products could discourage people from consuming them and reduce health problems. On the other hand, some argue that such taxes unfairly target lower-income families who may rely on these products as affordable sources of food. If you had to choose, would you support or oppose taxing unhealthy products? Why?

Sam: I support the idea of taxing unhealthy products. These products are often high in sugar, salt, and fat, which can lead to serious health problems such as obesity, diabetes, and heart disease. As you said, by taxing these products, the government can discourage people from consuming them and resolve some of these health issues. Moreover, the revenue generated can be used to fund advertising campaigns that promote healthy eating habits.

Tanya: I believe that such taxes are unfair to families that don't have a lot of money. Wealthy people will not care about the taxes and their habits won't change. Additionally, when prices go up, people usually try to save money by purchasing lower-quality products that are cheaper to begin with. If people start buying low-quality food they could suffer even more health problems. There are better solutions to this problem than taxes.

Original Response (Time Used: 10:41; Overtime: +00:41; Saved At: 2026/6/8 05:18:23; Word Count: 133)

I strongly agree with Sam that government should tax unhealthy products. For most people, I think, unhealthy products are unnecessary. For example, cigarettes are addictive, but they are really harmful - hardly to find any benefits. By taxing such products could decrease the usage of cigarettes, which will not only be good at human health, but also help declining the air pollution. Also, this advantage is the same concerning junk food and so on. Tanya said that taxes are unfair to poor families, but I think these family could buy other healthier products. They could just buy some vegetables to eat, instead of eating junk food; They could read some books or sing song when they are free or feeling bored, instead of smoking. Every unhealthy product could be replaced by cheaper product.¹⁹

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 107)

While both Sam and Tanya raised some relevant points, I share Tanya's opinion that the government probably shouldn't tax unhealthy products. Remember that our health depends on a lot of factors, so focusing entirely on our diets is counterproductive. The food we eat certainly impacts our health, but so does the amount of exercise we get. Even if we eat junk food all the time, we can avoid burdening the health care system by exercising on a regular basis. Therefore, I don't think it is fair to punish people

¹⁹The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

just for what they eat. Instead, the government should focus on educating people about healthy habits in general.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 124)

In my opinion, it's probably a good idea to tax some unhealthy products. I strongly agree with Sam's idea that taxes on junk food can reduce the prevalence of serious health problems in society. The government already spends an enormous amount of money treating people with such illnesses, but can't afford to do that forever. I read that the budget of our national health care system has increased by 20% in the last five years, which I found shocking. Tanya mentioned that people might turn to lower-quality products to save money, but she didn't mention that the government can prevent this by using the money from the tax to make healthy choices more affordable. For example, they could subsidize products like fresh fruit and vegetables.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 17/30

This response has a clear position and enough words, but it would probably receive only a mid-level score. The main problem is not the basic idea, but the weak development and frequent grammar errors. The argument about cigarettes is understandable, but it moves away from the professor's main examples of sugary drinks and junk food. Also, the response to Tanya is not fully convincing because vegetables are not always cheaper or easier for low-income families to buy.

Main Grammar Corrections

Original Expression	Corrected Expression
government should tax unhealthy products	the government should tax unhealthy products
For most people, I think, unhealthy products are unnecessary.	I think unhealthy products are unnecessary for most people.
they are really harmful - hardly to find any benefits	they are extremely harmful, and it is hard to find any benefits
By taxing such products could decrease the usage of cigarettes	Taxing such products could reduce cigarette use
be good at human health	be good for human health
help declining the air pollution	help reduce air pollution
these family could buy	these families could buy
sing song	sing songs
Every unhealthy product could be replaced by cheaper product.	Every unhealthy product could be replaced by a cheaper, healthier product.

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your answer is less convincing because it gives examples that are too simple and sometimes unrealistic. Model Response 2 is stronger because it directly answers Tanya's concern: the government could use tax revenue to make healthy food cheaper. This creates a more balanced and practical argument. Your response only says that poor families can buy vegetables or do other activities instead of smoking, but this does not fully address the economic difficulty mentioned by Tanya.

Your language is also less controlled than the model responses. The model answers use natural academic expressions such as "reduce the prevalence of serious health problems" and "make healthy choices more affordable." Your response has several sentence-structure problems, especially the fragment beginning

with “By taxing such products.” These errors do not completely block meaning, but they make the writing sound less fluent and less mature.

To improve, you should keep the same position but make the reasoning more specific. Instead of focusing on cigarettes and air pollution, it would be better to discuss sugary drinks, junk food, obesity, and diabetes. Also, when responding to Tanya, you should admit that the tax may hurt low-income families, then propose a solution, such as using the tax money to subsidize vegetables, fruit, or school meals. That would make the argument much closer to a high-scoring response.

Rewritten Response (Time Used: 10:50; Overtime: +00:50; Saved At: 2026/6/8 05:40:29; Word Count: 167)

I strongly agree with Sam that taxing unhealthy products is a good idea. Like the professor said, such taxes could discourage people from consuming them and reduce health problems. I would like to add that it also creates new government incomes. Most of people who use these unhealthy products might have a health issue, which cost government a lot of money to treat or heal them. So these taxes could be explained as the social medical taxes. The money comes from people who consume unhealthy products, but it would finally go back to them. Tanya said that it will be unfair for poor families if taxing low-quality products. But I think it is quite fair in the way I have explained. In my opinion, if everyone is willing to consume healthy products, then governments could save a lot of money in medical area. The extra money could be used to lower the price of healthy goods. Then finally the society would become a positive and healthy cycle.²⁰

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

This version is clearly better than the previous one. The position is clear, the response directly addresses both Sam and Tanya, and the idea of using tax revenue to reduce medical costs and lower the price of healthy goods is relevant and logical. Compared with the earlier response, this one is less off-topic and more connected to the professor’s question.

However, it is still not a high-scoring response because there are several noticeable grammar and word-choice problems. For example, “government incomes” should be “government revenue,” “Most of people” should be “Most people,” and “cost government a lot of money” should be “cost the government a lot of money.” Also, “social medical taxes” is not a natural expression. A better phrase would be “a public health tax” or “a health-related tax.”

The logic is stronger than before, but it still needs more precision. Saying that most people who consume unhealthy products have health issues is too absolute. A better argument would be that frequent consumption of these products increases the risk of obesity, diabetes, and heart disease, which can place pressure on the health care system. Also, the response to Tanya would be stronger if you clearly explained that the government should use the tax revenue to subsidize healthy food for low-income families.

Overall, this is a solid mid-level response. With fewer grammar errors and a more precise explanation of the economic issue, it could reach around **24/30**.

²⁰The gray text indicates content written after the allotted ten-minute period.

37 AI

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on computer science. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: A new story about Artificial Intelligence (AI) is in the news almost every day. And, of course, companies are spending an enormous amount of money to develop new technologies related to AI. Before next class, I want you to consider the following question: Is AI a dangerous technology that, overall, will be harmful to society, or is it a powerful tool that will improve the lives of people?

Megan: Personally, I think AI is a threat. As AI advances, many jobs may become automated, leaving people without work. That will certainly increase income inequality. Additionally, there's the risk that AI systems could be programmed with biases or used to discriminate against certain groups. We need to be careful and ensure that AI is developed in an ethical and responsible way. Since we can't guarantee that right now, I think it is best to slow down.

David: I disagree with Megan. I'm of the opinion that AI has the potential to solve many of the world's problems, from climate change to disease. Additionally, AI can help us make better decisions by analyzing vast amounts of data and identifying patterns that humans may miss. That said, I agree with Megan that we must ensure that AI is developed and used in a responsible way that benefits society as a whole.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:48; Saved At: 2026/6/7 15:12:17; Word Count: 147)

I agree with David that AI is a powerful tool, but it needs to be supervised properly. As AI is improving every day, it can help us in different ways. Life is more convenient with the assistance of AI. For me, I use AI to revise my paper by finding small mistakes which was really hard to locate in old days. Also, whenever I want to design a website or program, AI would provide the code immediately. So, using AI could minimize the time cost of trying something new. However, AI could also be harmful if it was abused. For example, I saw a news that a hacker attack the firewall of some companies using AI. AI accelerated the attacking by providing codes and searching backdoor. As a consequence, we should monitor the usage of AI, including set up some related policies to prevent some illegal actions.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 114)

While I can understand both points of view, I think that AI is mostly helpful and will improve our lives over time. Like David, I'm really confident that AI will help us deal with many serious problems currently affecting society. It has already been used to make driving safer and reduce car accidents, so we currently have some proof that AI is helping people around the world. According to statistics I read last week, self-driving cars get in accidents 80% less frequently than cars driven by humans. That seems like an incredible advantage to me. Remember that new technologies are always scary at first, but we shouldn't let our fears prevent us from making progress.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 127)

No one can predict the future with absolute certainty, but I am pretty sure that AI will cause a lot of problems in the long run. For instance, think about the effect it will have on education. We've already heard that many university students are using artificial intelligence to cheat on their assignments. It is almost impossible for teachers to detect when an essay has been written by an AI bot, so lazy students have stopped writing their papers altogether. Not only are students using AI to write their essays, but some are even using it to do math assignments... or even write computer code for their computer science classes. While I'm sure that no one in THIS class is dishonest, we cannot ignore the overall trend.

Evaluation and Suggestions (ChatGPT 5.5 thinking model)

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Suggested Correction
As AI is improving every day	Slightly unnatural wording	As AI continues to improve
with the assistance of AI	Correct but slightly stiff	with the help of AI
finding small mistakes which was really hard	Subject-verb agreement; informal phrasing	finding small mistakes that were difficult to locate
in old days	Incorrect article usage	in the past
AI would provide the code immediately	Verb tense is not ideal for a general fact	AI can provide code immediately
minimize the time cost of trying something new	Unnatural expression	reduce the time needed to try something new
if it was abused	For a general condition, "is" is better	if it is abused
I saw a news	"News" is uncountable	I saw a news report / I read a news story
a hacker attack the firewall	Verb tense and article problem	a hacker attacked the firewall
AI accelerated the attacking	Unnatural noun form	AI accelerated the attack
by providing codes and searching backdoor	"Code" is usually uncountable; "backdoors" needs article/plural	by providing code and searching for backdoors
including set up some related policies	Wrong verb form after "including"	including setting up related policies

Comparison with the Model Responses

Your response has a clear position and relevant personal examples, especially the examples about revising papers and writing code. These make your answer more concrete than a purely general discussion. However, compared with the model responses, your argument is less focused. Model Response 1 develops one main benefit of AI in detail, while Model Response 2 develops one main risk in detail. Your response mentions several ideas, but some of them are only briefly explained, so the reasoning feels less complete.

The biggest difference is language control. The model responses use simple but accurate sentence structures, so the ideas are easy to follow. Your response is understandable, but grammar errors such as "I saw a news," "a hacker attack," and "which was really hard" noticeably reduce fluency. Under the stricter TOEFL standard, these errors would prevent the response from reaching the high-score range.

To improve, you should keep the same balanced opinion but make the structure tighter. One strong benefit example and one strong risk example are enough. The cyberattack example is useful, but it needs clearer wording and a more specific explanation. The final sentence should also be more precise: instead of saying society should “set up some related policies,” explain that governments and companies should regulate illegal uses of AI while still allowing helpful innovation.

Evaluation and Suggestions (Gemini 3.1 Pro thinking model)

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 25/30

Grammar Corrections

Original Text	Corrected Text	Explanation
mistakes which was	mistakes which were	Subject-verb agreement (plural).
in old days	in the old days	Missing definite article.
AI would provide	AI provides	Simple present tense for general facts.
I saw a news	I read a news report	“News” is an uncountable noun.
hacker attack	hacker attacked	Past tense for a completed past event.
searching backdoor	searching for backdoors	Missing preposition and pluralization.
including set up	including setting up	“Including” must be followed by a gerund.

Comparison with Model Responses & Suggestions

Your response effectively fulfills the task with relevant personal examples, but falls slightly short of the model responses in grammatical precision and lexical sophistication.

- **Grammatical Precision:** The models demonstrate near-perfect syntactical control, whereas your response contains fundamental errors (e.g., subject-verb agreement, uncountable nouns) that briefly distract the reader. *Suggestion:* Reserve one minute at the end of your writing time to proofread specifically for verb tenses, plurals, and articles.
- **Vocabulary & Cohesion:** Your vocabulary is clear but somewhat colloquial (e.g., “small mistakes”, “trying something new”). The models use stronger academic phrasing (e.g., “absolute certainty”, “incredible advantage”) and more sophisticated transitions. *Suggestion:* Elevate your word choice (e.g., use “minor errors” instead of “small mistakes”) and practice using complex sentence structures to connect contrasting ideas seamlessly.

It seems that Gemini is more merciful than ChatGPT.

38 Longevity

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on social studies. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Life expectancies are increasing all over the world nowadays. Some of you probably know someone who is more than 100 years old. This has been attributed to things like advances in medical technology, improvements in government services and even changes in lifestyle habits. Before our next class, I want you to consider the following question: What factor do you think has contributed the most to the increase in life expectancy?

Lisa: I think the main reason why people are living longer nowadays is recent advances in medical technology. Modern medicine has enabled us to better treat and manage chronic illnesses, and there have been major breakthroughs in areas such as cancer treatment and organ transplantation. As a result, people are able to live longer with diseases that may have been fatal in the past. Not only that, but they can live more rewarding and fulfilling lives.

John: While medical technology has certainly played a role, I think improvements in government services have been just as important. We now have access to clean drinking water, sanitation systems, and free vaccines that have dramatically reduced health problems. In the past, people didn't have access to any of these things. Additionally, public health campaigns have helped educate people about healthy habits such as exercise, healthy eating, and about the danger of smoking.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:38; Saved At: 2026/6/7 17:14:40; Word Count: 123)

I think the most important factor that contributed to longevity have been the environment. Since the evolution of industry, every country had been building large factories and polluting without supervision. Until when the global meeting was held which discussed about how to improve the natural environment, people finally realized that the pollution was so damaging to our livelihood. After controlling the carbon emitting and hazard air releasing, the environment became more and more habitable. As we all know, the environment was vital to everyone's health. The air we breath, the water we drink, every corner of environment is influencing us. So we should protect the environment and make it a better world. Only through this could we enjoy a longer and happier life.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 128)

In my opinion, new scientific discoveries are the main reason we live longer nowadays. New technology also makes it a lot easier for doctors to deliver those treatments. In many cases, doctors can assist patients over the Internet, even from miles away. That wasn't possible when my parents were young. Back then, the average life expectancy was much lower than it is now. It's certainly true that public campaigns about healthy eating and exercise have improved our lives, but people actually have less healthy diets and get less exercise than they did in the past. Despite that, they still live longer lives. For example, although children are less likely to have physical education classes or play outside nowadays, they still suffer from fewer diseases than in the past.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 104)

A lot of things impact how long we live, but I'm fairly sure that our longevity is mainly due to improved government services. In the past, it was normal for people to go decades without getting a regular checkup, but nowadays local authorities encourage people to get checked out by a doctor on an annual basis. While individuals are certainly more likely to be diagnosed with life-threatening diseases nowadays, early detection means that they are also more likely to be cured. I think health care services like this will continue to be well-funded in the future, so our life spans might get even longer.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Suggested Correction
the most important factor that contributed to longevity have been the environment	Subject-verb agreement; awkward phrasing	the most important factor that has contributed to longevity is the environment
Since the evolution of industry	Unnatural expression	Since the development of modern industry
every country had been building large factories	Wrong tense for general historical development	many countries built large factories
polluting without supervision	Awkward and incomplete expression	caused pollution without enough regulation
Until when the global meeting was held which discussed about	Incorrect sentence structure; "discuss" does not need "about"	After global meetings were held to discuss
damaging to our livelihood	Word choice is not precise	harmful to human health and daily life
carbon emitting and hazard air releasing	Incorrect noun forms and word choice	carbon emissions and hazardous air pollution
the environment became more and more habitable	Understandable but slightly unnatural	the environment became healthier and more livable
the environment was vital to everyone's health	Tense problem	the environment is vital to everyone's health
The air we breath	Wrong verb form	The air we breathe
every corner of environment	Missing article	every part of the environment
Only through this could we enjoy	Grammatically possible but unnatural here	Only in this way can we enjoy

Comparison with the Model Responses

Your response has a clear opinion and stays generally related to the professor's question. Choosing the environment as the main factor is acceptable because clean air and clean water can affect public health. However, compared with the model responses, your reasoning is less direct. The model responses connect their chosen factor to longer life expectancy through specific mechanisms, such as better treatment, regular checkups, early detection, and fewer diseases. Your response mainly says that pollution is bad and the environment is important, but it does not clearly explain how environmental improvement has increased life expectancy more than medicine or government services.

The main weakness is development. Phrases such as “the global meeting” are too vague, and the historical explanation is not very precise. A stronger response would mention concrete environmental improvements, such as cleaner drinking water, reduced air pollution, safer waste treatment, or stricter pollution laws. These examples would make the connection between environmental protection and longer lives much clearer.

Language control is also weaker than in the model responses. There are frequent grammar and word-choice problems, especially with tense, subject–verb agreement, and noun forms. Under the strict TOEFL standard, these errors reduce fluency and make the argument sound less mature. To improve, keep the same main idea but use one or two specific examples and explain the cause-and-effect relationship more clearly: a cleaner environment reduces disease, protects the lungs, and lowers long-term health risks, which helps people live longer.

My Notes:

discuss sth.

carbon emissions and toxic air pollutants

39 University Spending

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on public administration. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Funding for education is a really hot topic nowadays, so today we're going to talk about how universities use their limited resources. In the discussion board please respond to the following question: Should universities prioritize funding academic facilities like libraries, or is it okay to spend just as much money on sports and athletic programs?

Rachel: I think universities should prioritize funding for libraries. Libraries are essential for academic research, and they provide students with access to information and resources that they might not have otherwise. Investing in libraries can also help attract and retain the most talented professors, which can ultimately benefit the university as a whole. Sports, on the other hand, appeal to just a few people.

Mike: While I agree that libraries are important, I think that sports programs should also be a priority for universities. Sports can bring the campus community together, even if that just means they attend sports and cheer for their favorite athletes. Meanwhile, among the athletes themselves, sports promote teamwork and leadership skills. Additionally, successful sports programs can generate revenue for the university and boost its reputation.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:22; Saved At: 2026/6/7 18:36:57; Word Count: 143)

I agree with Rachel that universities should prioritize funding for libraries. For college students, learning and researching are the most important things. So a well-developed library is essential. Take myself as an example, last year when I was preparing for the final exam of fluid mechanics, I find a proper name unfamiliar and could not find the professional definition online. Then I went to library and read a specific book. It not only answered my question, but also showed me the detailed formulations. With the assistance of that understanding, I earn a high score finally. Though Mike said that sports programs are also important, I think the facilities could be simple. For example, basic facilities such as a football playground or some basketball courts could be enough for sports. Sports are only auxiliary ways to promote the learning progress, instead of the priorities.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 103)

In my opinion, universities should spend more money on academic facilities. I'm convinced that they also help schools recruit the best possible students, which improves their whole academic environment. Everyone enjoys classes a lot when their classmates are intelligent and devoted to their studies, so this seems like an obvious choice to make. Mike raised the relevant point that athletic events bring people close together, but he didn't mention that there are other ways to do that which are much more affordable. For example, organizing a campus festival is a more cost-effective way to help students bond than funding an entire football team.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 108)

While Rachel brought up a few great points, I still believe that it is worthwhile to fund athletics. Remember that most universities in this country are pretty much the same in terms of classes and professors, but a winning sports team can help a school stand out from the crowd. Many high school students pick their university based on the success of its sports teams, so it is probably a smart idea to make sure those teams get enough funding. I certainly agree that libraries are ultimately more important than football stadiums, but when enrollment goes up there will be more money for libraries and other academic facilities.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 22/30

Your response is relevant, clearly takes a position, and uses a personal example to support your opinion. However, it is not yet close to a full-score response because some grammar mistakes and unnatural expressions reduce clarity, and the argument is less developed than the model responses.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression	Reason
learning and researching are the most important things	learning and research are the most important priorities	"Research" is more natural as a noun here.
I find a proper name unfamiliar	I found a technical term unfamiliar	Use past tense; "technical term" is more accurate than "proper name."
could not find the professional definition online	could not find a reliable professional definition online	Add "reliable" to make the meaning clearer.
Then I went to library	Then I went to the library	"Library" needs the article "the."
showed me the detailed formulations	showed me the detailed formulas and explanations	"Formulations" sounds too abstract here.
I earn a high score finally	I eventually earned a high score	Use past tense; "eventually" is more natural than "finally."
the facilities could be simple	athletic facilities do not need to be expensive	This expresses the idea more clearly.
a football playground	a soccer field / a football field	"Playground" is not natural for college sports facilities.
auxiliary ways to promote the learning progress	secondary ways to support students' development	The original phrase is unnatural and too direct.
instead of the priorities	rather than the university's main priority	The singular idea is clearer and more natural.

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with Model Response 1, your answer has a clearer personal example, which is a strength. However, Model Response 1 gives a broader institutional reason: academic facilities can attract strong students and improve the whole academic environment. Your response focuses mostly on your own exam experience, so the argument feels narrower. To improve, connect your personal example back to the university level, such as explaining that libraries support all students across many majors.

Compared with Model Response 2, your response addresses the opposing view, but the rebuttal is a little simple. You say that basic sports facilities are enough, but you do not fully explain why expensive athletic programs are less necessary than libraries. A stronger answer would mention cost-effectiveness: libraries benefit nearly every student every day, while major sports programs often require large budgets and mainly benefit a smaller group.

Main Suggestions

First, make the argument more general. Your personal example is useful, but it should support a larger point about how libraries help academic success across the whole campus. Second, make the counterargument more precise. Instead of saying sports are only “auxiliary,” explain that universities can still provide basic sports facilities without spending as much as they spend on libraries. Third, avoid unnatural academic phrases such as “learning progress” and “proper name,” because these expressions make the writing sound less fluent.

Overall, this is a solid response with a clear opinion and relevant support. With cleaner grammar, a broader argument, and a stronger rebuttal, it could reach around **24–25/30**.

40 Economic Growth

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on political science. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Today we're going to talk about the debate between economic growth and protecting the environment. Economic growth creates new jobs and gives people money they can use to improve their lives. On the other hand, if we protect the environment it can be enjoyed both by ourselves and future generations. If you had to choose between prioritizing economic growth or protecting the environment, which one would you choose. Why?

Alex: I would prioritize the environment. We only have one planet and if we don't take care of it, we won't have pleasant lives in the future. Economic growth can be important, but not at the expense of the environment. I think we need to shift towards more things such as investing in renewable energy and promoting environmentally-friendly technologies. We'll all live much healthier lives if the world around us is clean.

Maggie: While I agree with Alex that environmental sustainability is important, I think that economic growth is the only way to solve many of the social and economic problems we face. We need a strong economy to create jobs, reduce poverty, and improve standards of living. Not only that, but when companies grow stronger and more profitable, they can develop new technologies that solve our environmental problems.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:57; Saved At: 2026/6/8 06:10:29; Word Count: 124)

I think my choice should depend on practical periods or different countries. Both of economic growth and protecting the environment are important. For developing countries, economic improvement seems more essential. Since there are some people starving and dying, you could not force them to protect the environment. They might cut down some trees, or polluting the water because of industry factories. Such behaviors could be forgiven if they are trying to survive. However, well-developed countries should take more responsibilities to protect the environment. The economic effect might not so vital, while the priority of life is healthy and happy. So a good environment is necessary considering these demands. Planting trees, reducing carbon emissions and saving energies are effective ways to improve the life quality.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 128)

This is a challenging topic, but I think we should prioritize the environment at this time. I strongly agree with Alex's idea that our lives will be unpleasant if we focus entirely on economic growth. I would add that if the environment is damaged by industrial development we'll all be more likely to suffer from serious ailments like cancer and lung disease. These sorts of illnesses can be a real strain on our medical systems. Maggie raised the relevant point that it's possible that profitable companies will someday solve all of our problems using new technology, but she doesn't mention that they might arrive far too late to be of use. For example, it could take decades for an innovative company to create a source of clean energy.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 130)

While I appreciate the points mentioned by both Maggie and Alex, I think that we should mainly focus on economic growth. This is because our lives will become unpleasant if the economy slows down. We all have bills to pay and those require us to earn an income. Remember that many people have families to take care of, so they need to earn a regular income. That is only possible if the economy continues to grow at the same rate year after year. Some people may feel that preserving the environment is more important than maintaining our current standard of living, but I tend to disagree. My main focus is on the quality of life that people enjoy at this exact moment, not the lives that future generations will lead.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 19/30

Your response presents a reasonable and thoughtful idea: developing countries may need economic growth first, while developed countries should take more responsibility for environmental protection. This makes your answer more nuanced than a simple one-sided response. However, the professor asks you to choose one priority, and your answer does not make a clear final choice. Because of this, the response partially avoids the central task.

Main Grammar Corrections

Original Expression	Corrected Expression
my choice should depend on practical periods or different countries	my choice would depend on the situation and the country
Both of economic growth and protecting the environment are important	Both economic growth and environmental protection are important
economic improvement seems more essential	economic growth seems more urgent
Since there are some people starving and dying you could not force them to protect the environment	Since some people are starving or struggling to survive we cannot force them to prioritize the environment
They might cut down some trees, or polluting the water	They might cut down trees or pollute the water
because of industry factories	because of industrial development
take more responsibilities	take more responsibility
The economic effect might not so vital	Economic growth might not be so vital
the priority of life is healthy and happy	the priority in life is to be healthy and happy
saving energies	saving energy
improve the life quality	improve quality of life

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your answer has a more interesting angle because it distinguishes between developing and developed countries. This is a useful contribution to the discussion. However, the model responses are stronger because they clearly choose one side and then defend it with more focused reasoning. Model Response 1 supports environmental protection and explains concrete health consequences, such as cancer, lung disease, and pressure on medical systems. Model Response 2 supports economic growth and connects it directly to jobs, income, and family responsibilities. Your response mentions poverty and survival, but the examples are still general.

The main weakness is coherence. Your argument would be stronger if you added a clear thesis such as: "Overall, I would prioritize economic growth in poorer countries, but environmental protection should become the priority once basic living standards are met." This would keep your nuanced idea while answering the question more directly. Also, some wording sounds unnatural, especially "practical periods," "industry factories," and "saving energies." These errors do not destroy the meaning, but they make the response less fluent.

To improve, you should make your final position clearer, use more precise vocabulary, and develop one example more fully. For instance, instead of saying that cutting down trees can be forgiven, you could explain that a poor country may temporarily rely on industry to reduce hunger and unemployment, while richer countries should invest in renewable energy and stricter pollution control. This would make the argument more balanced and more academically convincing.

41 City Spending

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on political science. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: As you know, governments have a responsibility to improve the lives of residents. In today's class we're going to discuss the best way for them to do that. What strategy do you think governments should use to improve the overall quality of life of residents? Why do you think it's important?

Maria: I think investing in transportation should be the main priority for every local government. This could include things like repairing roads and bridges, expanding bus and train services, and even building bike lanes. When cities have good infrastructure it's easier for residents to get around, and new businesses come to town.

Tom: While I agree that infrastructure is important, I think that social programs should also be a major focus. The government could invest in things like education, affordable housing, and healthcare. All of these sorts of programs can help address issues like poverty, inequality, and access to basic needs. By providing these types of services, the government can help improve people's well-being.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:52; Saved At: 2026/6/8 22:30:20; Word Count: 134)

As transportation and infrastructure are both important, I think medical services are the most essential factor. For residents, living a healthy life is the fundamental requirement. Physical and mental health decide whether the livelihood could be happy. I am living in a small town, where healthcare services are not well established. Last year I had a extremely painful headache, but the clinic told me that unfortunately they could not diagnose my symptom. If the government could be more aware of medical service's importance, this would not happen to me. I had to drive a far distance to the city to get cured. No one could live a peaceful life if he was feeling uncomfortable. While transportation accelerates the traveling, infrastructure improves residents' lives, the well-developed medical health service still remains the basic foundation.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 119)

In my opinion, the government should help people by providing more funding for education. I don't just mean that they should spend more on schools. In fact, I think that they should also spend money on adult education. Nowadays, a lot of people have a hard time finding regular employment, but if they have access to training and programs that improve their skills they might have more success in the job market. Cities with higher employment rates have happier people and lower crime rates, so I think this approach is a wise one. Although it's true that governments already spend a lot on education, I think investing even more in this area will help a wide range of citizens.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 120)

Some people in the class might disagree, but I am convinced that governments should invest more in maintaining national parks. As countries become more urbanized, the need for green spaces is increasing. While people can easily access a great number of fantastic amenities like stadiums and cinemas, sometimes we need to spend some time surrounded by nature. Well-maintained national parks can help citizens unwind and feel better about their hectic lives. For example, whenever I visit a park I am able to forget about the stress and anxiety I get from my classes, but the closest one is almost a two hour drive from campus. Not only that, but its facilities are poorly maintained so sometimes my visits are unpleasant.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

Your response gives a clear opinion and uses a personal example, so it answers the question directly. However, several grammar problems and unnatural expressions weaken the clarity. The logic is understandable, but the final point is not developed as fully as in the model responses.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression
As transportation and infrastructure are both important	Although transportation and infrastructure are important
I think medical services are the most essential factor	I think medical services should be the top priority
living a healthy life is the fundamental requirement	having access to health care is a basic need
Physical and mental health decide whether the livelihood could be happy	Physical and mental health largely determine whether people can live happily
I had a extremely painful headache	I had an extremely painful headache
they could not diagnose my symptom	they could not diagnose my condition
medical service's importance	the importance of medical services
drive a far distance to the city	drive a long distance to the city
to get cured	to receive treatment
No one could live a peaceful life if he was feeling uncomfortable	No one can live peacefully while suffering from poor health
the well-developed medical health service	a well-developed health-care system

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your main weakness is not relevance but expression and development. Model Response 1 explains a broader social effect: education improves employment, happiness, and crime rates. Model Response 2 also connects parks to urbanization, stress, and daily life. Your example about the headache is useful, but it stays too personal and does not clearly explain how better medical services would improve the whole community.

Another difference is sentence control. The model responses use simple but natural sentence structures. Your response has some awkward phrases, such as “whether the livelihood could be happy” and “medical health service.” These expressions make the writing sound less fluent, even though the meaning is clear.

To improve, keep your opinion about medical services, but add one broader public reason after the personal example. For example, you could explain that better clinics reduce emergency risks, help elderly residents, and make small towns more livable. This would make your argument feel less like an individual complaint and more like a political science discussion about public policy.

42 Corporate Impact

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on business. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Next week, we're going to spend a lot of time in class discussing the positive and negative ways in which companies affect the world around us. Before we start talking about that in class, I want to hear what you think about the topic. So here's a question for the message board: In your opinion, what is the best way for a company to have a positive impact on society?

Sarah: I believe that companies should focus on making their operations more socially and environmentally friendly. While charitable giving can be beneficial, it doesn't address the root causes of serious social and environmental problems. By doing business in more responsible ways, companies can have a more meaningful and lasting impact on society. Moreover, if they attract positive attention from consumers they could inspire other companies to do the same. That's the only way we can really solve today's problems.

John: While those are very good points, I think that companies should focus on charitable giving. Philanthropy can provide immediate relief to those in need and contribute to the overall well-being of society right away. It could take years or decades for business changes to have a positive impact on society, and most people just can't wait that long.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:40; Saved At: 2026/6/8 23:45:21; Word Count: 134)

Although environmentally friendly and charitable giving are both important, I think the high-quality product is the most significant factor. Producing merchants is the prior assignment for a company. So every company needs to keep professional and monitor its products' quality. A well-designed and utilized product could benefit the society directly. For example, medical companies needs to supervise every steps during the procedure. If any part goes wrong, the mistake may cause a horrible impact on patients. Also, companies are expected to innovate all the time, researching for the better drug or treatment solutions. It is the same considering other companies such as making safer cars, healthier foods and so on. So making sure the company is legal and professional is the foremost point, while environmentally friendly and charitable giving are only the bonus points.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 149)

This is a challenging topic, but I think donating to charity is the best way for companies to make the world better. I strongly agree with John's idea that charitable donations are a way to quickly address the serious problems that we are facing. I'd add that some of these problems – like homelessness and food insecurity – are more serious than they have ever been, so companies certainly have a role to play. Even a small donation can save someone's life. Sarah raised the relevant point that philanthropy might help businesses to attract new customers, but she didn't mention that nowadays people's purchasing decisions are mostly based on cost. Many people prefer to buy the cheapest products available, even if they are sold by unethical companies. Because the economy is in such rough shape, they just can't afford to think about the reputation of a business when they are shopping.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 115)

While I appreciate the points mentioned by both Sarah and John, I think that companies should focus on paying their employees higher salaries. We all know that nowadays people around the world are struggling just to keep their heads above water. Everyone is also aware that inflation is out of control, so even basic necessities are quite expensive. Remember that children from poor households don't always live up to their potential, so business executives ought to help them by paying their parents higher wages. Some people may feel that this approach doesn't address long-term concerns like climate change, but I think that poverty is accelerating and could be an even bigger concern in the future.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Your response has a clear and relevant opinion: companies should make high-quality and safe products. This is a reasonable contribution to the discussion because it gives another strategy besides environmental responsibility and charity. However, the score is limited by several word-choice problems, grammar mistakes, and a lack of deeper explanation.

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression
Although environmentally friendly and charitable giving are both important	Although environmentally friendly operations and charitable giving are both important
the high-quality product is the most significant factor	producing high-quality products is the most important factor
Producing merchants is the prior assignment for a company	Producing goods is the primary responsibility of a company
keep professional	remain professional / maintain professional standards
monitor its products' quality	monitor the quality of its products
A well-designed and utilized product	A well-designed and useful product
benefit the society directly	benefit society directly
medical companies needs	medical companies need
every steps during the procedure	every step during the production process
cause a horrible impact on patients	seriously harm patients
researching for the better drug or treatment solutions	developing better drugs or treatment solutions
It is the same considering other companies such as making safer cars, healthier foods and so on	The same idea applies to other industries such as companies that make safer cars or healthier food
the foremost point	the top priority
only the bonus points	secondary concerns

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your answer has a good basic idea, but it does not develop the social impact deeply enough. Model Response 1 explains why charity can solve urgent problems quickly and even responds to Sarah's point about consumer behavior. Model Response 2 connects higher salaries to inflation, poverty, and children's future opportunities. By contrast, your response mainly says that product quality is important, but it does not fully explain how this improves society beyond avoiding harm.

Your language is also less natural than the model responses. Phrases such as "producing merchants," "prior assignment," and "researching for the better drug" are understandable only after interpretation. In TOEFL

writing, these lexical problems reduce fluency and precision. The model responses use simple but accurate expressions, which makes their arguments easier to follow.

To improve this response, keep your main argument, but make it broader. After the medical-company example, you could add that safe and reliable products build public trust, protect consumers, and reduce social costs caused by accidents or defective goods. Also, avoid casual phrases like “bonus points” in academic discussion writing; use more formal expressions such as “secondary concerns” or “additional responsibilities.”

My Notes:

developing better drugs or treatment solutions

The same idea applies to other ...(industries)

the foremost point -> the top priority

only the bonus points -> secondary concerns / additional responsibilities

43 Work From Home

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on business management. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Today, we're going to talk about the benefits and drawbacks of remote work. Many companies have implemented remote work policies in the past few years, and many others are considering joining them. Given that this represents a major change in the way we work and interact with each other, companies must carefully consider all relevant details before making a decision. What do you think? Is remote work beneficial, or do you think it's a bad idea?

Sara: I think remote work is a very positive trend. When we work from home, we spend less time commuting and we have more flexible schedules. Plus, many people find that they are more productive when working from home. Some people say this is because they aren't distracted by their coworkers, while others suggest it's because their energy isn't drained during a long and bothersome commute.

Michael: While I can see the benefits of remote work, I don't think it should become the new normal. There's something to be said for the atmosphere that comes from being in the same physical space as your colleagues. I also think that remote work can make it harder to build relationships and collaborate effectively. This means it might limit our chances to earn promotions and raises. And what about people who don't have enough room for a home office? They'll suffer if this trend continues.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:45; Saved At: 2026/6/9 00:07:22; Word Count: 165)

I think it is better to offer the choice for staffs whether to work in company or at home. For some people, they love the way interacting with each other face to face, which not only promotes the communication but also binds the connections between workers and colleagues. For example, I am really outgoing and always eager to make new friends with people around me. The passion could drive away my depressions if some project does not work out. However, for some people who are more efficient while working alone, then working remotely might be more suitable for them. My senior brother is an exemplification. It might cost him three days to complete a task working in the office. But he only needs one day working alone at home. He told me that he love the peace that no one would disturb him. So I think companies should take both choices into consideration, and find out which one is more suitable to different individual employees.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 119)

While a lot of people favor traditional workplace arrangements, I really think that letting employees work from home is a fantastic idea which more companies should consider. Most of us just feel much more comfortable when we are in our own house, and that makes it possible for us to think more creatively about our assignments. Nowadays, employers value creativity above all else, so this option is probably best for everyone. While communicating with people in person can certainly inspire us to think about things from new perspectives, so can talking to people via social networks. Actually, the ability to quickly

share links to relevant articles sometimes leads to even greater inspiration and more rapid progress on work projects.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 128)

While Ronald has raised some relevant points, I think that remote work is harmful. When we work from home, we don't have many opportunities to directly interact with our supervisors. Consequently, we are likely to be overlooked when promotions are offered to employees. Remember that company managers only promote people they have very close personal connections with, and such relationships cannot be established through e-mail. Since almost everyone wants to advance in their careers and make more money, I think it's a smart idea to give up remote work and return to our offices. It's also important to keep in mind that spending time with our colleagues can improve our mental health. That's because socializing with people outside of our family is a good way to release stress.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Suggested Correction
offer the choice for staffs	offer employees the choice
work in company or at home	work in the office or at home
they love the way interacting	they enjoy interacting
promotes the communication	improves communication
binds the connections	strengthens relationships
drive away my depressions	reduce my stress or frustration
if some project does not work out	when a project does not go well
then working remotely might be	working remotely might be
My senior brother is an exemplification	My senior schoolmate is a good example
It might cost him three days	It might take him three days
he love the peace	he loves the quiet environment
no one would disturb him	no one disturbs him
different individual employees	individual employees

Overall Evaluation

Your response answers the question clearly and gives a balanced opinion: companies should not choose only one model, but should allow different employees to choose the working style that suits them. This is a reasonable and relevant position. You also give two personal examples, which makes your response more specific than a purely general answer. However, the language contains several noticeable grammar and word-choice problems, especially with countable nouns, verb forms, and unnatural expressions. These errors do not block understanding, but they make the writing sound less fluent and less academic.

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with the model responses, your main advantage is that your position is more practical and balanced. Instead of simply saying remote work is good or bad, you suggest a flexible policy. This is a strong idea. However, the model responses sound more fluent because they use smoother transitions and more academic phrasing, such as "flexible schedules," "collaborate effectively," and "advance in their careers." Your response relies more on simple personal examples and has less analysis of business management. For a higher score, you should explain why flexibility benefits both employees and companies, not only why some individuals prefer one option.

Suggestions for Improvement

To improve this response, first make your thesis more direct, for example: “I believe remote work is beneficial, but companies should offer it as an option rather than a requirement.” Second, replace informal or inaccurate words with more natural expressions, such as “employees” instead of “staffs” and “quiet environment” instead of “peace.” Third, after giving an example, add one sentence of analysis that connects it back to company performance. For instance, explain that employees who work in their preferred environment may become more efficient and more satisfied with their jobs. This would make the response more persuasive and closer to a high-scoring TOEFL answer.

44 Online Classes

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Over the next few weeks, we're going to talk about recent trends in education. Specifically, we'll discuss how many universities have started letting students take classes from home instead of taking them in person on campus. I want to know what you think about this issue, so here's a quick question for the discussion board: "What do you think is the most significant impact of online classes? Why do you think it has this impact?"

Jack: The main thing is that online classes make education more accessible. For one, they help reduce commuting times and costs for students. They also give them more flexibility in their schedules. Plus, online learning can be more accessible for students who have disabilities or live far away from campus. Traditionally, high costs have prevented many people from pursuing an education, but thanks to online classes cost is less of a problem.

Emily: I think that online classes cause people to learn less than before. There's something to be said for the energy and engagement that comes from being in the same physical space as your classmates and instructor. Moreover, when we take classes in person it is easier to build relationships and collaborate. We learn just as much from personal connections as we do from our actual lectures and textbooks.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:53; Saved At: 2026/6/9 11:29:47; Word Count: 128)

I think the most significant impact of online classes should be the efficiency. When having class in classroom, students need to listen all of the sentences in original speed. However, online classes allow students to skip the period they have already known. For example, last year I took a online course called Fluid Mechanics. The classes contained more than 20 hours, including the static and dynamic part. While I already learned static equations before, I could go through this part in 2x speed, which made my learning more efficiently. Because of such flexibility, students could decide the learning progress depending on their own situations. The traditional classes could not possess this advantage, since teachers are expected to introduce all the knowledge and take care of the poor students.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 128)

While there are certainly some advantages of online learning, I think its biggest impact is that it makes people more likely to cheat on their assignments. When we study on campus, we can easily access resources like an academic library or a science lab. We can even schedule meetings with our professors or other experts who work on campus. That means it is easier to complete our assignments all by ourselves. In contrast, when we study entirely at home it can be difficult to access beneficial resources. Consequently, some people might feel that they have no choice but to plagiarize content online, or use AI to complete their essays. Honestly, I think people who study at home do this just to keep up with their peers on campus.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 20/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression	Reason
the efficiency	learning efficiency	"Efficiency" is too general here; the topic is learning.
having class in classroom	taking classes in a classroom	The phrase needs a clear subject and the article "a."
listen all of the sentences	listen to every sentence	"Listen" must be followed by "to."
in original speed	at the original speed	We use "at" with speed.
the period they have already known	the parts they already understand	"Period" is not natural here; "understand" fits learning content better.
a online course	an online course	"Online" begins with a vowel sound.
including the static and dynamic part	including fluid statics and dynamics	This is more precise and natural for Fluid Mechanics.
in 2x speed	at double speed / at 2x speed	We use "at" with playback speed.
made my learning more efficiently	made my learning more efficient	"Learning" needs an adjective, not an adverb.
decide the learning progress	control their learning pace	"Pace" is the natural word for speed of learning.
the poor students	struggling students / weaker students	"Poor students" sounds impolite or may mean students without money.

Evaluation

Your response answers the professor's question directly and gives a clear personal opinion: online classes improve learning efficiency. This idea is different from both Jack's focus on accessibility and Emily's focus on reduced engagement, so your post does make a contribution to the discussion. The personal example about Fluid Mechanics is also useful because it explains why online classes can help students learn at their own pace.

However, the response is not at the full-score level mainly because the language errors are quite frequent. Some phrases, such as "listen all of the sentences," "the period they have already known," and "made my learning more efficiently," are understandable but unnatural. These errors do not completely block communication, but they make the writing less fluent and less academic. In addition, the final sentence is a little too strong. Saying that teachers must "take care of the poor students" sounds awkward and slightly inappropriate. A better expression would be "support students who need more time."

Comparison with Model Response 1

Compared with Model Response 1, your answer has a more practical and reasonable central idea. Your point about controlling video speed is realistic and closely connected to online learning. The model response discusses cheating, but its logic is less convincing because it assumes that students cheat mainly because they cannot access campus resources. That cause-and-effect relationship is not very strong. However, Model Response 1 is stronger in sentence control and academic tone. It uses clearer transitions such as "In contrast" and "Consequently," while your response relies more on simple sentence connections. The model also has fewer grammar mistakes, so it sounds more fluent. To reach a higher score, you should

keep your original idea but express it with cleaner grammar, more precise words, and a more neutral academic tone.

Main Improvement Advice

The biggest improvement is not to change your argument, but to make the language more accurate. You should write “students can control their own learning pace” instead of “students could decide the learning progress.” Also, avoid informal or potentially negative words like “poor students.” If you add one sentence explaining that online classes help both fast learners and slower learners, your reasoning will become more balanced and closer to a high-scoring TOEFL response.

My Notes:

poor students -> struggling students

at ... speed

keep up with peers

45 Smartphones

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Lately we've talked a lot about the impact of technology on our lives. With the prevalence of smartphones and other devices, we're more connected than ever, but some people are distressed by this trend. We'll discuss this in our next class, but before we do I'd like to hear your thoughts on the issue. Overall, do devices like smartphones have a positive impact on the way we communicate? Or a negative one?

Rachel: This sort of technology has had a negative impact on our ability to communicate face-to-face. People are too reliant on text messages and social media, and that reduces the nuance and depth in our interactions. It's harder to read body language and tone of voice over text, and that can result in misunderstandings. If people want to become effective communicators, they should talk to people in person.

Mike: While I agree that it can sometimes be challenging to communicate in person, I also believe that modern technology is beneficial. Smartphones make it possible for us to stay connected with acquaintances and loved ones who are far away, and social networks provide a platform for introverted people to express themselves in ways that they may not be able to do in person.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:56; Saved At: 2026/6/9 12:09:35; Word Count: 128)

I agree with Mike that modern technology is beneficial overall. Almost everyone need a smartphone or some modern devices to communicate in daily life. With these devices, we are allowed to call someone or send text to others. The communications could be really efficient and break down the barrier of time and space distance. Also, I think remote connections could also contain interactions like body language and voice tone as taking face to face. Video calls and even virtual reality(VR) calls perfectly meet these needs. What's more, it can deliver some message that words and expressions that talking in person do not involved, such as emojis. So technology definitely have a positive impact on the way we communicate. I can not imagine a world without technologies like smartphones.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 123)

In my opinion, having a smartphone is advantageous in the modern world. Certain groups of people just aren't able to share their ideas in traditional media like newspapers and television broadcasts, but if they have smartphones they can easily share whatever is on their mind by posting to social networks like Twitter and Facebook. When people are able to share how they feel about political and sociological issues, they can bring about positive change in society. Think about the last election in our country. People were really upset about the policies of the Red Party, so they flooded social media with complaints and encouraged people to vote for the Blue Party. I think those posts had a profound impact on the final result.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 134)

While I can see where Mike is coming from, I am convinced that smartphones have a really detrimental impact on communication in the modern world. People everywhere have become obsessed with watching short videos and reading social media posts when they have some time to kill, so their attention spans are almost non-existent. This means they have a hard time interacting with each other for long periods of time. When my parents were young, they spent their free time reading newspapers and books. I think that improved their overall academic abilities, so when they went to college they were able concentrate on things for hours at a time, including conversations. In contrast, I get pretty anxious when I have to talk to someone and am unable to look at my phone every five minutes!

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression	Reason
Almost everyone need a smartphone or some modern de- vices to communicate in daily life	Almost everyone needs a smartphone or another modern device to communicate in daily life / in everyday life	"Everyone" is singular. The singular structure is cleaner. "Everyday life" is more natural.
we are allowed to call someone	we can call someone	"Are allowed to" sounds like per- mission, not ability.
send text to others	send text messages to others	"Text messages" is the standard phrase.
The communications could be re- ally efficient break down the barrier of time and space distance remote connections could also contain interactions like body language and voice tone	Communication can be very effi- cient overcome the barriers of time and distance remote communication can also include cues such as body language and tone of voice	"Communication" is usually un- countable here. More natural and concise. "Cues" fits body language and tone better.
as taking face to face	as in face-to-face communication	More academic and idiomatic.
virtual reality(VR) calls it can deliver some message	virtual reality (VR) calls it can convey certain messages	The original structure is incom- plete. Add a space before parentheses. "Convey" is more precise than "de- liver."
words and expressions that talk- ing in person do not involved	meanings that ordinary face-to- face conversations may not ex- press	The original grammar is incorrect.
technology definitely have I can not imagine	technology definitely has I cannot imagine	"Technology" is singular. "Cannot" is the standard written form.

Evaluation

Your response gives a clear answer to the professor's question and supports Mike's view that smartphones have a positive impact on communication. The main idea is understandable: smartphones make communication faster, more flexible, and less limited by distance. You also add your own contribution by discussing video calls, VR calls, and emojis, which is a useful extension beyond Mike's point.

However, the response is not at a full-score level because the grammar errors are frequent and sometimes affect fluency. Sentences such as “Almost everyone need,” “The communications could be really efficient,” and “words and expressions that talking in person do not involved” are understandable, but they sound unnatural and reduce the academic quality of the writing. The logic is generally clear, but some claims are a little broad. For example, not all smartphone communication includes body language and tone of voice; only video calls or VR calls can do this. A more accurate sentence would be: “Even when people are far apart, video calls can preserve some nonverbal cues, such as facial expressions and tone of voice.”

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with Model Response 1, your answer is more directly connected to everyday communication. Model Response 1 focuses on political expression through social media, which is relevant but somewhat narrower and less directly tied to personal communication. Your discussion of calling, texting, video calls, and emojis fits the professor’s question more naturally.

Compared with Model Response 2, your position is clearer and more balanced in relation to the prompt because you directly respond to Rachel’s concern about the loss of body language and tone. However, Model Response 2 is stronger in sentence control, example development, and contrast. It gives a concrete personal comparison between older habits and current phone dependence, while your example remains more general.

Main Improvement Advice

To improve this response, keep the same argument but make the language more precise. Instead of saying “technology definitely has a positive impact,” explain the condition more carefully: smartphones are beneficial when they supplement, rather than replace, face-to-face communication. Also, use more accurate academic phrases such as “overcome the barriers of time and distance,” “maintain social connections,” and “convey emotional meaning.” With cleaner grammar and one more specific example, this response could move from around 21/30 to 24–25/30.

Revised Response (Word Count: 128)

I agree with Mike that modern technology is beneficial overall. In daily life, almost everyone needs a smartphone or another modern device to communicate with others. With these devices, we can call people, send text messages, and stay connected even when we are far apart. This kind of communication is efficient because it helps us overcome the barriers of time and distance. Also, I do not think remote communication always lacks body language or tone of voice. Video calls, and perhaps even virtual reality calls in the future, can preserve facial expressions, gestures, and emotional tone. In addition, emojis can sometimes convey feelings that plain words cannot express clearly. Therefore, technologies like smartphones have a positive impact on communication. I cannot imagine a modern world without them.

46 Learning Styles

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: In next week's class we'll talk about different approaches to education. You know, not everyone agrees about the best way for young people to gain knowledge and learn new skills. Let's prepare by discussing whether it's better for students to take classes with a lot of discussions or classes mainly focused on lectures. What do you think?

Rachel: I prefer classes that have a lot of discussions. I just learn better when I'm actively engaged with academic material and can exchange ideas with my classmates. When I have the opportunity to get immediate feedback, I can understand things more deeply. I also benefit from hearing about different perspectives and new ways of thinking about challenging topics. Additionally, discussions help me retain the information better since they're more interactive and memorable.

Mike: I see your point, Rachel, but I prefer lectures. I like being able to listen to an expert explain a topic and really get into it. With lectures, there's usually a clear structure and a set agenda, which can help me stay focused and organized. I also appreciate being able to take notes and study at my own pace. I can't do those things if I have to engage in a discussion. Not only that, but discussions can sometimes get off track or become too argumentative, which can take away from the learning experience.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:52; Saved At: 2026/6/9 13:31:05; Word Count: 130)

I agree with Mike that classes should mainly focus on lectures. Since taking classes is the most significant way for students to gain knowledge, teachers are expected to give lectures and deliver new ideas in a limited time. What teachers say should be well prepared before class, which make the teaching progress more efficient. However, discussing may go astray and finally deviate the correct answer. Also, the discussion would not be so heated sometimes. For example, in my mechanics lecture, when the teacher gave us time to discuss something, we just search the answer online quietly with no one speaking. For students who are not so outgoing, the discussion time could be really embarrassing and torturing. In this case, I think classes should mainly focus on lectures with substantial contents.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 116)

In my opinion, interactive classes are much better than ones where we just sit and passively listen to a professor. I strongly agree with Mike's perspective, and I'd add that we need to prepare for discussions in advance, which also improves our retention of specific details and concepts. When we have a deeper understanding of academic topics, we get higher grades on tests and assignments. While Rachel is right about the fact that it is hard to stay focused while a conversation is going on, it is extremely easy to record our classes. If we need to refer back to things that were mentioned in a class, we can just listen to a recording of it.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 137)

Both options have real advantages, but I'm convinced that interactive classes are much better than ones where we just sit and passively listen to a professor. Discussions require a certain amount of preparation, so they encourage learners to do plenty of pre-reading before coming to class. Whenever we prepare for a topic in advance, we increase our likelihood of retaining memories of specific details and concepts. Remember that people who are able to master challenging academic topics get higher grades on tests and assignments. It's also worth mentioning that nowadays it's really easy to record our classes, so we can create a record to refer to later in case we forget something that was brought up by a classmate or professor. Overall, I'd say that spirited discussions create a stimulating academic environment that everyone can benefit from.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 21/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Better Expression	Reason
classes should mainly focus on lectures	classes should focus mainly on lectures	More natural word order.
Since taking classes is the most significant way	Since classes are one of the main ways	The original is too absolute and slightly unnatural.
which make the teaching progress more efficient	which makes the teaching process more efficient	"Which" refers to the whole previous idea, so the verb should be singular. "Process" is more appropriate than "progress."
discussing may go astray	discussions may go off track	"Go astray" is not idiomatic in this context.
deviate the correct answer	move away from the correct answer	"Deviate" is usually intransitive and should not directly take "the correct answer."
the discussion would not be so heated sometimes	discussions are not always active	"Heated" often means angry or intense, not simply lively.
we just search the answer online quietly	we just searched for the answer online quietly	The example describes a past event, so the past tense is needed.
with no one speaking	without anyone speaking	More natural academic expression.
embarrassing and torturing	embarrassing and stressful	"Torturing" is too strong and unnatural here.
lectures with substantial contents	lectures with substantial content	"Content" is normally uncountable in this meaning.

Evaluation

Your response clearly answers the professor's question and supports Mike's preference for lecture-based classes. The personal example from your mechanics lecture is useful because it gives the post some concreteness. However, the development is still limited. Most of the response repeats Mike's idea that lectures are structured and efficient, but it does not add a very new angle to the discussion. The example is relevant, but it could be connected more directly to learning outcomes, such as concentration, accuracy, or efficient knowledge acquisition.

Compared with Model Response 2, your response is weaker in three main ways. First, the model response has a smoother structure: it admits both sides, gives a clear position, and then develops the argument step by step. Your response moves from lectures to discussions and then to your example, but the logical transitions are less polished. Second, the model uses more precise vocabulary, such as “preparation,” “retaining memories,” and “stimulating academic environment,” while your expressions such as “go stray,” “heated,” and “torturing” sound less natural. Third, the model makes a broader contribution to the discussion, while your answer mainly focuses on one disadvantage of discussions.

One important point is that Model Response 1 is not a strong full-score model because it contains a logical contradiction: it says interactive classes are better, but then claims to agree with Mike, who actually prefers lectures. Model Response 2 is much stronger and more coherent.

To improve your answer, keep your main position, but make the reasoning more academic. For example, instead of only saying that discussions are embarrassing for quiet students, explain that lecture-based classes help students receive accurate information from an expert before forming their own opinions. Also, use your example to prove a broader point: when discussion time is not well guided, students may become passive rather than active learners. With more precise language and stronger logical development, this response could reach around **24–25/30**.

My Notes:

Use your example to prove a broader point: when discussion time is not well guided, students may become passive rather than active learners.

deviate from

substantial content

Discussions help improve students’ retention of information. Here retention = the ability to remember information later

47 Influencers

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on marketing. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Hello class! Next week we will be discussing the impact of social media influencers on consumer behavior. With the rise of social media platforms like Instagram and YouTube, we've seen the emergence of a new type of celebrity: the social media influencer. These influencers have large followings and can sway consumer behavior by endorsing products or services. What are your thoughts on this?

Jack: I think social media influencers have a significant impact. When young people start admiring these influencers and trust their recommendations, they are more likely to buy products or services that they endorse. However, I also think there are some concerns about the authenticity of these endorsements, as some influencers may promote products that they don't actually use or believe in.

Emily: I'm not convinced that social media influencers have a significant impact on consumer behavior. While they may have large followings, most people are smart enough to make their own purchasing decisions based on their needs and preferences. Plus, there are so many influencers out there promoting different products that it can be hard to know who to trust.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:46; Saved At: 2026/6/9 14:39:24; Word Count: 131)

I agree with Jack that media influencer could persuade consumers to buy their products or services. Since most of people are using social media nowadays, we are more and more exposed to the advertisements about their services. Seeing different benefits like advanced functions and practical usage, we might finally give in paying to upgrade. For example, when I use Instagram to communicate, I would like to DIY the preference myself which could make me feeling more satisfied. Also, the vanity of comparison could be another factor that influence us. One of my friends love the logo of VIP that makes him feel respected. So I think social media influencers have a significant impact on consumer behavior, not only by promoting their products and service advantages, but also by manipulating consumers' psychology.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 150)

In my opinion, social media influencers aren't as significant as some people suggest. I agree with Emily's idea that people are too smart to be influenced by them. I'd add that twenty years ago a charismatic person might have convinced us to buy something we didn't really need, but I think that doesn't happen so much nowadays. That's because we can thoroughly research whatever products we are interested in using blogs, consumer magazines and social media. Since we can use these sources of information to find goods that exactly suit our needs, we aren't swayed by the exaggerated claims of social media influencers. Jack raised the relevant point that young people are especially vulnerable, but I think most parents these days take the time to educate their kids about misinformation and monitor their internet use. As a result, young people aren't likely to make rash decisions about what to buy.

Model Response 2 (Word Count: 113)

While I appreciate the points mentioned by Jack and Emily, I think that social media stars aren't particularly influential nowadays. Nowadays consumer behavior is affected by many different things, not just what we see on the Internet. Twenty years ago a charismatic person might have convinced us to buy something we didn't really need, but I don't think that happens so often today. Remember that the choices people make are also impacted by their peers, by their family members and even by traditional advertising, so the Internet isn't a dominant force in their lives. Some people may feel that influencers are more powerful than ever, but I think their impact is actually declining.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 19/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Problem	Better Expression
media influencer could persuade consumers	Singular/plural error; missing article or plural form	social media influencers can persuade consumers
most of people	Incorrect phrase	most people
we are more and more exposed to the advertisements about their services	Awkward wording; unclear reference of "their"	we are increasingly exposed to advertisements for their products and services
different benefits like advanced functions and practical usage	Awkward collocation	benefits such as advanced features and practical uses
we might finally give in paying to upgrade	Incorrect structure	we might finally give in and pay for an upgrade
I would like to DIY the preference myself	"DIY" is unnatural here	I like to customize my preferences myself
which could make me feeling more satisfied	Verb form error	which could make me feel more satisfied
the vanity of comparison could be another factor that influence us	Word choice and subject-verb agreement errors	the desire for social comparison could also influence us
One of my friends love the logo of VIP	Subject-verb agreement; unnatural phrase	One of my friends loves the VIP logo
products and service advantages	Inconsistent number and awkward phrase	product and service advantages

Strict Score Explanation

Your response has a clear position and directly responds to the professor's question, so it satisfies the basic task requirement. It also adds one useful idea: influencers affect not only rational purchasing decisions but also consumer psychology. However, the support is not fully convincing. The Instagram example is unclear because it does not show how an influencer caused the purchase. The VIP-logo example is closer to the idea of psychological manipulation, but it still needs a clearer connection to influencer marketing. Because of these logical gaps and several grammar problems, this response is around the middle range, not the high range.

Comparison with the Model Responses

Compared with Model Response 1, your answer is less fully developed. Model Response 1 clearly responds to both Jack and Emily, gives a broader reason, and explains why modern consumers may be less influenced by online personalities. Your response mainly agrees with Jack, but it does not engage much with Emily's

opposing view. A stronger answer should briefly acknowledge Emily's point and then explain why influencers still matter.

Compared with Model Response 2, your answer has a more interesting idea because you mention consumer psychology. However, Model Response 2 is more controlled in organization and sentence structure. Your answer sometimes uses vague expressions such as "practical usage," "DIY the preference," and "vanity of comparison," which weaken clarity. To improve, use simpler but more precise language, and make each example directly prove your main point.

Main Improvement Direction

To reach the 24–26 range, the response needs clearer logic rather than just more words. You should keep the idea about psychological influence, but connect it directly to influencers: for example, explain that when influencers display a premium membership, fashionable product, or lifestyle, followers may buy it not only for practical value but also to feel closer to that image. This would make your argument more specific, more relevant, and more persuasive.

My Notes:

par for

be increasingly exposed to

make sb. do sth.

customize my preferences

Revised Response (Word Count: 142)

I agree with Jack that social media influencers can strongly influence consumers' buying decisions. Since most people use social media every day, they are increasingly exposed to advertisements for different products and services. When influencers describe benefits such as advanced features, convenience, or personal enjoyment, viewers may gradually become interested and finally decide to pay for the product. For example, when I use Instagram, I often see influencers showing how they customize their accounts or use premium functions. This can make the paid version seem more attractive and useful. In addition, influencers can affect consumers' psychology. Some people buy products not because they truly need them, but because those products make them feel fashionable or respected. One of my friends once wanted a VIP membership mainly because the special logo made him feel important. Therefore, influencers affect consumer behavior not only through product information, but also through social comparison and emotional desire.

High-Score Revised Response (Word Count: 168)

I agree with Jack that social media influencers can have a powerful effect on consumer behavior, but I would add that their influence is not limited to simple advertising. Emily is right that many people make their own decisions, but independent thinking does not mean people are completely free from social pressure. Influencers often sell a lifestyle, not just a product. When followers repeatedly see a popular influencer using a certain brand of clothing, app, or electronic device, they may start to associate that product with confidence, beauty, or success. For example, a student might buy a premium membership not because he truly needs every feature, but because the influencer makes it look fashionable and exclusive. This kind of emotional appeal can be more persuasive than a normal advertisement. Therefore, influencers affect consumers through both practical information and psychological pressure, especially when their followers trust them and want to imitate their lifestyle.

My Notes:

but independent thinking does not mean people are completely free from social pressure.

SO COOL: **Influencers often sell a lifestyle, not just a product.**

48 Price Controls

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on economics. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Today, we're going to discuss whether the government should impose price controls on essential goods, such as housing, food, and medicine. On one hand, price controls can make necessities more affordable for everyone. On the other hand, critics argue that price controls can lead to shortages and inefficiencies. If you had to choose, would you support or oppose price controls? Why?

Sam: I support price controls because they ensure basic needs like housing and medicine remain affordable. For example, rent control prevents excessive rents in expensive cities, which helps low-income families a lot. While critics worry about shortages of apartments and houses, the government can address this by subsidizing new construction so that there is a balance affordability and availability.

Tanya: I oppose price controls because they often harm quality. Rent control, for instance, can discourage landlords from maintaining properties because of the cost. Instead of controlling prices, I think it is better to provide subsidies or targeted financial aid so that people can more easily afford essentials. If we give help only to people that actually need it, there is less chance that our actions will lead to unexpected and undesirable outcomes.

Original Response (Time Used: 09:54; Saved At: 2026/6/9 15:58:07; Word Count: 139)

I agree with Sam that the price of certain essential goods need to be controlled. Take housing as an example, during the development of big cities in recent twenty years, the houses' price have been raised to really expensive. Some scalpers even buy all the houses remaining and then sell them in the price much higher than the houses actually valued. Since the houses are essential for people to live, some citizens have to pay for the living place without other choice. If the government could regulate such behavior and controlling the prices, normal people could save a lot of money to enjoy their lives. Although Tanya's opinion may be right in some meaning that price controlling may bring harm quality, I think the quality only matters when it comes to human made products, not to some specific goods.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 128)

In my opinion, it's probably a good idea to control the prices of some goods. I strongly agree with Sam's idea that this will ensure that people can access basic needs. I'd add that due to current economic conditions, many parents have trouble buying healthy food for their kids. This will be less of a problem if we reduce prices. In the long run, this will pay off as the kids will grow up to be productive members of society. Tanya mentioned that there could be unexpected outcomes, but she didn't mention that price controls have been used successfully in the past. For example, the prices of essential medicines are already controlled by the government and there have been no problems related to safety and quality so far.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 19/30

Your response has a clear position and gives a relevant housing example, so it would not be a low-score answer. However, the language contains frequent grammar and word-choice problems, and the economic reasoning is not developed enough. The final sentence is especially weak because it makes an unclear distinction between “human-made products” and “specific goods.”

Original Expression	Corrected / Better Expression
the price of certain essential goods need to be controlled	the prices of certain essential goods need to be controlled
during the development of big cities in recent twenty years	during the development of big cities over the past twenty years
the houses' price have been raised to really expensive	housing prices have risen to extremely high levels
buy all the houses remaining	buy up the remaining houses
sell them in the price much higher	sell them at a much higher price
than the houses actually valued	than the houses are actually worth
people to live	people to live in
without other choice	without any other choice
could regulate such behavior and controlling the prices	could regulate such behavior and control prices
price controlling may bring harm quality	price controls may harm quality
in some meaning	to some extent / in some ways
human made products	human-made products

Compared with Model Response 1, your response is weaker mainly in three areas. First, the model response connects price controls to a broader social benefit, such as children's access to healthy food, while your response stays almost entirely on housing. Second, the model response responds to Tanya more directly by addressing her concern about unexpected outcomes, but your response only briefly mentions her point and then gives an unclear reply. Third, the model response uses smoother academic discussion language, while your answer has several grammar errors that reduce clarity.

To improve, you should keep your housing example but express it in more precise economic language. For example, use “speculators” instead of “scalpers,” “housing prices” instead of “houses' price,” and “market value” instead of “actually valued.” You should also explain why price controls are necessary only for essential goods, not for all products. A stronger argument would say that the government should impose limited price controls on necessities while also increasing supply through subsidies or public investment. This would respond to both Sam's affordability point and Tanya's concern about shortages.

Overall: This is around a **19/30** response. With cleaner grammar, a more direct response to Tanya, and a clearer explanation of how to avoid shortages, it could reach about **23–25/30**. To reach **27+/30**, the argument needs to be more balanced, more precise, and more naturally written.

My Notes:

buy up the remaining houses

house scalpers -> property speculators

49 Website Reliability

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

Your professor is teaching a class on research techniques. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Next week, we're going to discuss the best way to determine if a website or article is reliable. There are many factors to consider in order to ensure that your essays are supported by reliable sources. Before we meet, I want you to consider the following question: what do you think is the most effective way to assess whether a website or article can be trusted?

Laura: I think the best way is to check if the author of the article makes use of strong evidence and sources. A reliable article should cite credible studies, data, or expert opinions. If the author's claims are backed by verifiable information and come from a trustworthy institution like a university or academic publisher, it's a good sign the website or article can be trusted.

Caleb: I believe the author's credibility is most important. If the writer has expertise or professional experience related to the topic, it's more likely the content is accurate. For instance, I trust articles written by scientists about health topics more than random blogs. Checking the author's background is a crucial first step.

Original Response (Time Used: 04:32; Overtime: 00:00; Saved At: 2026/6/12 21:44:00; Word Count: 129)

While both evidential sources and author's credibility contribute to the material's reliability, I think the most essential part should be the authority. For example, we all use dictionary to learn the words. The author may not be so famous, and the evidence might not so strong. But we still believe in it without any reservation, because it is the authority and official exemplification. No one could not doubt it, because the dictionary makes the rules. Also, it is the same when it comes to other textbooks such as math books. We need to learn algorithm such as how to plus or minus. So these books are the authority, which construct our knowledge foundations. All the evidence and sources as well as the author's profession are based on such authority.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 124)

While I appreciate the points made by both Caleb and Laura, I think the best method of determining whether an article is reliable is to check who has published it. This is because if it has been published by a trustworthy source like the "New York Times" we know that a lot of time and money has been used to ensure that it is accurate. Moreover, when this sort of publisher realizes that they've made a mistake in an article they usually go back and fix it. Sometimes they even retract the article. Some people, like Laura, might argue that it is most important to check which sources the author has cited but they don't realize that some unscrupulous writers might simply fabricate sources.

Evaluation and Suggestions

Estimated TOEFL-style Converted Score: 18/30

Grammar and Expression Corrections

Original Expression	Corrected Expression	Reason
evidential sources	evidence and sources	"Evidential" is uncommon in this context.
author's credibility	the author's credibility	A definite article is needed.
the authority	authority / authoritative sources	"The authority" is too vague here.
we all use dictionary	we all use dictionaries / a dictionary	Countable noun problem.
the evidence might not so strong	the evidence might not be very strong	Missing verb "be".
official exemplification	an authoritative reference	The original phrase is unnatural.
No one could not doubt it	Few people would doubt it	The double negative changes the meaning.
how to plus or minus	how to add or subtract	"Plus" and "minus" are not verbs here.
which construct our knowledge foundations	which construct the foundations of our knowledge	More natural academic phrasing.
author's profession	the author's expertise	"Expertise" is more accurate than "profession".

Overall Evaluation

Your response addresses the professor's question and gives a clear personal opinion: authoritative sources are more reliable than ordinary websites or individual writers. You also respond to both Laura and Caleb, which is good for the academic discussion task. However, the main argument is not fully convincing. The example of dictionaries and math textbooks is related to authority, but it does not directly explain how to judge the reliability of a website or article. In addition, some sentences are grammatically inaccurate or logically unclear, especially "No one could not doubt it," which accidentally means that people can doubt it.

Compared with Model Response 1, your answer is less precise and less practical. The model focuses on checking the publisher, gives a concrete example, and explains why a reliable publisher has fact-checking and correction procedures. Your answer discusses "authority" in a broader philosophical sense, but it does not explain a usable method clearly enough. A stronger answer should define authority more specifically, such as government agencies, universities, peer-reviewed journals, or established news organizations. It should also explain why these sources are reliable: they have editorial standards, expert review, accountability, and correction mechanisms.

Main Advice

To improve the score, make the argument more directly connected to website reliability. Instead of saying that dictionaries "make the rules," say that authoritative institutions are usually more trustworthy because they have professional review systems and public responsibility. Also, avoid absolute claims such as "no one would doubt it," because even authoritative sources can make mistakes. A high-scoring response should sound balanced: authority is important, but it should still be checked together with evidence, publication date, and possible bias.

Score Breakdown

Category	Score	Comment
Task Response	4/5	Clear opinion, but the examples are not fully relevant to websites or articles.
Development	3/5	The idea is interesting, but the reasoning is repetitive and not sufficiently practical.
Organization	4/5	The response has a clear structure, though the logic could be smoother.
Language Use	3/5	Several grammar and word-choice errors reduce clarity.
Academic Discussion Fit	3/5	It responds to classmates, but the contribution is less specific than the model answer.

Revised Response (Word Count: 132)

While I agree with Laura that evidence matters and with Caleb that the author's background is important, I think the most effective way to judge reliability is to check whether the article comes from an authoritative institution. For example, when students look up the meaning of a word, they usually trust a well-known dictionary, not because they know the individual writer, but because the dictionary is produced by a professional organization with clear standards. The same is true of textbooks, university websites, and peer-reviewed journals. These sources are generally more reliable because they are reviewed by experts and must protect their reputation. Of course, authority alone does not guarantee that every detail is correct, but it is still a strong first sign that a website or article can be trusted.

High-Scoring Revised Response (Word Count: 147)

Laura and Caleb both raise important points, but I think the most effective way to judge reliability is to examine the publisher's authority and accountability. Evidence and author expertise matter, but they are more convincing when the article appears on a platform with clear editorial standards. For example, I would trust a health article from a university hospital or a government health agency more than a personal blog, even if both mention similar studies. The reason is that authoritative institutions usually have expert review, fact-checking procedures, and public responsibility if they make mistakes. This does not mean we should accept everything from famous organizations without question. We still need to check whether the article is recent, whether its evidence is cited clearly, and whether it has obvious bias. However, starting with the publisher's authority is the most practical first step because it helps readers quickly separate serious sources from unreliable ones.

50 Automation and the Workforce

Task Type: TOEFL Write for an Academic Discussion

Recommended Time: 10 minutes

The professor is teaching a class on science. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should:

- express and support your personal opinion.
- make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor: Next, we'll be discussing the future of automation and its impact on the workforce. As industries integrate more advanced technologies, there are concerns about job displacement and the transformation of work. For example, automation may replace some jobs but could also create opportunities in technology and engineering fields. Given these changes, do you believe that automation will ultimately benefit or harm workers? Explain why you think so.

Juan: I believe automation will benefit the workforce by enhancing efficiency and creating high-skilled jobs in sectors like AI and robotics. This shift could lead to increased job satisfaction as people engage in more creative and less monotonous work, fundamentally improving our quality of life.

Alice: While Juan makes a valid point about job creation in certain sectors, I'm concerned about widespread job losses among less skilled people. Not everyone can transition into high-tech roles, so automation could widen the gap between the wealthy and the poor. Therefore, I think the harms could outweigh the benefits, especially in the short to medium term.

I agree with Juan that automation will ultimately benefit workers, because it will release workers from tedious repetitive work and bring efficiency. As Juan said, autonomous technology improves our life. I would add that it also ... **I failed to write this topic.**

When I tried to write this response by myself, I found that I could not develop a clear and independent idea. My first thought was almost the same as Juan's, so I did not know how to make a new contribution to the discussion. Because of this, I decided to stop writing the response directly and use ChatGPT to help me generate possible angles. The purpose was not simply to get a finished answer, but to see how the same general opinion could be developed from different perspectives, such as worker safety, job transition, inequality, education, human-machine cooperation, and the difference between company profits and workers' well-being.

Model Response 1 (Word Count: 132)

In my opinion, automation will end up harming workers ten or twenty years down the road. My personal belief is that when a company has a choice between compensating an employee or utilizing cheap technology, the company will almost always choose to use technology. For example, the car manufacturing industry used to employ tens of thousands of workers, but due to advances in technology, the workforce has been reduced to a fraction of what it was fifty years ago. While Juan raised a relevant point about efficiency leading to the creation of new jobs, I believe he is missing a critical idea. To be more specific, high-skilled jobs like programming and game design are already disappearing due to the advent of AI technology that can do the same job for almost nothing.

Possible aspects:

- **Angle 1: Time Scale**

- **Automation may hurt workers in the short term but benefit them in the long term.**

Automation will ultimately benefit workers, but the transition period may be painful for people whose jobs are replaced. This idea responds to both Juan and Alice: Juan is right about long-term opportunities, while Alice is right about short-term job losses.

- **Angle 2: Nature of Work**

- **Automation is beneficial because it can replace dangerous, repetitive, and physically exhausting work.**

This angle is different from Juan's general point about high-skilled jobs. It focuses more specifically on how automation can improve workers' safety and make human labor less monotonous. Examples can include factories, mines, warehouses, and assembly lines.

- **Angle 3: Social Inequality**

- **Automation may harm workers because its benefits are not equally distributed.**

Automation may increase profits for companies and create opportunities for highly educated workers, but it may also leave low-skilled workers behind. This angle is close to Alice's concern and is useful if I want to write a more critical response.

- **Angle 4: Education and Policy**

- **Automation itself is not the real problem; the real problem is whether workers receive enough training and support.**

This is a balanced and practical position. Automation can benefit workers if governments and companies provide retraining programs, career guidance, and job-transition support. Without these measures, automation may increase unemployment and inequality.

- **Angle 5: Change in Job Content**

- **Automation will not simply eliminate jobs; it will change what workers are expected to do.**

This angle is more sophisticated than saying automation either creates or destroys jobs. For example, doctors may use AI to analyze medical images, but they still need to make final decisions and communicate with patients. Teachers may use AI to grade simple assignments, but they still need to guide and motivate students.

- **Angle 6: Different Effects on Different Workers**

- **Automation will create winners and losers in the workforce.**

High-skilled workers may become more productive because they can use advanced tools, while low-skilled workers may face a higher risk of replacement. This angle avoids treating "workers" as one single group.

- **Angle 7: Economic Efficiency vs. Worker Welfare**

- **Automation may improve economic efficiency, but this does not automatically mean it will improve workers' lives.**

A company may become more productive after adopting robots or AI, but workers may not receive higher wages, shorter working hours, or better working conditions. This angle is useful because it clearly separates company benefits from worker benefits.

- **Angle 8: Historical Comparison**

- **Automation will probably benefit workers in the long run because past technological changes also created new industries.**

This angle uses history as evidence. For example, computers replaced some traditional office tasks, but they also created new jobs in programming, cybersecurity, digital design, and online business. However, this argument should not sound too absolute because the current speed of automation is unusually fast.

- **Angle 9: Speed of Transition**

- **Automation may harm workers because technology changes faster than ordinary people can adapt.**

Juan is right that new jobs may appear, but not everyone can quickly become an engineer or AI specialist. This angle is especially useful for discussing middle-aged workers, low-income workers, or people without access to advanced education.

- **Angle 10: Human-Machine Cooperation**

- **Automation should be used to assist human workers, not to replace them completely.**

This angle focuses on cooperation between people and machines. Machines can handle repetitive calculations, dangerous operations, and data analysis, while humans can focus on judgment, creativity, communication, and ethical decisions.

Response: Automation Removes Dangerous and Repetitive Work (Word Count: 151)

Juan and Alice both make reasonable points, but I tend to agree more with Juan that automation will ultimately benefit workers. The main reason is that many jobs replaced by machines are repetitive, exhausting, or even dangerous. For example, in factories, mines, or large warehouses, workers often have to do the same physical task for many hours, which can damage their health and limit their personal development. If robots can take over these tasks, human workers can focus more on supervision, communication, quality control, and problem solving. Of course, Alice is right that some workers may lose their jobs in the short term, especially if they lack technical skills. However, this problem should be solved through retraining rather than by rejecting automation itself. In the long run, automation can make work safer and more meaningful, as long as companies help workers move into better roles.

Response: Efficiency Does Not Automatically Help Workers (Word Count: 150)

While Juan is right that automation can improve efficiency and create some high-skilled jobs, I am not sure that it will automatically benefit workers. In my opinion, automation may benefit companies more than ordinary employees if its gains are not distributed fairly. For example, a warehouse company may use robots to ship products faster and reduce labor costs, but the remaining workers might simply face heavier monitoring and faster work rhythms. In that case, the company becomes more productive, but workers do not necessarily receive higher pay, shorter hours, or better working conditions. This is why I agree with Alice's concern about inequality. New technology can create wealth, but that wealth may stay mainly with business owners and highly educated workers. Therefore, automation will only truly benefit workers if governments and companies ensure that productivity gains lead to fair wages, training opportunities, and more humane working conditions.